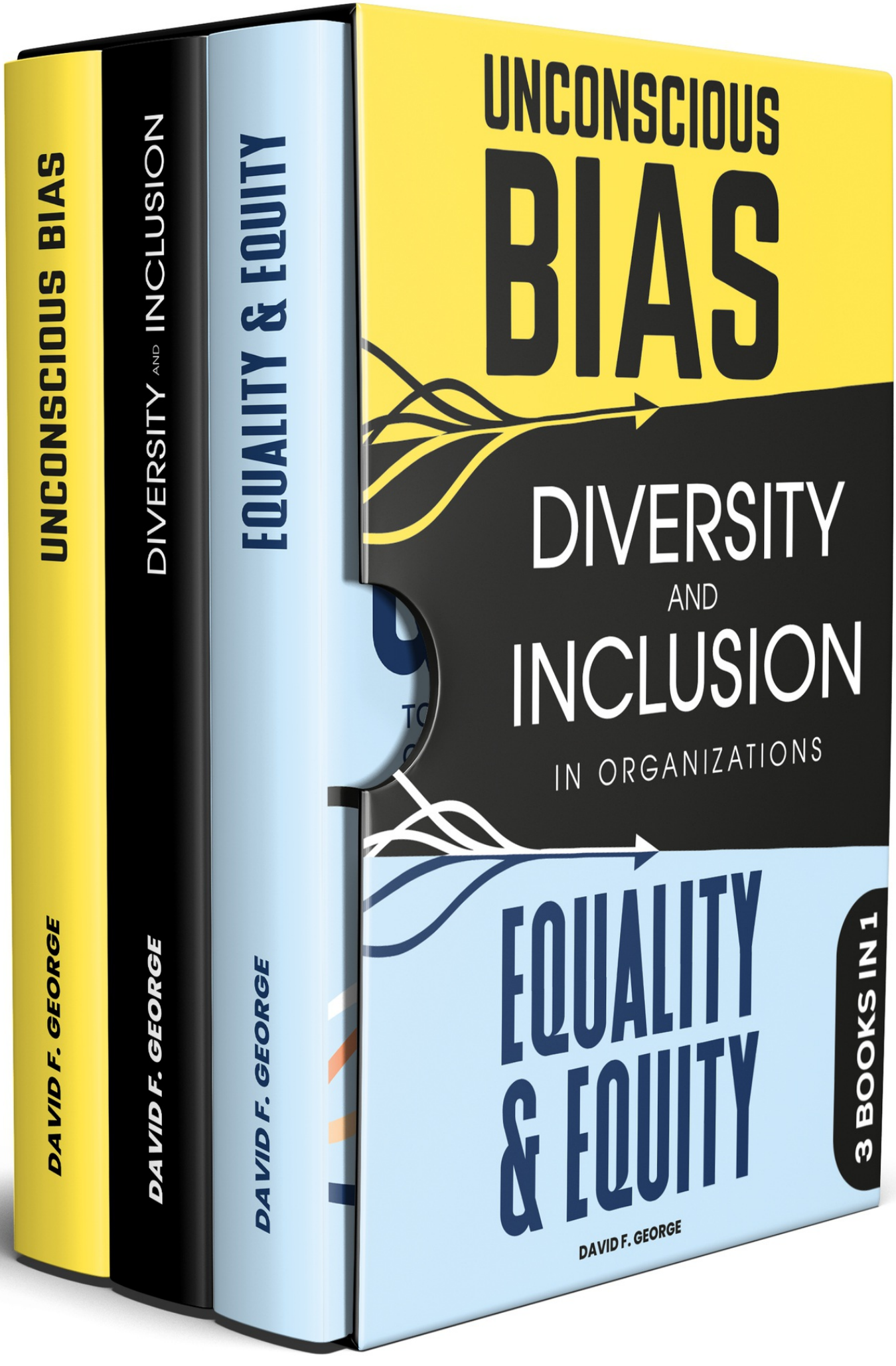

UNCONSCIOUS BIAS
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UNCONSCIOUS BIAS

The Prejudice of Open-Minded People

DIVERSITY AND INCLUSION IN ORGANIZATIONS

How to promote equality in the workplace and benefit from it

EQUALITY & EQUITY

Today's Situation of Equality in USA, UK and Other Multicultural Countries.

David F. George

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Introduction

The human brain automatically feels at ease when we interact with people we look and think alike, or act similarly. That was used as a survival trick in the savannah and is still applicable today. Our brain creates shortcuts to handle the important information that it processes. These shortcuts cause us to make quick and snappy decisions about who or what we prefer over others. It is these automatic preferences that we refer to as biases. And the fact that our brain does it without our awareness is what makes it unconscious.

Unconscious biases are in every part of our society and exist in every one of us. According to findings from developments in neuroscience, many of the biases held at a subconscious level are formed throughout our lifetime through societal and parental conditioning. Also, millions of information are gathered and processed by our brains to be categorized into certain patterns. These patterns include gender, profession, sexuality, ethnicity, disability, body size, etc., and they all have different assessments imprinted on them, which comprise the basis of our relationship with everyone.

According to observations, Google image search show that whites constitute 90% of professors, and only about 25% are women. However, this is statistically inaccurate and proves that bias is present even in the algorithm. A study that once involved an AI review of more than 100,000 images worldwide showed that women are more associated with images of the kitchen. At the end of the review, the AI had learned the act of bias and even amplified it. This showed how much bias exists on just internet images.

Comparison is the first step for transformation. And the comparison is derived from diversity. Imagine living in a material world where there is just one type of coffee, one flavor of fragrance, and one kind of weather. It can also be justified as nobody would have ever witnessed it differently. But the earth is a beautiful mystery. It has classified its dwellers into different time zones and different weathers. This made it easy for people to develop their idiosyncratic characteristics simultaneously with stages of evolution.

The dichotomy of nature makes a great point where we see a whole world come together as one and yet are distinct within its heterogeneity.

A Yale University study proved that scientists (male or female) trained to be objective are more likely to hire men, considering them more competent and paying $4,000 per year more than their female counterparts. In another study, a science faculty had once rated male applicants for the role of a laboratory manager more than females and even offered a higher starting salary and career mentoring to them. They were surprised when this bias was explicitly pointed out to them, and it proved that they had never realized their own internalized biases.

Sendhil Mullainathan once wrote a New York Times article about a study he co-authored in 2003. In it, he and Marianne Bertrand mailed thousands of resumes from the University of Chicago to employers with job openings and monitored those who called back for interviews. They both randomly used stereotypical names such as Jamal (depicting African-American) and Brendan (White). In the end, they found out that almost 50% stood a higher chance of being called back for an interview as long as they had a white name. Since they had made the resumes statistically identical and only manipulated the names, it was apparent that the names influenced the outcomes.

On a further study in 2015, Sendhil applied for 12 vacancies looking for an academic position, all identical in nature, on the same salary scale, and in the same academic departments. He sent the same resume with 6 bearing his maiden name (a foreign name) and used a double-barreled surname (containing a European surname). In the end, calls came from all 6 of the places where the European name was used, while only one came from where the Indian surname was used.

Although this is a relatively small dataset and various variables are involved, the results still hint at something. Questions that it can provoke are if the surname attracted more professional responsibility and why? After investigating all the recruitment committees, it turned out that they were all white. This hinted that the committees could be favoring those who were similar to them even without explicitly showing prejudice against foreigners.

Unconscious bias can be consequential to employee experience and, consequently, hinder the organization’s capabilities. However, topics on race, diversity, and prejudice cause discomfort to most. But viewing from a risk vs. reward perspective, it is clear that these topics are very often avoided with the notion that it causes more harm than

good. Nevertheless, the outpouring of grief, anger, and actions provoked by recent high-profile tragedies have made the majority of society more open about their biases.

The fact that the cost of workplace bias annually is around $64B is alarming and slowly drives various economies to the dust. This estimated figure is gotten from the cost of losing and replacing over 2 million American workers due to unfairness and discrimination. What's worse is that these estimates do not even include legal fees – resource companies or employers spend defending themselves in court or for legal penalties.

In the twenty-first century, diversification is seen under the lights of many shades. Existing classifications like gender, ethnicity, faith, sexual orientation, age, community, socio-economic status; all leading to a skewed view of the world for any individual. Now, where do people from a wide range of diversity come together to function as a union? It is their workplace. For achieving financial independence, an assorted workforce is co-dependent on each other.

To gain a deeper insight into the status of currently trending focus groups, individual study into the subject matter is necessary. Diversity in terms of nationality, age, ethnicity and gender holds a special place in organizations. Companies recognizing various diverse groups in building their workforce attain higher zeniths than those who do not.

Including diverse groups for important positions is a win-win for employers and employees. A dynamic and coherent workforce tends to achieve better than otherwise. When creative minds from various clines join hands together to solve a problem, a holistic overview becomes the solution's backbone.

An entrepreneur with good leadership qualities that can harmonize the interest and creativity of the team will produce groundbreaking success. American author Seth Godin quotes that "Leadership is the art of giving people a platform for spreading ideas that work."

It implies that if there are mutual grounds or a common platform provided to a diverse willing set of people, the reach of ideas would be widespread, which will result in a more significant and quicker positive outcome.

This book will cover a range of subjects that are imperative to the understanding of the unconscious biases we make, inequality and inequity in our schools, workplace and society, and how inclusion of diversity in the work environment can be practiced. This book identifies various issues on diversity and prejudice, and it also identifies solutions to these problems from a professional perspective. Fundamental values such as empathy towards the marginalized may help achieve a positive outlook on diversity.

Despite the rising agitations against inequalities, the imbalance in our society keeps evolving in different forms in the system. Inequality is getting out of control. Hundreds of millions of people are facing severe sufferings while huge rewards and benefits seem to be the inequitable inheritance of others. There are more riches in the world than at any point in time, we have more billionaires than ever, yet the gap between the oppressors and the oppressed continues to widen.

Many governments are guilty of fueling this inequality crisis. Several policies put in place hit those at the bottom the hardest while those at the top hierarchy in society enjoy benefits at the expense of the masses. This practice is detrimental and has a devastating cost on humans. It has to stop, and change is possible. This book explores the problem at the source on the state of equality and equity in the US, UK, and other multicultural countries thorough research and fact-finding. It tackles issues such as the complete meaning of inequality and how it's practiced in several nations of the world, to give us a basic understand on inequalities as it has been from time past.

You will get to understand the deleterious effect unconscious bias has on the emotions of victims. It breaks them down and causes them to disengage from and reduce contribution on many things, work inclusive. For centuries, women have been biased against taking up jobs deemed unsuitable for them. The unnecessary social construct suggesting stereotypical gender roles is to blame. This age-long belief has been quashed by the success of notable and strong women in different walks of life. The roots of the problem are still noticeable in our workplace, family setup, and socio-economic affairs, which need to end.

Nations of the world have missed out on the potentials of women who could have been the missing piece in solving several societal issues due to gender stereotyping. Some women even voluntarily avoid some career paths due to the prejudice bottleneck in the field.

Racial discrimination is also a burning issue all over the world. Since time immemorial, racial discrimination has been the bane of diversity and prejudice in our society. Racism and slavery (now in the form of human trafficking and systemic slavery) are big worries worldwide.

This book sheds light on various initiatives an organization must take to inculcate diversity. How one can work more efficiently when they are considered 'needed' and provided with a conducive environment to work. The creation of a workplace culture requires great dedication and determination. Building a concrete inclusion strategy is a prerequisite of making a shatterproof unity in any organization.

According to Nelson Mandela, "As long as injustice, poverty, and gross inequality persist in our world, none of us can truly rest." Ending systemic inequality is the cross of everyone, because one way or another, it affects every one of us. If not directly, then indirectly. We make the world a fair place to live, and that's what global egalitarianism is all about.

There is an extreme need to advocate for equity and equality in day-to-day living, in the relationship between groups, nations, and the world. The rise of equality is a practical project that would require the development of new ideas to help reshape and restructure the environment, economic, governmental, and social institutions.

Various practical activities and strategies are included in some of the chapters. Leadership ideals are also discussed, and leadership plans to inculcate inclusion in organizations.

There are certain benefits of investing efforts and resources in diversity and inclusion in an organization for leaders. Aside from the societal sense of equity, it can also extend to profit-making, as the marginalized ones will feel loved and always choose the company's product and services.

Getting rid of biases that exist subconsciously is a tedious task. However, it can be made possible by opening up the mind and bringing the conscious mind to power. This book gives valuable insight into the best HRM practices that could eventually contribute to the organization's growth.

"Your assumptions are your windows on the world. Scrub them off every once in a while, or the light won't come in." — **Isaac Asimov**

Chapter 1 - A Trip to a World Devoid of Consciousness:

Understanding Unconscious Bias

An open-minded person is one who is receptive to a wide variety of ideas, arguments, and information. This ability is generally considered a positive one and necessary for critical and rational thinking.

Without the ability to welcome other ideas and perspectives, it may be very easy to miss certain factors that contribute to the problems, making the discovery of a practical solution very difficult. With the world being as polarized as it is now, the ability to step out of your comfort zone to look into other's ideas and perspectives is vital for peaceful coexistence.

As much as open-mindedness can be a treasure to our relationships with others, it creates the perfect opening for prejudices to creep in, most times even unconsciously.

In the first book - *Diversity and Inclusion in Organizations*, we have already seen prejudice as a preconceived judgment of a certain group of people simply because they are members of that group. It also entails the opinions and attitudes we direct towards these people.

Prejudice was treated as a tendency to over-categorize and was seen to be unjustified and incorrect. It's just a set of attitudes that offer some form of support or reasons for the justification of discrimination and is done solely because of people's membership in a social group. An example is a person holding prejudiced views towards another for the sheer reason of the latter being a member of a particular race or gender.

Prejudice is not always discrimination. We know discrimination to mean behaviors or actions directed towards an individual or group, most especially based on the social group they belong to. These behaviors are mostly negative.

Prejudice can occur without discrimination. In essence, prejudice makes do of all the three components of an attitude which are affective, behavioral, and cognitive, while discrimination, on the other hand, involves only behavior.

The prejudiced views open-minded people hold are often unconscious. They have these views or mindsets without even being aware that they do. This has provoked the topic of Unconscious Bias, which we shall be looking into.

Unconscious (or implicit) bias as a term was first brought into light in 1995 by Mahzarin Banaji and Anthony Greenwald, both psychologists who argued that social behavior is influenced significantly by associations and judgments which are carried out unconsciously.

Since then, psychologists have carried out many extensive pieces of research on implicit bias, and results have proved that we all possess a form of implicit biases of our own even without knowing it.

According to a distinction by Kahneman in 2011, there are two different types of thinking – system 1 and system 2.

System 1 thinking involves the mode of the brain where its thinking is fast, emotional, and unconscious. Little effort is required for this type, but there are usually some errors here and there. Type 1 system is applied extensively in our everyday lives. It is required for activities like talking, cleaning, driving, etc.

The type 2 system, on the other hand, makes use of logical thoughts where effort and reason are vital. It is also done slowly and consciously.

These two terms are very important in understanding how the human mind works, but the first one – Type 1 or System 1 thinking-is of more importance to us, as it is the root of unconscious bias.

Implicit Bias vs. Explicit Bias

Implicit bias, as we have seen, is just the attitudes and beliefs that occur without our conscious awareness and control. It is an example of system 1 thinking, and we could not even be aware of its existence.

In implicit bias, a person can hold beliefs that are contradictory to their conscious beliefs without even realizing it. For instance, it is possible for one to publicly or openly express honest liking of a particular social group while at the same time being unconsciously biased against that same group. This shows that a single individual can hold implicit and explicit biases differently.

Also, implicit bias can become an explicit bias as well. This happens when the prejudices and beliefs you hold become known to your consciousness. At this point, you are consciously aware of them and can choose if you want to act on or against them.

Explicit biases are those biases that we are consciously aware of, and they are examples of the system 2 thinking treated earlier (*in Diversity and Inclusion in the Organizations*). A demonstration of explicit bias is being threatened by or scared of another group and subjecting to dropping hate speech against them as a result.

Many factors influence how implicit and explicit biases are developed. Therefore, yours may differ from your friend's or even your family members.

Our focus, unconscious or implicit bias, is how an opinion about a specific situation or a person is quickly formed by you without knowing it, which is deeply rooted in psychology. In a later stage of this book, we will see that our brain is responsible for forming these biases. It uses the knowledge and previous experiences on social situations, stereotypes, attitudes, cultures, emotional reactions, and many more. We gain this knowledge or experiences from our daily activities and exposure to media throughout our lives.

In recruitment, unconscious bias plays a very significant role in skewing your overall judgment on many levels. The norm is using your experience in the assessment of applicants, but it becomes a concern if you have your assumptions, expectations, and preferences influence your decision too much. It is still not ideal for letting your feelings result in positive bias as it will still lead to unfair favoring. For instance, if you associate with intelligence and choose a candidate who went to a high-profile university, it is still an example of harmful unconscious bias. Having a higher education or attending a better university doesn't automatically make a candidate more intelligent or more qualified than others.

With your biases reined in, recruitment would definitely become challenging, and first impressions are also significant during interviews. Nevertheless, avoiding unconscious bias is extremely important because it can lead to many negative results such as unfair and inaccurate judgments, overlooked talent, or discrimination in the worst-case scenario.

How Unconscious Bias Occur in Different Forms

Unconscious bias takes many forms, but we shall look at its common examples in the workplace. This aims at improving your awareness of the various forms so you can become more self-aware and have a better understanding of the topic at hand. In a later stage of this book, we will still treat more forms, but the 9 most common examples of unconscious bias in the workplace are; Affinity bias, attribution bias, beauty bias, conformity bias, confirmation bias, contrast bias, gender bias, halo effect, and horns effect.

1. **Affinity Bias:** This is an occasion where one unconsciously prefers people who share certain qualities with them or with someone they like. It is made possible by your brain seeing those people be familiar and relatable, and everyone wants to be around people they can relate well to.

An example here is if an applicant comes from the same school as you. Another is if they share similar hobbies with you. In these cases, there's a higher chance that you'll prefer them over others.

Recruiting people on the basis that they have similar qualities with you is not the right move in any way. If you want an identical culture in your business, you might want to hire like-minded people. But it would be best if you didn't let affinity bias cloud your judgment. If you do, your workplace might only end up lacking diverse personalities, thereby decreasing the level and quality of creative views.

Also, it is very unfair; as applicants who isn't like you can be just as talented or even more talented than those who are.

2. **Attribution bias:** This type of bias entails the perception of your actions and that of others. It is based on our brain's flawed ability to make accessions on the reasons for certain behaviors, most especially those who end up on success and failure.

In general, the human mind tends to take responsibility and praise its skills and personality for its accomplishments while blaming failures on other factors or making excuses for them. In essence, we are all less likely to find faults in ourselves most times.

However, this is reversed when it comes to our views on others. We always tend to tag their successes as luck while attributing their failures or errors to lack of skills.

In recruitment or the workplace, this type of bias can cloud your judgment on a candidate or your colleagues or workers. It makes you unconsciously focus on their faults and ignore most of their accomplishments.

3. **Beauty Bias:** It is normal for us humans to quickly notice people's appearances and choose to relate them with their personalities. Hence, the coining of the term "dress as you want to be addressed." Appearances are very important, especially in workplace settings, because they generally reflect professionalism. However, many people are guilty of judging people too harshly on their physical attractiveness.

It is never fair to conclude on the number of efforts people make based on their appearance. It is even worse when you start to judge their skill level by their physical attractiveness. You shouldn't always assume that a person is organized in an all-around manner just because they dress professionally. The reverse could be true.

In other cases, you might unconsciously dislike an individual because there are certain features about them that you don't like. An example could be that they lack height, have bad posture, or do not possess an expressive face. These are all common stereotypical views of how a serious, successful, or qualified person should look like.

Having these assumptions will only push you to make unfair decisions that favor attractive people in the workplace. Therefore, we should all make efforts to portray the saying "do not judge a book by its cover."

4. **Conformity Bias:** This form of bias occurs when your decisions are heavily influenced by other people or by a third party. It is brought into fruition by our natural tendency to seek acceptance from others by always striving to hold opinions accepted by society.

Conformity bias is quite common in the workplace. People tend to go by the views held by the majority group on certain issues and usually choose to dump their contrasting original views to go with the majority.

In interviews, people may develop strong feelings towards a candidate because they noticed something similar. However, it is not good to let these opinions prevent you from honestly accessing the candidate as you never can tell what influenced the thinking of the majority.

5 **Confirmation Bias:** Confirmation bias has to do with occasions where people opt to search for pieces of evidence that support their opinions instead of looking at the whole picture. It may sound like a good approach, but in reality, it will only result in selective observation where you ignore every other information that doesn't fit your view to focus on those that support you, no matter how wrong you are.

For example, having to interview a candidate that came late 10 minutes might clouds your judgment throughout the interview as you already concluded from the onset that they lack organizational skills. While conducting the interview, you keep being only focused on any information or idea that backs up your initial judgment.

This particular form of bias is found in many people, as we all usually seek confirmation that our initial judgment is right. Confirmation bias is also used to back up other forms of bias and is therefore very important that we keep it in check.

6. **Contrast effect:** The contrast effect is visible when two things are compared to each other instead of being judged based on their merits.

This type of bias is also prevalent in the workplace, especially in recruitment. Typically, if you want to narrow your options and reduce your work, it can be very useful to compare applications when you have too many CVs on your desk.

However, opting for this can make your standards too high and harsh. If your goal is to find people who can suit the role, you will only end up overlooking that goal, focusing on those who have the most excellent CV.

7. **Gender Bias:** This is simply the preference for a particular gender over the other. It is heavily influenced by the deep views and beliefs we hold about roles of genders and stereotypes.

In our workplaces, most especially in interviews, this form of bias can make you unconsciously favor a candidate based on their gender and qualities you've already associated with them just for belonging to that gender. A perfect and common example is unconsciously believing that a man is more deserving of a physically demanding job than a woman. Another is favoring a woman for a chef's job over a man simply because you believe women are to be better chefs than men.

Most notably, gender bias occurs when we relate better with colleagues because they are of the same gender or of the gender that we prefer. We can usually connect better with people of the same gender because they are more likely to have shared gender-specific experiences.

8. **Halo Effect:** This is apparent in situations where we are more focused on a desirable feature of a person. Seeing that feature makes you conclude the person is perfect, and all your views about them are positive and in a "halo" light. Just as in affinity and confirmation bias, we are made to overlook other information about the person. This cloud our judgment in other aspects, even the negative ones.

In workplaces and recruitments, if you don't want to hire or work with someone who turns out to be unfit for a role when the halo glow wears off, then you should try your best to prevent this form of unconscious bias.

9. **Horns Effect:** This is directly opposite to the halo effect. Here, you focus on a particularly negative attitude of a person, which skews your judgment on their other qualities, even the good ones.

For instance, if someone uses a phrase we dislike, we automatically ignore or dislike everything else they say.

In your workplace or recruitment, we must learn how to avoid focusing on features of a person we dislike. One mistake or flaw about them doesn't automatically define them entirely.

Is it right to hold biased opinions against people?

According to research, people instinctively classify others based on common criteria in general. These criteria or factors include; age, skin color, gender, and weight. People can also be classified based on educational level, accent, social status, job title, sexuality, and disability. We also have presumed traits that we subconsciously relate to these groups and automatically kick off whenever we classify any new person into these groups.

One might argue that this system is advantageous because the time and effort that would have been spent in processing information about people is saved. This creates the avenue for us to focus our attention on more important tasks.

However, there are many disadvantages associated with this, and the worst is that it can influence us to make unfair and wrong assumptions about people and act accordingly. This makes people rely more on stereotypes, even if we don't consciously believe in them.

No matter how unbiased we may consider ourselves to be, there is a good chance that we have a level of subconscious negative opinion about a particular group of people different from ours. The only way there is a low chance of feeling prejudice against these people is if we get more exposure.

Many people are unaware of their prejudices and always tend to try to hide them. However, these prejudices can have disastrous consequences for our management level and the response of the people being managed by us. According to various studies, the way victims of discrimination feel can affect them in many ways. In workplaces, most especially, it can affect their commitment, job satisfaction, and work tension, consequently harming their overall performance.

In another instance, if your workers or colleagues feel that you are being influenced by unconscious bias when conducting management reviews, they may feel they are just victims of the consequences of your discrimination. This can significantly affect your organization as there will be mistrust and low morale in your ranks. In the worst outcome, you can even lose highly qualified employees.

With a team member who felt discriminated against by you leaving your organization, it may not only result in you losing a possible gem but also spoil your reputation. At worst, if the victim is to take legal actions, it could cost you considerably. Therefore, make sure you understand the discrimination laws in the country you stay and work. Afterward, read further into this book to help you understand how and why you are capable of controlling unconscious bias and how to overcome it.

Chapter 2 - An Encounter with Mind Bugs

With the brain often referred to as one giant supercomputer, it's no surprise that it shares some of the strengths of these high-level performance computers and some of its weaknesses. With the software of a computer often having instances of errors or flaws, the human brain also has its fair share in the form of unconscious bias described as 'mind bugs' by Harvard professor Mahzarin Banaji.

Picture an American driving home after a long day of work to get home to bed. If you've done this, you would have automatically pictured a white man in the vehicle with no subconscious thought of assigning a race or a gender, the likelihood of picturing a different race and gender is highly unlikely though possible. The possibility of picturing a white male is aggressively high because we have automatically attributed a white person to be American even without mentioning the race in the statement. Why? Because the flooded ideas that associate these concepts together expressed by the mainstream media, books, movies, etc., all leave an imprint of that idea in your mind.

Mind bugs are perception shapeshifters (changers) that unconsciously control our mental activity without us knowing or giving full thought about them.

Mind bugs not only exist in instances of memory, but there are also social mind bugs, visual mind bugs (as in the case of the checkerboard by Ted Adelson), memory mind bugs where the brain creates false memories, sometimes in a desperate attempt to shield us from trauma or a false testimony given by a witness because of the mind. The mind sometimes automatically fills in the gap or gives a false recount or memory of what we perceive to have happen or what we saw in the past.

In an experiment held in the late 1970s by the American Symphony Orchestras, an attempt was made to show whether there were or were not biases in picking the members of their orchestras as the population consisted entirely of men. The experiment involved an audition for the position to join the orchestra, but during auditioning, they had to perform with a blind, like a curtain shielding the eyes from the performer. After the audition was carried out in this format, they noticed something interesting. The number of successful women in the audition increased by a whopping 50%. This experiment clearly showed that although the American symphony orchestra was looking for the best sound, the unconscious mind affected their decision to a large extent. The eyes sending signals to the brain because of the gender of the performer; even though their reflective mind had no bias against women and was ultimately still seeking the better sound, their unconscious (automatic) mind still rated the male higher than the women. To this day, American symphony orchestras use this method of shielding their vision during an audition to get into the program.

This experiment and many others prove how the eye unconsciously tells the mind how to react and how it can affect our decision-making.

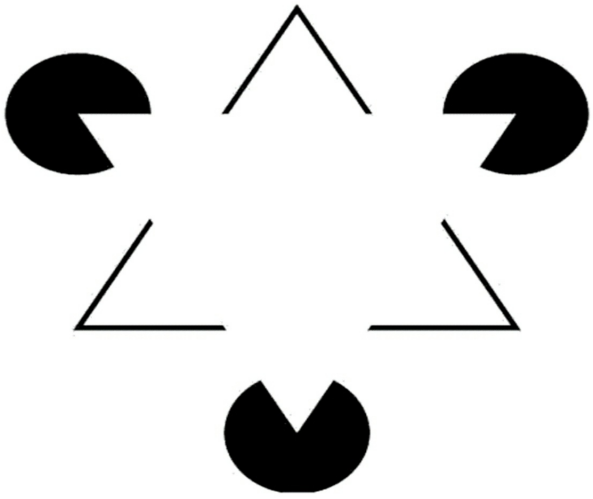
However, this is just an example of an area where visual mind bugs are pronounced. There are several other types, and I will be explaining them later in the next part of this chapter.

TYPES OF MIND BUGS

There are diverse ranges of mind bugs. However, the major categories they are grouped into are; virtual mind bugs, memory mind bugs, availability and anchoring of mind bugs, and social mind bugs.

VISUAL MINDBUGS

Visual mind bugs (as in the case of the American symphony orchestra) are visual illusions that often produce an error in the mind's ability to perceive objects as they are inherent habits of reasoning that lead to flaws in how



we see, remember, reason, and make judgments. Unconscious interference is a term coined by nineteenth-century German physicist and physiologist Hermann von Helmholtz to explain the visual illusions that the mind ascribes automatically and without conscious thought to create visual impressions such that even after finding out that our eyes have played tricks on us; we cannot convince ourselves otherwise.

An example of unconscious interference is the Kanizsa's triangle by Gaetano Kanizsa in 1976, which is an illusory contour. Although discovered by Friedrich Schumann in the twentieth century, illusory contour gained a resurgence in interest when the Kanizsa triangle was introduced in 1976 by Gaetano, an illusory contour or subjective contour.

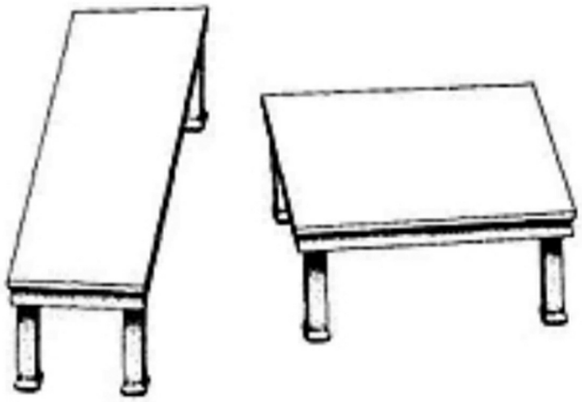
Looking at the Kanizsa triangle, your mind automatically creates a white triangle that is floating in the midst of the other separate fragments. The brain needs to make sense of the shape filling in the gaps like an incomplete puzzle.

This mechanism that produces the floating triangle exists to enable us to see and understand the world successfully.

Visual mind bugs are a form of unconscious interference that causes us to try to connect two or more things in relation to their shape, position, size, and other apparent qualities of those objects most times without positive or accurate results leading to a misunderstanding of what is supposed to be seen.

What unconscious interference does is that it makes you highly prone to being tricked by optical illusions. For instance, here are two tables that I want you to examine. Take your time to view it for as long as you want.

You will notice that these tables are not of the same size or shape. The table on the left is longer and will probably hold many more things than the one on the right. The one on the right is quite good, with a nice support system using sturdy legs. It can be used for a stool.



If that is what you thought, then you've fallen

prey to the visual illusion of the Shepard Tables.

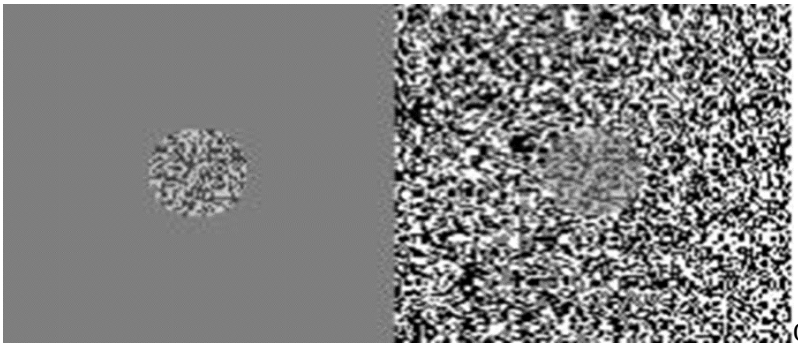
The Shepard tabletop illusion, also named Shepard Tables, refers to the optical illusion invented by an award-winning psychologist, Roger Shepard, a pioneer in research dealing with spatial relations. This illusion alongside others is included in Shepard's book 'Mind Sights: ambiguities, original visual illusions, and other anomalies, with a discourse on the play of mind in perception and art' which he published in 1990. He refers to this particular illusion as "Turning the tables." When Mr. Shepard was still active, he derived pleasure from tricking students, lecturers, and even professors with this illusion of his whenever he went for lectures in other universities (well, apart from the one where his tricks are well known and he is currently honored as Professor Emeritus - Stanford University). He always explains the concept of this trick, as you'll see in an example of a lecture he made at a leading university as a guest lecturer.

The image you saw on the previous page, the tables, of course, were displayed in a lecture hall by means of a projector. At first, there was silence as he took his time to look round the hall and appreciate its beauty. Many people would have concluded before he dropped his statement that dumbfounded them that those two tables were completely different. He then said that the tables are of the same shape and size, leaving everyone in the room apart from him to the mercy of their minds, apparently affected by a visual mind bug as they twisted and turned their heads to view it from a different perspective. It looked exactly the same as they had seen it previously. The table on the right still seemed shorter than the one on the left.

After a while, he went on to get a plastic sheet containing a red parallelogram. He then laid it on the table on the left, and the shape fitted perfectly. He turned the plastic sheet clockwise and fitted the red parallelogram on the second table. To the utter consternation of the people in the hall, it matched the table perfectly.

He explained that his tables are an optical illusion and that because they are not the traditional images that our brains have been trained to interpret, using the same method of interpretation on this image will lead to error. The visual mind bug causes this error that most of us are infected with.

Chouinard Phillipe, author of "The Psychology of seeing in autism," acknowledges that the Shepard's tables are among the most powerful optical illusions that exist. He claims that the apparent size difference/error in calculating the average human makes upon seeing the picture is between 20 to 25 percent. That shows us just how much error a visual mind bug can cause.

 Oh. If you think you've seen the best illusion of all time, check out this one where your mind bugs will blow you off balance. It's called the Chubb illusion, and error arises when you think that the two circles in the middle of the pictures you see are of different colors.

MEMORY MIND BUGS

Memory mind bugs occur in many instances of our human experiences, most commonly an illusion in terms of repetition of attributes belonging to a particular group or sharing a specific theme, false memories, etc. Psychology has shown that the brain, in an attempt to remember a large group of information, groups certain words together based on a theme creating a false memory of the concept. The mind automatically makes associations to things. When our minds come across new information like Hijab, Bible, Priest, Qur'an, Church, it automatically associates these concepts with 'religion'. When we try to remember the words sometime later, we use that shared theme as we try to remember the past.

We often connect certain words with some actions because we were first introduced to those actions or events with those words. For us to picture a mental image and make conclusions unconsciously based on the data we get from a certain stimulus, some information has to be stored in our brain continuously.

Professor Elizabeth Loftus, a leading expert in experimental psychology, does much research to study this particular mind bug in people. One of her famous studies involved using two sentences to test people's ability to link the severity of action to certain words they see. Procuring images from an accident scene where none of the victims sustained personal injuries, she showed them to eyewitnesses who volunteered to participate in her study.

She then proceeded to ask two questions, one different question for each candidate. "How fast was the vehicle moving when it hit the other car?" she asked some. And to others, the question they got was, "how fast was the car going when it smashed the other car?" Her results show that those who were asked the second question answered with higher speed estimates than those asked the first question.

Those who gave higher estimates did so because of the use of the word "smash" in the question they were asked. Though they witnessed the accident, they had unconsciously pictured an image of a hard collision with glass shards and pieces scattered everywhere, just as you may be doing right now.

Professor Loftus tagged this phenomenon as the 'misinformation effect.' It's rather catchier than what it's generally called by psychologists, retroactive interference- a conniving mind bug.

Retroactive interference refers to an effect caused by new or sudden information on memories stored in the brain.

This mind bug is more dangerous than it sounds. Because with the addition of little details that your mind absorbs from questions or prompts around you, memory can be tampered with, and you may end up unknowingly giving a false account of what you witnessed in person.

AVAILABILITY AND ANCHORING

Availability and anchoring are mind bugs that affect you and cause you to unconsciously correlate two completely unconnected figures.

Before I go further, I'd like you to take a little test.

Imagine the number 9. Put that number away now and try to predict the cost of buying a pair of scissors.

Imagine the number 89. As with the previous number, put that thought away. Now imagine the cost of buying a watermelon.

Lastly, imagine the number 1268. Erase that number from your mind's whiteboard. Now, what would it cost you to buy a pack of contour foam earplugs?

What are your answers? Do you notice that the cost of each of these items increased down your list? However, the price range of these products is the same. Why did you give these answers when you could have guessed with more precision how much these items cost. The answer is those numbers I asked you to think of before. However, I asked you to wipe them off. You didn't. You kept these numbers with the suspicion that I'd refer to them later. But I didn't; you did. You subconsciously connected the invisible dots between these numbers and the prices of these commodities, which led you to an overall erroneous conclusion.

Amos Tversky and Daniel Kahneman coined a term for this mind bug. They called it "anchoring heuristic."

Let's take another test, shall we? Ready? Try to empty your mind before this test and answer as quickly as possible.

Do more words exist with the letter 'R' in front than those with 'R' in the third position?

Your answer is probably yes. This is because the words that have r in them that you thought of are those words that begin with 'r' (for example, refer, rather, rabbit, raucous, ravage, etc.) However, your answer is wrong. There are actually more words with 'r' in the third position than those that begin with the letter 'r' (for example, fire, northern, world, purple, etc.)

Daniel Kahneman and Amos Tversky called this particular mind bug that makes you have this erroneous conclusion, "availability heuristic." These mind bugs affects most people. That it affects you doesn't make you less intelligent than another person. It just means that you have an utterly annoying mind bug that tends to create conclusions in

your subconscious.

SOCIAL MINDBUGS

We're down to the granddaddy of mind bugs- social mind bugs.

Imagine walking down an alley, and someone is walking right behind you with his or her face screwed up in anger. Let's say you were just coming back from the mall where you bought some things. This person currently following you was there too. This person bought eggs and milk, and you saw this same person check those things out by the counter. Meanwhile, you got two pairs of scissors and a paring knife. This person is approaching you very quickly now, and the person's mood doesn't seem to be getting any better. What do you do? You start to run, and the person's pace keeps increasing. You're glad you're out of the alley but what you see makes you completely ashamed for running. It's this same person running towards an Uber and arguing with the driver on why the vehicle wasn't parked in a place where it would be easier to reach and trace.

Let me start from here. Why did you imagine the Uber driver as a man? Because you saw 'he,' right? Check again. It isn't there! You've assigned this Uber driver a gender because of your stereotypical unconscious judgment. *Women can't be Uber drivers.* Now that you're thinking it out loud, you want to deny that you judged that way. You've been affected by a mind bug that I just pointed out —one of the subtlest of its kind.

Did you imagine the person following you as a black woman? Why did you do so? Because only black people follow shortcuts? Because only women buy eggs and milk from the mall? Why were you afraid when you were the one with the two potentially fatal wound-causing instruments? Because being chased by a potentially dangerous breed of human in an alley that has only two ways out, blinds you from understanding that you're the one that is capable of causing more harm.

Get out.

Get out!

Did you read, or hear in this case the second sentence louder than the first? Why? Because the exclamation mark you were introduced to as a kid is one that the teacher used to complement sentences, he or she raised his/her voice to pronounce. Those examples are stuck in your subconscious, and you use them as a basis for assessing other sentences with that punctuation mark.

When you were very little, the only difference between you and someone of a different race to you was probably your skin color. What then brought this unconscious bias that evaluates people of other races either favorably or unfavorably without any reason from the individual? It's the things you've grown up with. The stories you've been told, the books you've read, the movies you've watched, amongst other minor factors that have planted a virtual courtroom within your mind that you use to unconsciously assess all the individuals that you come in contact with.

Some stereotypes and biases are popular opinions based on unproven concepts that tend to stay in our memory. Think of a nurse. Why isn't the nurse a man? Because men don’t suit the job description? Think of a janitor. Why isn't this person female? It doesn't fit the job description, too, does it?

Someone went to a supermarket to get roll-on deodorant and hand moisturizers. This person left without paying. Like a mall cop, you went out to catch this person before they go too far. You successfully do so. Does this description- a black woman -match what's in your mind? If so, then you've been exposed to and infected with one of the worst forms of mind bugs, social mind bugs.

It is from these minor mind bugs that big issues spring up. Gender inequality stems from the mindset that women do not have the capacity to be as productive in society as men are, amongst many other related stereotypes. Racism and racial prejudice both at work and in the global society trace its root from the fact that people think of certain races in association with poverty, illiteracy, and criminality without bothering to find out more about the subject or rather object of this thought.

Let me ask two final questions. Why do you think Kiara DeShawn (a completely fictional name) is a dark-skinned female?

Which of these kinds of mind bugs do you think is the most dangerous?

Now that we understand mind bugs, let us identify our own unconscious biases.

Chapter 3 - Facing Our Demons: *Discovering Our Implicit Biases*

The human brain is a wonder on its own. The most complex series of cell structures that determine how a person lives is arguably considered the body's powerhouse. For example, the neurons responsible for conveying and absorbing neurotransmitters, chemicals that communicate information between brain cells, are a complicated series of cells that can take years to study.

There are lobes or partitions at a more significant level in the brain. Amongst these four distinctions of cerebral hemispheres in charge of variegated functions, the temporal lobe stands out, though anatomically and quite ironically, it resides at the rear extremities of the skull and even lies underneath other lobes. The human brain's temporal lobe is called the hippocampus and is responsible for long-term memory. This hippocampus initiates the interactions between consciousness and the unconscious memories stored in it.

Have you ever held a car key whose buttons used to have markings that have been erased by either rubbing off with constant use or dissolution in certain chemicals? You'll notice that among the black buttons, the red stands out. There's this feeling that makes you want to press it and at the same time warns you not to. Even though you may not know what its purpose is, especially when the key is not yours, there's this rush of excitement and sense of dread that seemingly overwhelms you when your finger is just above it. When your finger eventually comes down on that button, with enough force to hit the sensor upon which its purpose is dependent, your mind tells you that you've initiated an exciting action. The car's horn may probably blare automatically in calculated intervals in response to the alarm key that you just pressed.

However, the outcome of this decision to press this key is not what's going to be emphasized. It's the processes involved in linking previous subconscious memories that bring the rush of excitement and the conscious ones that determine whether you press the button or not that will be dwelt on.

For some reason, the human mind has associated the color red with danger. Scientists have tried to place this reason as the color of blood is red, indicating pain, death, or sacrifice. However, it is not relevant in all cases. Red is also viewed as the color of passion or love for reasons without scientific backup. Red, also used in warning alarms and police sirens, serves as a reminder that events out of the ordinary are occurring. In this case, research has shown that air molecules amongst the other colors least scatter red light. An old theory in psychology called mental association correlates to the subconscious adhesive that allows two groups to combine into one. Hearts & diamonds in a deck of cards have a mental association because they are both colored red. However, for most people, names and pleasant-meaning words have a mental association because the abstract quality of positive affinity stemming from the subconscious is mutual.

In the example mentioned previously, the agitation and apprehension attached to that button indicate a connection between the subconscious storage of information which concerns the color red, and the conscious activity pushing the button. This is all done within a short period ranging from milliseconds to a couple of minutes, depending on the individual. In some cases, the fear of pushing the button supersedes the thrill, prompting the option to leave the button untouched.

Suppressed information, called implicit memory, is stored in the hippocampus of every human dictate a lot of things that may skip one's notice.

Implicit memory is defined as memory stored in the temporal lobe that enables individuals to use previous memories, sentiments, and history about a particular thing or concept to evaluate people or things. Implicit memory is eponymous to its characteristic quality- being hidden and relatively unobtrusive. For good understanding, consider of it as a file on a computer's hard drive. Now, if that file is encrypted and kept in a hidden folder, you may not know it exists.

Sometimes, Implicit memories may not even be yours, but you possess them. When you read a book, you dive into the author's mind. This is the same with movies and audio publications. When you read, watch and listen to people's complaints about something, someone, or a group of people, some of this information is stored in your brain.

Among such information is, as we have treated in a former chapter, the preference of a specific race of people over

another without considering the apparent characteristics of both kinds and their similarities that are independent of their origins. We also saw how in organizations, employers try to put themselves in a position where their clients' race, gender, or sexual orientation does not matter to them. They want and most times attempt with sincerity to prioritize qualifications and productive capabilities of individuals as the criteria for employment into a given office over skin color, race, nationality, gender, and sexual orientation, amongst others.

However, most of them are infected with mind bugs – specific details connected with previous encounters, sentiments, and negative history saved in their temporal lobes –, and this affects their decisions without being noticed. It is similar to a virus in a computer that encrypts itself and goes unnoticed by the user. In the end, it causes damage that's quite hard to control when it manifests. Studies in recent times have proven that this factor, the seemingly unobtrusive mental embargo-implicit evaluation-is a major determinant that decides whether an employer employs a person or not.

Assessments that take place unconsciously in one's mind towards an attitude object or oneself are called Implicit evaluations. These evaluations are generally favorable or unfavorable and come about from various personal experiences.

The Implicit Association Test, IAT, was invented to detect these implicit sentiments in individuals who claim not to prefer one category of individuals over another and say so with "sincerity." Since its inception in 1994 by Anthony Greenwald, the IAT has been modified to include other tests that bring to light people's unconscious preferences and sentiments. Some of these tests include the Native-White American Implicit Association Test, Religions Implicit Association Test, Gender-career IAT, etc.

Project implicit is a non-profit body and multinational alliance between people involved in research united by the common interest of studying implicit social behavior and was launched in 1998 by Anthony Greenwald, Mahzarin Banaji, and Brian Nosek. Project implicit is currently run on the internet with implicit.harvard.edu as its official website, where people can take implicit association tests for free, irrespective of their race or class.

IMPLICIT ASSOCIATION TEST (IAT).

The IAT, as aforementioned, is an acronym for Implicit Association Test. Its inventor, Dr. Anthony Greenwald, a social psychologist, begun his award-winning work on this in 1994 to test the implicit behavior of individuals towards certain concepts. There are certain things that people fail to own up to when answering questionnaires. For example, for one to avoid being called racist or making himself look racist in a race preference test, he/she will avoid putting in answers that bring one to the conclusion that he prefers one specific race of individuals over another for reasons unknown even to the questioned. The IAT functions as a subtle method of bringing out those hidden details that explain individuals' behavior towards certain people.

The Implicit Association Test compromises simple tasks requiring individuals to sort out categories of items into pleasant and unpleasant items. The first of its kind was the flower-insect implicit association test, of which Dr. Greenwald himself was the first subject. It involved ticking or crossing out circles under two columns, "Flowers or pleasant words" and "insects or unpleasant words," with names of insects and flowers, one by each, between two circles (one on each side of the word). The instruction for this test was: "For flowers and words pleasant in meaning, mark in the circle to the left. For everything else (insects and unpleasant-meaning words), mark in the circle to the right. Record the time elapsed in seconds."

This instruction clarifies that the time taken to answer these questions helps in knowing the test results. The participant's speed in answering the question and the errors he/she makes constitute the criteria for determining the individual's preference for one category over another.

In that same year, Dr. Anthony Greenwald wrote the computer program for the test and tested it on other people with quite an impressive number of volunteers. Experiencing unprecedented success from the tests, he, alongside Mahzarin Banaji, likewise a leading psychologist, designed the Race Implicit Association Test. The new form of the test was developed with the hopes for the model to accurately measure one of the malignant, millennia-long menaces that affect the global society so badly today but in subtle proportions when compared to previous times racial prejudice.

The test involved sorting out words with unpleasant meanings with African-Americans and pleasant meaning words with European- Americans in the same order as the flower-insect test. However, in the second phase of the test, people were to match unpleasant words with European-Americans and words with pleasant meanings with African-

Americans.

Race IAT programs usually comprise a course of a heptad of tasks. The first of these seven tasks require a person to classify stimuli into two classes. For instance, a computer screen on which the word "Black" appears in the top left-hand corner and the word "White" appears in the top right-hand corner may be what an individual has to deal with. Mid-screen lies a word that is typically associated with either the categories of "White" or "Black," such as a person's first name. The individual taking the test is required to sort the word into the appropriate category by clicking the corresponding left-hand or right-hand button for each word displayed in the middle of the screen. The second task involves completing a similar classification course with some attributes. Switching sides, the word "Pleasant" may now be displayed in the top left-hand corner of the screen and the word "Unpleasant" at the screen's top right-hand corner, for instance. In the middle of the screen, a word would be displayed that was either acceptable or bad. Once more, the test subject would be required to categorize each word as either pleasant or unpleasant by clicking the suitable option. The test subjects were requested to perform a combined task on the third phase of the test, including the categories and attributes from the first two tasks. They follow the same order of being switched till it becomes an unpredictable pattern.

At the end of the test, the result of the assessment was based on the sum of the amount of time (in seconds) and the number of errors they made. If the test subjects, like the first test, were faster and made fewer mistakes in the first sheet than the second, results showed that they had automatic preferences for European-Americans to African-Americans.

The test was and still is a huge success given that people have been able to test themselves and make conscious efforts to adjust their preferences.

Classifications of Implicit Association Tests

IATs are classified into several groups; some of them include:

1. **Valence Implicit Association Tests (Valence IATs)**: Valence, also known as hedonic tone or emotional value, refers to a psychological term used to describe the ability of a person to react with another person or thing by attraction or the help of a function or ability. Positive valence attracts, and negative valence repels.

This type of IAT calculates links between theories and negative or positive valence. The test measures people's affinity for specific things or people related to certain concepts. For example, the Race IAT shows that many people prefer White/European-Americans to Black people even when results from straightforward questionnaires are quite different. The same goes with sexual orientation, as most people who take the Sexuality IATs show an implicit bias for straight people over people with differing sexualities such as heterosexuals, bisexuals, and homosexuals. Other examples of Valence IATs include the Arab-Muslim IAT and the Weight IAT.

2. **Stereotype IATs**: Stereotype Implicit Association Tests measure connections to which individuals hold on to familiar stereotypes. An example of this is the Gender-career IAT which has shown from general results that people associate men with being concerned about having jobs and being productive in them than having an interest in family matters and vice versa for women. Other stereotype implicit association tests include the Gender-science IAT, Native IAT, and Weapons IAT.

3. **Brief IATs:** BIATs, Brief Implicit Association Tests employs a method analogous to the general IAT but does not have as many classifications as the original. It comprises fewer tasks and fewer reiterations. A single aspect is specified rather than the usual multiple and the central theory of each task. The abeyance rather than accurately identifying the specific concept and characteristic demanded is used to assess the candidate and formulate the result.

4. **Self-esteem Implicit Association Tests**: This category of IATs measures the subconscious self-esteem of individuals by requiring them to match 'self' with either positive or negative words. Self-esteem, a psychological term, refers to measuring the value a person places on the subject of his/her worth, himself or herself. Of course, those who match 'themselves' with negative terms have results that show that they have implicit poor self-esteem that may most times manifest explicitly.

5. Other types of IATs include the **Go/No-go Association Tests**, **GNATs**, and **Child Implicit Association**

Test (Ch-IAT).

People do generally say that no man is an island and that one man's success depends on the subtle and not-so-subtle help of other individuals. The same is the case with the IATs. We have to give credit to other individuals who were involved in the invention of the various forms of IATs. Dr. Kenneth Clark with his wife Mamie Clark, brilliant American Psychologists of the civil-rights era, invented the "doll experiment" – an idea utilized, innovated, and modified to form the Valence IATs. I won't forget to mention Debbie McGhee and Jordan Schwartz, who, alongside Anthony Greenwald, introduced the Implicit Association Tests to scientific literature.

The test has now played significant roles in helping people recognize and admit their unconscious biases, making them conscious of the prejudices that exist within them. This is a huge step forward to overcoming implicit biases. You can never really overestimate the importance of discovering biases on your own.

How are these IATs important?

To aid your understanding of the importance of Implicit Application Tests, I'll give an example of Mr. Harding Blue (a fictional character for illustration), the Managing Director of a telecommunications firm in New York, whom I will refer to subsequently. Mr. Blue has been accused of being racist. Allegations that rose were from people who felt that Mr. Blue, an African-American, was biased in favor of the white people who applied for jobs at the firm. Mr. Blue, upon hearing these allegations, was delirious with laughter, given that the accusation was from people with whom he had the mutual similitude of skin color and race. He dismissed the thought while defending himself. "After all, any black person I did not hire wasn't qualified," he said to himself. Randomly surfing the net one day, Mr. Blue found the famous Implicit Association Test taken for free on implicit.harvard.edu. After reading a brief article on implicit attitudes, he decided to take the Race IAT. He was shocked by his results. "Your responses indicate a high preference for European-Americans over African Americans." He began to take active steps to tackle his mind bug previously unknown to him.

The following are benefits one gets from discovering biases on his/her own:

1. **It helps one accept the legitimacy of the accusation:** Biases are subtle. They are existent even when they seem not to be. In honesty, one may say that we do not prefer a particular race of individuals over another and that we view people of all races as equal. We might even be bent on that view and reject talks of ourselves being one-sided. However, the only way we can truly know how unbiased we are is to take a test that probes even the areas that we haven't examined. Places that ordinary questionnaires cannot bring to light.

Upon taking an IAT, individuals tend to accept that they are biased in some way when negative results come out. This is because they are the ones who took the test themselves in privacy and answered those questions as quickly as they could with what they knew. Please look at Mr. Blue's example above; one can barely imagine the shock on his face after seeing the test results. What made him accept the glaring truth was that he took the test independently with full privacy. People tend to realize just how bias they are when they take the IATs. Their slight hesitations and seemingly meaningless swift assessments before choosing their options come to mind and help them realize just how partial they are. As an employer in an organization, taking the IAT in whatever area you feel you're entirely impartial will help you understand how close/far from the truth you are about your sentiments.

2. **It helps you detect the areas you need to work on**: This is perhaps the most important reason for taking the bias test. Identifying the areas where you exercise prejudice subconsciously is vital to rectify them and making a change. With the privacy you're offered when you take the test, you are sure that only you see the results you get. With this mindset, you know that your weaknesses are confidential, giving you the motivation to work as hard as you can to tackle them. If, as a boss, you do not know which areas you have faults in, it will cause quite some problems in the long run. Taking the IATs helps you pinpoint with impressive accuracy the areas you have an implicit evaluation. Depending on how truthful you are when answering the questions When talking about secrets and the subconscious, published writer Bessel A. van der Kolk once said, "As long as you keep secrets and stifle information, you are essentially at war with yourself…The decisive issue is allowing yourself to know what you know. That takes an enormous amount of courage." Just like Mr. Blue, you can begin to take conscious steps to get rid of your unconscious bias, but this can only be possible when you're able to identify the areas you need to improve

upon. The IATs bring out those areas to the light.

3. **It helps one rectify mind bugs within oneself faster**: When individuals take the Implicit Association Tests, it enables them to identify areas where they have blind spots regarding certain factors. After identifying these areas of one-sidedness, your immediate goal should be to rectify this bias and restore the balance. Taking the tests on your own helps you to see how much you were unconsciously sentimental and help you plan on how quickly your attempts should be to amend the impropriety. If Mr. Blue, from our example, had spent more time justifying himself and being indifferent towards those accusations, he definitely would have made more mistakes. He would have assessed more people based on their race subconsciously before even interviewing them.

As a boss, the speed at which you rectify these blind spots cannot be overemphasized as it enables you to make better choices as more individuals with these factors approach your facility for employment. Opportunities arise spontaneously, and people are ever willing to take them up. How prepared are you to have a just and impartial mindset before making detailed assessments of who comes in through the door? How quickly do you need to work on your subconscious to amend the maladies? The IAT helps you know and budget how much time you should spend working on that area of subtle prejudice in your mind.

4. **It helps you appreciate a model for checking prejudice within yourself:** The IATs are modeled so that they provide accurate answers when the subject is completely honest when answering the tests. Knowing that you're getting real results helps you appreciate that you have a working model to assess yourself from time to time and help you impartially pattern your subconscious.

The bias test helps you see areas in which you can improve, making you a better person. If you own an establishment or you're a working member of a firm, taking regular Implicit Assessment Tests to constantly enhance your subconscious judgment system helps you be more productive and provide an enabling environment for those constantly prejudiced to yield better results. The more often you take these tests, the more they become part of your subconscious, and before you can even realize it, you have a counter-judging system within you that helps you avoid being racist in your decisions. You can imagine how thankful Mr. Blue felt when he took the test. He was happy because designed with such accuracy that gives honest answers are what the test subject provides, as one can rest assured of getting accurate results.

5. **It enables you to broaden your scope on the definitions of prejudice within your mind:** Workplace prejudice appears in diverse forms, one of which is depriving qualified individuals of certain privileges at work based on their skin color. But what about those who get maltreated and abused in their places of work because of factors such as their religion, their accent, their sexual orientation, skin type, etc. Taking the IATs helps you understand various other forms of unconscious bias to take radical steps to curb them if they are present in you. Perhaps as an employer, after taking the bias tests, you discover that you prefer light-skinned, American accented individuals over dark-skinned, native African, or African American accented ones despite their education level. You know exactly where you should work on and try to change.

However, they are areas that will skip your memory because they were never included on your acceptance list. You may be one that constantly verbally debunks the idea of maltreating homosexuals at work because of their sexual orientation. But you end up making jokes about them that are quite painful and justify your act like the boss; you add a “no offense” at the end of your joke. What you have done is that you’ve made someone the object of prejudice regardless of how productive the person is at work. It may not appear so at the moment because you all consider it as a “harmless joke”, but do you ALL really do? Taking up the IATs then, with its profoundly logical questions and enlightening inquiries, enables you to understand that prejudice at work is of different forms. Let’s suppose that Mr. Blue takes other forms of the Implicit Association Tests; he will have a broader understanding of the concept of workplace bias.

There you have it; for you to test yourself and identify your unconscious weaknesses, biases rather, it’s quite imperative that you take the Implicit Association Test as soon as possible. For a wide range of IATs that have proven to be of top-notch quality over the years, log on to implicit.harvard.edu and pick a test of your choice. Remember to make conscious efforts to tackle them as soon as possible to prevent yourself from being a propagator of racial prejudice in all aspects of society.

Chapter 4 - Behind Enemy Lines

At the close of this chapter, you should have gained a solid understanding of the antagonist of this adventure in preparation for the final battle in the next chapter. Let's begin.

Sometimes, our mind is split into either accepting or rejecting facets. Accepting in the sense that ideally, one may bear no prejudice towards the person that identifies as a member of a group and rejecting not consciously but by a stereotypical unconscious analysis of the individual, placing a rating score on them. Now, what exactly are these "groups" that we've been talking about?

Belonging to a Group – The Categorization of Human Society

Human society is built up of categories; people even wear signifiers like clothing to show that they belong to a particular class or niche in the society. People have the inherent desire to treat doctors and nurses in hospitals with respect as their dressing makes them stand out; we have that inherent idea to trust them with our life without even giving a single thought to it. Are they imposters? A Question like this barely comes to mind because of the idea we have imprinted in our minds; the same goes with law enforcement officers or lawyers and the likes.

In chapter two, we did a little experiment with the American driving home from work and how the brain automatically categorized 'Americans' as white because of the unconscious imprint of this in our mind's eye. Human society is grouped either by race, religion, gender, etc. These groups are still further subcategorized into other groups. The stereotypical belief that one holds in mind about a particular group can be the basis for bias, and shared interests in different categories are the theme and what enables people to be identified in one category, what separates one group from the other.

In the grouping of society based on race, a study has proven that individuals tend to trust or believe people or forgive people when they are of the same race as us, as shown by the classical conditioning experiment. We tend to be passive in our feelings to others that identify in the same group as we are than to others in a different group who may have committed the same offense. As such, it's in commonplace say that group identities also constitute unconscious bias towards members of the same group.

The brain also shows a clear distinction when we think about people with whom we identify and those we do not, recruiting a particular part of our brain when thinking about someone we identify with and another part of the brain when doing the opposite. How does an employer know he or she is not making an unconscious bias when hiring new workers?

STEREOTYPING

Psychology defines "stereotype" as the generalization of belief of a particular class of people. The word stereotype is derived from French and Greek words, which translates to "Solid impressions". The word was first used in 1798 in a printing trade by Firmin Didot. It was also used outside of printing in 1850 and used in a psychological sense in 1922. It involves attributing a particular behavior, characteristics, or ability of one person as a universal identity of all group members. Stereotyping helps humans to group people into "us" and "them". Stereotyping is a learned behavior, although it is tough to explicitly determine at the first instance where an individual learned a particular stereotype. It may range from learning from neighbors, friends, and family to a learned behavior from media outlets and society. The under presentation of certain minority groups in the media also promotes stereotyping or ultimately endorses stereotyping.

Stereotyping is grouped into implicit stereotypes and explicit stereotypes. Explicit biases are conscious beliefs or stereotypes a person is aware of and can deliberately use to judge people of different groups, while implicit stereotypes lie within the subconscious and pre-reflective. Individuals might not be aware that they hold such beliefs. In explicit bias, the individual is aware of his bias but may not express them publicly to paint himself positively in society.

Stereotyping may occur due to experience by an individual from a particular group and seen as a social construct to categorize people into groups, in groups, and outgroups.

CORRESPONDENCE BIAS

Coined by Lee Ross, correspondence bias is the tendency to underestimate the structural explanation of an individual's personality and overemphasize the person's behavior to their inherent personality. A typical example is when person A is pushed past by person B in a particular space, with person B not even apologizing and continues on his way. Person A automatically labels person B as a jerk, characterizing him on his personality alone without thinking that person B may be hurriedly rushing to the hospital as person B may have been called and told that his wife is in the labor room, hence prompting person B to act in that manner based on the situation. Correspondence bias can be seen every day in society and sometimes encouraged by our unconsciousness and, in turn, favor ourselves as we rate ourselves higher, believing we are not capable of such.

ILLUSORY CORRELATION

Illusory correlation occurs when we overestimate outcomes or events we easily recall and forget about or underemphasize the others. When a person of a certain ethnic or racial background is being arrested for a crime, you automatically assume everyone is likely to be involved in the same crime and ignore all the other people who did not get arrested. Another example of illusory correlation can be a case of a worker who is treated poorly by a person of a specific ethnicity. The worker then chooses to never work for a person of that ethnicity again, relating the person's behavior to his ethnicity.

There are many demonstrations of unconscious bias in our society today. Too many to even keep track of, but we will have to gain a more solid understanding of them all.

When an employer of a particular company is sorting through the qualified applicants to find the best person suited for the job, he/she tends to assume certain aspects about a person by merely looking at their pictures or names. A study once showed this correlation, as a question was asked to a sample of people where pictures of random people were given to them, and they were asked to identify if the person likes doing one particular activity over the other by mere looking at the faces given to them. Surprisingly, nobody chose to skip the seemingly impossible test by saying "I wouldn't know" or "I cannot tell'. Every participant seemed to already have a mental picture of what a person liked doing just by looking at their faces. This showed just how much our mind works and how biased it can be.

Many factors come into play whenever unconscious bias is mentioned, especially in workplaces. There are many common demonstrations of these prejudices and discriminations, could even be too many to identify them all. However, there are a few carried out every day around you, even earlier today or right now as you read this. At this juncture, we have already crossed the borders and are now headed deep into enemy lines as we treat the various discriminations that occur around us, with a special focus on our workplaces. This is aimed at pointing out the most common demonstrations of prejudices, especially in workplaces, so we can identify our faults in preparation for making efforts to eliminate these biases in the final chapter.

Hiring a person for a particular job is heavily influenced by the unconscious mind, and not many people realize that aside from the names and pictures, certain frivolous events, as little as weather, may also affect a person's decision to hire one or not. A study by Redelmeier and Baxter on medical school interviews in Canada at the University of Toronto showed that something as frivolous (in the context) as rainy weather could subconsciously affect the choice of who gets the job at the end of the day. The students who came in for the interviews on a sunny day instead of those that came in on rainy days surprisingly got a 10 percent score difference than those that came in on rainy days. With such clear statistical inference, is it right to say that the interviewers decided consciously to reduce the scores of the students that came in on rainy days? Clearly, there was an unconscious factor that played in the grading.

Why does a pro-gay activist or a feminist, or a person with no conscious prejudice towards other races, take the IAT tests and still show unconscious support for the opposite of what they stand for. It is safe to say that this is because they belong to a race that condemned such beliefs years ago. This has made some rating them as an abomination.

While one may not choose or believe that they harbor these thoughts, what leads them to take the IAT, and does it reveal the unconscious? It also begs the question, is an egalitarian who 'failed' the test racist? Or does a pro-gay activist have a deep-rooted bias for the movement he or she stands for?

Society has imbibed specific attributes to certain things as standard or normative that it imprints in the brain, and it's believed to be normative. An example is the portrayal of older people as always having poor or failing health, being sad, grumpy, suffering from loneliness, have weak bodies, diminished sensory capacity, etc. These attributes register as unconscious mental contents and bring about unconscious bias to the old and showing favoritism to the young. Everyone loves grandparents, from their leniency to their loving nature. It's hard to imagine a bias towards the older

people, but with the IAT, there has been proof showing large ageism hidden in the unconscious mind of the majority of people because of the social and cultural portrayal of the old despite having absolutely no prejudice to our grandparents or great grandparents.

The IAT showed that this ageism doesn't only affect the young; it also affects the old. One study shows that even when older people who have grown into their 50s take the IAT, the result shows that they have a bias about themselves, still favoring the young because of the imprint that young automatically means healthy and strong.

However, ageism in the workplace does not only affect the old to some extent; it affects the young also, but most times, the old are the primary receivers of this unconscious discrimination. Although most organizations at the forefront are always speaking about the lack of ageism in their workplace, the unconscious mind, as we have seen from the previous chapters, still affects our decisions more than we can imagine. Examples of unconscious biases in the workplace to the old include being left out of client meetings unconsciously or being overlooked when giving promotions as they may be an age-based description or, rather, unconscious discrimination. For this, challenging tasks may not be passed to some older workers because, unconsciously, they might think they would not be able to handle them.

This bias, as stated earlier, doesn't only affect the old with the notion imprinted in the minds of people that younger people are automatically stronger and more capable, more challenging assignments as well as the idea that they automatically can work harder so they may not be fully entitled to time off. They also might involve them in learning programs when new strategies to work or tackle their assignments are introduced as the employers may unconsciously think that their minds are more reliant to grasp further information.

Unconscious racial bias in the workplace commonly occurs as microaggressions amidst other forms such as affinity biases, confirmation biases, and name bias, with these biases often negatively impact any minority group in the workplace. Racial stereotypes are notions that all members of the same race share given characteristics. These characteristics are usually negative and barely positive. People may possess unconscious or conscious racial stereotypes, and this can cause impartial decisions about certain minority groups. Negative stereotypes that exist can substantially impact how people behave towards the stereotyped groups or races. When a person has the notion that members of a particular race consistently exhibit negative social behavior, e.g. crime, terrorism, etc., the person tends to consciously or unconsciously see everyone in that group or race as tending to exhibit such crime, consequentially producing prejudiced mental affiliations with such groups.

Racial stereotypes in a person can be influenced by friends, media, parents, curriculum, and general activities carried out by members of a selected sect. These influences create a racial image in a person's mind. In a sociology journal, research conducted by Malkovich asked children to describe a racial group by describing at least five traits of each group. The responses given stereotyped whites to be materialistic and pleasure-loving; blacks to be musical, aggressive, and straightforward; and Japanese as industrious, ambitious, loyal to family, and quiet. These mental affiliations may have been influenced by the above factors that have painted a picture and tinted their minds throughout their lives.

The racial stereotyping of criminals has also been a sad feature in most cultures, especially the American culture. Young black males are usually stereotyped and linked to criminal cases or activities. Researchers have also shown that this common stereotype has erroneously served as the basis for racial profiling by some criminal justice practitioners in some States.

Microaggressions mainly occur after the person has been hired and has started work already. They can come from any one of the co-workers or the employer unconsciously at the time of hiring. Microaggressions are comments or behaviors that may be deliberate or accidental and sometimes well-meaning with no intention of harm but negatively targets the receiver of the words. For example, an Asian-American being asked if "he is from here" because the individual is not white. Although the person asking may say this with no ill intent, the Asian-American might feel singled out because he or she is not the typical white. Even in most cases where they reply to the question that they are from America, they still bear that confused, skeptical look on their faces. To make it worse, some people even ask the question over again.

Also, in workplaces, interviewers are always prone to ask Black males if they have any criminal records while tending to ignore that for Whites. Most times, these may be honest questions, but there is still that tendency of the question being provoked unconsciously from the mindset and beliefs of the interviewer and the society at large at that.

Other microaggressions in the workplace involve telling people that they speak a certain way (which you had not quite expected) because of how they look. You perceive them to speak or act a certain way because of the stereotypical analysis that has been imprinted in your mind on a certain group. When a white co-worker tells a colleague, who is a person of color that they speak so well is one of the most common microaggressions in the workplace. They may mean well, but such statements could end up implying that they had automatically assumed that the person of color was not articulate or less articulate than they are, before they finally heard them speak.

Pointing out that a worker's name is hard to pronounce is also a form of microaggression. It is actually implying that the person's culture is so small and not important, and there is no need to try to learn the name in the first place. Asking about the hair of an African American is another racially-based unconscious bias that occurs extensively in workplaces. Some people automatically conclude that African-Americans are 'unprofessional' or 'distracting' because they have unconsciously emphasized how a workplace environment should be, barely ever factoring in the African-Americans.

What about when it comes to job interviews? Do we as employers unconsciously subscribe to an underlying belief or stereotype when employing? And do these beliefs affect our decision-making on whom to hire? The answer is Yes. The first instance is the affinity bias, where the employer automatically connects with people sharing the same background or interest as they may have, who they believe will get along with them better. The affinity bias works in favor of people in the same race as the employer and possibly the same gender.

The equality act 2010 shields against harassment, discrimination, and victimization based on protected characteristics. There are protected characteristics, and religion or belief is one of them. The equality act protects against discrimination because you are of a particular religion or hold a philosophical idea. However, discrimination against people still occurs, and even more prevalent in the media is the discrimination in the workplace. This may be in the form of indirect discrimination, such as the requirement of employees to dress in a particular way or prohibition from wearing a certain type of clothing regarded as part of their faith. However, it is not discrimination if they have to wear safety gadgets, and they may be a need to take off their religious or faith-based clothing.

An approximate 25% of Muslim physicians have experienced bias against them in the workplace, where they have been maltreated because of their religious affiliations. Religious bias is an unfair or indifferent treatment of a person because of their religion. 75% of the Jewish citizens surveyed noted being called an offensive name. Muslims who wear hijab and other faiths identified by certain aspects, be it clothing or symbols, are subject to this bias because people automatically know their religious affiliations.

People tend to have an irrational fear or prejudice towards Muslims, which may be implicit or explicit. They have labeled Muslims as non-belonging and associated the group with acts of violence, terrorism, and being cold. On average, Muslim women receive a lesser call back to job interviews than other religions.

Religious discrimination doesn't only exist against Muslims but also other religions. In most cases, when a person of a particular religion prays in public, people tend to have unconscious negative ideas about them automatically.

Discrimination against Jews when they take a Friday afternoon off work to prepare for Sabbath, a condition that the employer and employee may have agreed beforehand, but after hiring the worker, the employer adjusts the working schedule believing that the work should come first.

People in a particular religious group also prefer to identify with one another more than with others. Also, when there is a portrayal of our religion in the media, we unconsciously pay more attention to the information disseminated than when the info is on other groups or religions.

Confirmation bias is also a huge factor in unconscious prejudice; we earlier treated how the employer automatically subscribes to a belief or unconscious racial prejudice on why the candidate will not fit in the job and look for confirmations to prove their assumptions during the interview. This prejudice can be unconsciously subscribed to the back of our mind, and we wouldn't even know that we are searching for something to confirm that prejudice when the job applicant is being interviewed. In most cases, even when the employer fails to get such confirmation, they are still less likely to offer them the job. I brought back this idea because it is crucial and common when most of the demonstrations above are displayed by an interviewer. This means that if an interviewer is to hold any of these beliefs about age, gender, religion, etc., against a candidate, he will most likely try to dig up proofs to back up his prejudiced views.

Another type of bias is the name bias, which is one of the most common types of work bias. When someone sees a

name, and it seems to be challenging to pronounce, there is a huge possibility that their CV will get skipped. It's very unfair when job applications are ignored just by merely looking at the applicant's name without even considering the other skills or educational qualifications they might possess, just because the employer finds the name difficult to pronounce. When these names are skipped, it's safe to say that the employer is opting for familiarity when they go through the resumes.

For a fact, one study dedicated to proving this notion shows that African-Americans are 50% less likely to get callbacks than their white counterparts, even though they send about 60% more job applications. Also, applicants having Asian last names suffer worse, as they are 28% less likely to get callbacks than their white counterparts. The name alone gives rise to an affinity bias for the other candidates. Even if they get callbacks, they also have the confirmation bias of the employer to deal with because of the unconscious judgment or prejudice held in the employer's mind.

Gender bias demonstrates implicit and explicit bias, which we can not ignore. "He hits like a girl" – one of the most common stereotypes used in our society, although it may seem harmless. However, it still subscribes to the idea that all women are automatically or predisposed to be weaker in strength than their male counterparts. This is a classic case of stereotype – generalizing the belief that all women are the same despite clear distinctions that not all women are equal or identical, and the same goes for the men.

Research has shown that gender stereotypes or at least some primary evidence of a difference in sex and activities occur as early as three years of age. A study showed that children are rudimentarily biased towards members of the same gender. Children make use of gender stereotypes to make a judgment on others. In a recent study, three-year-old boys and girls were seated, and a video was played to them; one boy in the video said, 'My name is Ben', I like Spoodles. Spoodles is my favorite thing to eat!' The girl in the video also said: 'My name is Betsy; I like blickets, blickets are my favorite thing to eat!' Next, an experimenter went on to ask the children what they would like to eat? If they would prefer Spoodles or blickets. It was realized at the end of the experiment that boys chose the item Ben picked 65% of the time, and the girls chose the item Betsy chose 85% of the time. This experiment proves the automatic unconscious rudimentary identification with members of the same gender. The investigation also attempted to find out the reason for this performance, and it was discovered that it was beyond the awareness of the child. The children were asked their reason for preferring one of the snacks to the other, and they commonly answered, 'I don't know or because I liked it.'

At a young age, we all unconsciously need to identify with a particular group. Gender stereotypes tend to portray men as competitive and goal-driven and assertive and assured, while women are portrayed to be emotional, caring, and amenable. This portrayal of women relegates them towards family and home. It is harder to persuade people that women are best suited for certain careers and managerial opportunities. Whenever a person thinks about a career, say, an engineer, doctor, mason, pilot, etc., the mind automatically pictures a man occupying that position. However, the assumption is wholeheartedly unconscious. Society's portrayal of this role is spear-headed by men. Then, some statistics actually show the larger percentage of some of this occupation occupied by men.

Gender bias is one of the most talked-about types of biases in all walks of life. The primary effects of gender bias are more on women and girls because of society's imprint or portrayal of women in culture for a long time. In recent times, there have been massive movements to raise awareness on the biases that women have to face every day, with active feminists heavily trying to advocate for women their rightful and equal place in society. But because of our inherent unconscious bias, the mind still shows an archaic method of classification where the women should take the family roles, leaving men better suited for most careers. The gender-career IAT test data once showed that 75% of men still believe unconsciously that women should assume family roles while men are best suited for careers. The data also showed that 80% of women also share this prejudice.

Aside from actual reflective conscious bias against women, the unconscious mind, even for people who are forward and promote gender equality, still may unconsciously affect their decisions in, say, job opportunities. According to recent studies, less than 7% of CEOs in Europe and the United States are women. But some employers still fail to recognize their own bias when hiring. This has been proven by studies that have shown that traits assigned to leaders are stereotypically male behaviors, therefore when employers are hiring or giving a promotion or offering a position, they unconsciously are looking for such male behaviors which they unconsciously believe that they would not be able to find in most women employed there. This may be one reason for the statistics of the CEOs in the US and Europe.

Other stats show that 50% of men in companies believe that women are represented equally when 90% of the senior leaders are men. However, both men and women are twice as likely to hire a male candidate than a female, and there is a 30% likelihood of men getting managerial positions as opposed to their female counterparts. It's evident that there is a gaping bias against women in the workforce.

Bias exists inherently in workplaces, even though gender equality is the main goal for businesses and organizations in the modern world today. Nevertheless, our minds have proven to be a setback to achieving a totally unbiased work environment because it is not easy to de-bias the mind. A business review by Harvard also revealed an inherent bias performance evaluation when they analyzed a review of an employee even when companies attempt to be unbiased by making the assessment open-ended.

Some workplaces unconsciously deter female applicants by adding unnecessary and random qualifications. They may not even know that their goal is to weed out the women from applying by making the job description more form-fitting to a man than to a woman. Also, preference of male leadership skills unconsciously may lead the employer to question the woman's ability to lead and may already have a prejudice towards the women applying for the role.

What about the pay? In recent times, women have been a pushed effort to earn equally as men in the same field or position but do this hold through? As stated earlier, though thoroughly qualified, women are barely given the same position or ranking as their male counterparts. The employers most times believe a promotion should go to the male counterparts, thinking that they will be better equipped for the job. The makes the women to be pushed to the lower levels of the job. A further study proves this as it shows that the median salary for men is still 18% higher than for women.

It is safe to say that this bias against women and people belonging to outgroups may be unconscious, just like in the American symphony audition experiment where they never actually knew they were unconsciously biased until the performers started auditioning behind blinds. They trusted their ears to judge and, in turn seeing a 50% increase in women in the orchestra. And how they never knew the eyes had programmed the mind to be automatically biased against the women because of their gender.

Mechanisms like the American symphony audition have been put in place and have ensured gender equality in the American symphony orchestra, and such auditioning method is still used up to the present. Also, optimistically, we have treated how the Harvard gender IAT tests have shown the gradual decline of the unconscious association of males to be best suited for careers and women suited for a home with hopes of total eradication of that unconscious thought in the future.

However, there are still other methods that we can all use to make necessary adjustments and efforts to play our part in the eradication of our enemy – prejudices. This, we shall discuss in the next chapter.

Chapter 5 - Slaying the Beast: *Ways of Eliminating Unconscious Biases*

Implicit attitudes or biases are hard to tackle when one does not have the right tools to do so. If your approach towards unconscious biases is the same as the one you make towards your typical everyday problems, you may not be able to handle them effectively. When you have a pimple on your face, you squeeze it, and the pus comes out, or you just apply pimple cream, issue solved. However, when you are dealing with large cysts under your skin, you will have to visit a dermatologist who will then carry out a surgical procedure in order to get rid of it. Surgeries require caution and precision to be effective and innocuous in the long run. This is why they are carried out by trained professionals.

The same applies to unconscious biases. For one to be able to effectively tackle them, he or she must employ appropriate systems to rectify them.

How do we overcome unconscious bias?

Two main strategies are employed when trying to regulate and effectively curb negative implicit attitudes. They are:

- Change-based adjustments
- Control-based adjustments

Change-based adjustments, as the name implies, refer to interventions targeted at overcoming your implicit attitudes. This method of approach involves you taking steps to completely eradicate your unconscious biases by adopting and implementing new behaviors that replace your implicit ones.

Control-based adjustments, on the other hand, are aimed at accepting the fact that negative biases are planted in your subconscious. Upon accepting them, your major aim should be to-with full consciousness-not allow these implicit attitudes to have effects on your way of life.

Below are some ways you can effectively eliminate or neutralize unconscious biases with both change-based adjustments and control-based adjustments.

1. **Accepting the fact that you have an implicit attitude:** Being conscious of the fact that you have a mind bug is a vital step you need to take to curb implicit evaluations in your mind. When you acknowledge, after taking an Implicit Association Test, an IAT, and the results show that you express bias in some form- that you implicitly evaluate people based on certain information stored in your subconscious- you can then take steps to control it. "You can't change what you don't acknowledge." This is a quote from Dr. Phil Mcgraw, renowned psychologist and reality talk show host. From his many years of experience, Dr. Phil acknowledges the fact that unless people come to terms with their problems, there is no way that they can rectify them.

Let us make use of time travel in this adventure of ours as we bring back an example from chapter three. The subject is our very own Mr. Harding Blue of a telecommunications firm in New York. Mr. Blue would never have been able to start working on changing his attitude towards his workers and potential employees if he hadn't acknowledged the fact that he had an implicit bias system in his mind. He was only able to come to terms with this mind bug of his when he took the IATs. With that, he was able to identify the various areas where he wasn't completely sincere in his evaluations.

The same applies to you if you actually are willing to get rid of blind spots and mind bugs within you. So, after taking the IAT, the first thing on your mind should be the acknowledgment of the reality that the results are accurate and are based on the information you inputted and how honest you were taking the test.

There's no possible way you can start working to eradicate something that you have no knowledge of. It's just like when you're using a laptop without an antivirus. When a virus infects the device and encrypts itself, there's no way that you can know about it, talk more of trying to get rid of it. Upon the installation of an antivirus similar to the taking of an IAT, you get to realize that viruses exist in your laptop, analogous to mind bugs. It is when you can identify and acknowledge these mind bugs, just like viruses, that you can begin to take measures to control them.

2. **Contravene the negative pattern:** One of the most important methods of neutralizing unconscious biases in your workplace is to contravening the pattern of stereotyping a particular race or group of people. This contravention starts in your own mind. It is necessary that you consciously start to delete such information by replacing them with actual and verified erudition. Get new facts about the subjects of your implicit evaluations. Getting information about stereotyped individuals that bring to light how similar to everyone, you inclusive, they are and how ostracizing them is wrong is what you should do. From there, you can begin to study materials like that as often as you can to solidify them in your subconscious. This method of information replacement works best if you practice it very often. The more you study how completely wrong your unconscious bias is, the more knowledge you'll have to replace it. For example, imagine you have about a quarter of a liter of black paint in a bucket. When you add the same quantity of white to it, there's a slight difference. You'll notice that the color you have is a dark shade of grey. If you add another quarter-liter of white, you'll get a lighter shade. And when you keep adding white continuously, there'll be a point where you'll get a pure white consistency from the bucket. What I'm trying to bring out from this illustration is this. To change the unconscious pattern of your

mindset or to neutralize your unconscious bias, you'll have to take in much more positive and truthful information regarding the unfavorably biased than what you think you know about them. When you reach the point where you have enough categorical information concerning the subjects of your implicit attitude evaluations, you'll notice that the negative data stored in your subconscious will be completely gone. As this is a change-based adjustment, it may take a while to do this. Change-based adjustments are the hardest to initiate and continue with, even when trying to apply them in other aspects of life. It was Lady Mary Wollstonecraft Shelley, published author of the 19th century, who said this about the difficulties experienced with making alterations- "Nothing is so painful to the human mind as a great and sudden change."

Take a look at this. She said, "nothing is so painful…as a great and sudden change" to what? The body? No! To the mind. You must buckle up for a gruesome and painstaking process, as trying to change your subconscious is a process that will require discipline and determination from you. As all hard things are, in the end, the reward will be worth the effort.

3. **Spend time associating with the affected bunch:** As a boss or worker in an organization, one of the conscious steps you can take towards eradicating workplace prejudice is associating with the affected group more often. Make them feel involved and among without having any doubt as to whether they're being maltreated. Try inviting them, not only for conferences and corporate events but for simpler things like lunch at a restaurant down the block during a break. You can never underestimate the importance of socializing with people that are prone to be ostracized and stereotyped. Become their friends. From time to time, try to ask them questions that do not relate to work. Ask about their welfare at home. Simple inquiries like "how are the kids today?", "I hope Nana's fine. Have you taken her to the care center this morning?" help to solidify the bonds that you're trying to create with them. However, in your process of consciously taking active steps to curb the implicit ostracizing of stereotyped individuals, you have to construct certain limitations. You must establish these boundaries because when you spend too much time focusing on socializing, you tend to have reduced efficiency and get distracted while postponing some on-the-job activities that you need to do. This does not necessarily mean that you cannot maintain a healthy relationship with your teammates and coworkers. It just means that you set limitations regarding certain things like how often and when you have conversations that do not relate to work. You can do this by planning when to interact with them on free periods such as lunch breaks. But one rule regarding this is that you must, and never forget this, desist from gossiping on the job. Also, try as much as possible to have your discussions with them in person to avoid constantly texting, which is a huge distraction from work.

During conferences and workshops that involve taking trips from your working station and some of these individuals come along, you can also make time to interact with them. After training and plenary sessions, you can take them out for a tour of the city that's hosting the event. During these tours, try to engage them in conversations about their work prospects and areas that they feel they have issues with at work. By doing this, you'll create an enabling environment for them to speak up about their work prospects and productivity goals while making them feel among.

4. **Avoid making decisions based on a 'hunch':** Your critical and instantaneous perception of something is called your gut instinct or intuition. It grows as you grow. As you meet new things daily, your gut instinct increases till it reaches a point where, if you don't have an erudition about something, it may make you conclude certain things about it, whether positive or negative. Your gut instinct makes you think like *"do I need to think over this? No other opinion matters. It's quite plain to me, I know about this, and I'm going to take a step."* Your gut instinct is felt inside you alone; no one else can experience your gut feeling apart from you. People may have a similar intuition, but yours is peculiar, and because of this, there's no other person that can know and tell you if you're following your instincts or not. You are the only one who can latch on to your instincts. It's a popular belief that the peak of self-trust is trusting your intuition. Steve Jobs once said, "You cannot link the dots looking forward; all you can do is connect them looking backwards. You need to trust that the dots will somehow relate in your future… this strategy has never me down, and it has made all the difference in my life." You see all that I've written concerning trusting your intuition, package them in a mental box, and seal it. Don't seal it too tightly, though; you'll need it for certain aspects of your life.

But when you're dealing with unconscious biases, you'll have to forsake all your hunches and deal based on facts rather than logic. There are two means you can deal with your presuppositions. You can either change them or control them. I'm saying that dealing with your gut instinct can be done as a change-based adjustment or a control-based adjustment.

As I mentioned in the previous point, the change-based adjustment method involves replacing your assumptions with pure reason. What assumptions do is that they make you feel like you have a complete and veracious comprehension of the subject matter, in this case, the objects of workplace bias and stereotyping. Each day, we make many useful and important assumptions to make things go smoothly. However, when prioritized over knowledge, assumptions make you take extreme risks as they may be false. And of course, as you must have noticed by now, it causes many issues at work, damages relationships and even potential ones. Knowing this, you should take active steps to replace your assumptions, presuppositions, and gut instincts with factual information. Rather than think with what you feel is right, think with what you know is right. This will guide you to make the right decisions and relate with your co-workers better.

The control-based approach requires you to control the areas you allow your gut instincts to make decisions for you. Use your intuition on other things, for example, selecting some clothes, picking items at the mall, etc. But when you're dealing with your co-workers who are the objects of unconscious bias, do not use them at all. This method works when you cannot take the time and effort to replace your assumptions with actual knowledge. You can combine both approaches, though.

5. **Don't be too proud to say sorry:** If you vehemently rejected the fact that you were biased when your co-workers or employees pointed it out to you and you suddenly found out they were right when you took the Implicit Association Test, you'll have to apologize to them. This sounds easy but is extremely difficult to do for most people. Some people think that apologizing is a sign of weakness. Although this is predominant with men, it affects women also. When you're dealing with an unconscious bias, for example, one that involves gender-career stereotypes, you implicitly feel that certain people do not have the qualifications to work where you work because of their sex. You think you are more efficient than they are at work because the job was not designed. For instance, let's say you're a female worker in a soap manufacturing plant; you may feel that the men who work in your line of service – say packaging – are not supposed to work there, that the work requires effeminacy. What you've done is that you've reasoned based on a stereotype.

From a different angle, some male doctors, when they see that there are female doctors around, get disturbed subconsciously because they feel that they should be nurses and that being a doctor is a manly task. Like in the previous example, your thoughts are more stereotyped than you think.

Making amends requires you to lay aside your haughtiness for you to own up to your imperfections. Most people feel exposed and defenseless doing this. This is because they think that apologizing makes them declare that they are not perfect and have flaws that can be criticized. This leads to making many excuses and blaming others for their mistakes. And because some people are used to blaming others, apologizing becomes seemingly impossible.

Another hindrance that may make you not want to apologize to the object of your subconscious prejudice is your feeling that they'll imagine you as weak and tenderhearted. And that your co-workers of the same sex, who may find out, will make fun of you and ostracize you. It's evidence that you care more about people's evaluation of you than you care about your wrong implicit evaluation of them. Change should begin with you. Saying you're sorry for the emotional damage you caused to the unfavorably biased is not a sign of weakness; it's a sign of strength. The strength comes from a determined mental attitude to fix what's wrong. Own up to your mistake and apologize to the people you've offended by your judgments. By doing this, you'll create a platform for establishing a relationship between you and the person or people at work. They will know that you're taking conscious steps to rectify your unconscious biases and not only appreciate it but accept you with glee.

6. **Configure the basis for making your decisions**: Constructing the basis for making your decisions requires you to plan out and outline certain factors that constitute the backbone of your selections. This is a point that applies primarily to employers. When you implicitly judge people based on certain factors

that do not affect their productivity at work, such as gender, religion, and gender orientation, among others, you do so ignore the fact that you should have a reasonable basis for selecting them. Daniel Kahneman, Nobel Prize winner in Behavioral Economics, states concerning hiring biases - "We cherish or dislike people even before you know about them; we esteem or distrust strangers even without knowing why; Whether you declare them or not, you oftentimes have answers to questions that you do not completely understand, relying on evidence that you can neither defend nor explain".

Outlining the requirements that potential employees will have to possess is an important step you need to take to neutralize implicit biases within yourself. This is Management 101 stuff.

There are specific things you can look out for in prospective employees. Experience, valuable work traits, dexterity, and level of education are examples of job requirements. Once you, as an employer, have these things in mind, it will be easier for you to make unbiased decisions on whom to employ and whom you shouldn't.

When you fail to set aside and perfectly outline your requirements for hiring someone, you tend to promote your implicit evaluations during interviews. For example, when you have an unconscious gender bias, you tend to correlate a particular office in your organization to a specific gender. When people apply for a particular position because you have already unconsciously specified the gender for that role, no matter how qualified someone of the opposite gender is, you will find it difficult and even impossible to employ that person. In other cases, you may want to hire candidates who are of the same gender as you because you feel that it will be easier for you to associate with them. When you do that, you have completely ignored the job requirements you were supposed to follow. This means that using job requirements as a standard for employing candidates is just as important as outlining them.

7. **Make yourself imperceptive towards your biases**: When you acknowledge that you have a bias or biases, you should blind yourself towards them if you are determined to stop them. You can never overestimate the value attached to this particular method. Most children are color blind when it comes to race. I once read an article about two toddlers. One was from an African American family, and the other was a White American. Completely unplanned, they wore the same color of striped shirts and denim jeans that day. Excited, the white kid screamed, ran towards the black American child, and engulfed him in a warm embrace. He then called out to his mother. "Mommy, I just found my twin! We look the same!" He kept repeating this, and the adults around them were brought to eye-watering heaps of adoration for these youngsters who were completely imperceptive of the color of their skins.

You should possess this attitude towards your co-workers and your employees. When dealing with them, do so as you would with yourself or someone close to you. Someone you do not regard as a stranger, a criminal, or someone incapable of being productive than your implicit evaluations implies.

As an employer, analyzing a candidate's qualifications imperceptibly refers to discarding factors that could potentially make you take wrong decisions based on stereotypes. An approach towards this is imagining that the people you're interviewing possess the same qualities as those you unconsciously favor. Better still, imagine all your candidates as having transparent skins where their qualifications become the most important things to you.

Being biased doesn't only involve you implicitly thinking of one person's skin color as being his reason for incompetence. It also involves you subconsciously criticizing other things such as gender. When you make yourself completely unaware of the gender of your co-workers and employees, you'll realize that you create a suitable environment for them to be as productive as they can without feeling left out or ignored at work. The same applies to when you're interviewing candidates that applied for a position. Think of all sexes as equal and, if they possess the requirements for working there, as equally capable of being productive.

8. **Speak up against bias and stereotyping when you notice it in your workplace**: Taking a stand against something pervasive can be risky at times. This is because you don't know how they'll react to someone being completely different about something they do. Biases have quite devastating effects in the workplace. Talented individuals often get left out when employers possess an implicit evaluation system; workers aren't given equal opportunities to work and be productive. People who are truly desperate to make positive changes and be influential at work become ostracized and, as a result, unproductive. It is up

to you to take the risk and stand for what's right. Let your voice be heard on workplace bias when you notice it. Become an example that people will refer to when talking about those who made a difference. These occasions present themselves in form of meetings and conferences. Raise your hand when the opportunity is given to outline issues that affect productivity at work and say your mind concerning the issue. As a boss or manager, make it plain to your team that you do not tolerate it when a member of the organization is ostracized based on a stereotype. This is an active step to curb unconscious bias at work.

Suzy Kassem says this in her book 'Rise Up and Salute the Sun: "*Our liberties are fading. If you do not take a stand now against all that wrongs while you can, then one of your children may choose to do so in the future when it will be considerably riskier — and much harder.*"

9. **Creating awareness about unconscious biases**: A very vital step in neutralizing unconscious biases is to create awareness on the matter. John Dewey, the father of experimentalism philosophy, once said that "a problem well stated is a problem half solved." This rings true for unconscious biases. In your workplace, you should endeavor to create awareness on the issue of implicit evaluations. You can do this by making presentations, circulating articles that provide erudition on the subject of unconscious biases. Encourage your coworkers and teammates to take the Implicit Association Test. By doing that, they'll be exposed to their own biases and actively take steps to eliminate them. As a boss, organize workshops and plan a curriculum that will enable you to exhaustively explain what unconscious biases are, their negative impacts, ways they're manifested, and how to control them. Please encourage them to take several forms of the IATs from time to time to acknowledge the areas they need to work on.

If you're not the type that's having difficulties with speech, you can invite a guest speaker to speak on the issue. You can also develop tasks that involve participants. Grant rewards to people who participate in them. This way, you'll get many volunteers next time while solidifying information about the message you're trying to pass across. Take time to involve those prone to or victims of implicit evaluations in these activities. Make them feel, and be sincere about it, that they are important in these activities. At the end of the workshop or training sessions, ask questions concerning the issue to test their knowledge and how much of it they've grasped. If they don't seem to have gotten enough information, repeat the drill. It's a process that involves discipline and courage, but if you put your mind to it, you'll notice positive results in the long run.

Suppose you feel you have been a perpetrator of unconscious bias, while it may not have been your fault, to ensure peaceful coexistence in this polarized world. In that case, it is your responsibility to fix your prejudices, to slay the beast. Perhaps, I have even shown you why this beast ought to be killed.

PART 2

Chapter 6 - What is Prejudice?

"Judgment in Advance" is how Latin coined it. Throughout different sections of society, we are all involved in it one way or another. However, generational curses in the Gospel Coalition are no longer a religious phenomenon. They are explained as the cumulative effects of any individual's ancestral beliefs, practices, or actions passing down to its posterity. Breaking such a curse is a strenuous piece of work. However, a curse is bestowed upon a person because of his or her misconduct or wrongdoing. As much as the successors of the cursed did not deserve ill-treatment, the reason for the curse's existence might be justifiable. Moreover, curses could be broken.

It would be controversial to say about the medieval times that it was easier. There were no corporate professional platforms that required people of different classes, genders, religions, cultures, and economic backgrounds to come and work together. Every section of a respective society was bifurcated to carry out the tasks subjected to their lineage.

However, individuals have evolved to push their lucks and limit in modern times. Considering their backgrounds, achieving certain positions or remunerations is regarded as a victory against centuries of discrimination. Democracy had taken birth when people decided to choose what they wanted to become.

Democracies, however, are not devoid of discrimination and discrepancies. There are various parameters based on which individuals are treated indifferently in modern times. What was the generational curse has become directly proportional to prejudice. The invisible virus has crept onto humans (its prey) dominantly and has no proven logical reasoning. It is due to myths heard and believed by a community that focused on a stereotypical past.

The exciting thing about it is that it can be overcome by our conscious efforts to strive to achieve certain morals as prejudice in mind is a human-made phenomenon and not an act of god.

Unfortunately for us that our society is not open enough to accept diversity. Most people out there who do not conform to the prevailing standards of acceptance are treated with prejudice. It is only because of a limited but growing section of society's choice to embrace the diversity in every realm of life that this book is written.

Most people don't even recognize that they are exercising prejudice over certain groups. The practice of condemning traits that are not homogenous is gravely normalized. When people have a negative impression about a specific group of individuals, they treat them differently upon having an encounter, without even realizing it. Sociology professor David Williams testifies.

It is downright sad what average individuals consider as 'facts' with no access to accurate sources. How individuals are discriminated against because of archetypal myths related to ethnicity, gender, sexual orientation, or age without any specific evidence is plainly immoral and even scarring.

It would be argued that the government passes many laws and regulations for the welfare of the marginalized. However, prejudice is not a practice in itself. It is the reason and source of visual discrimination. Laws can indeed address a person's actions, but the feeling of prejudice is internally entrenched.

"When a man's mind is expanded by a new idea, it never contracts to its former state," says Oliver Wendell Holmes Sr., Autocrat of the Breakfast Table. Implying that any mind that lets the misinformation received not affect its decisions widens its horizons, and the idea of being prejudiced would seem very narrow and shallow.

In Employment:

Gender and Sexual Orientation

Lesbians, gay men, and bisexuals who feel ready to be open about their sexuality at their workplace might be discriminated against for specific positions and benefits. In connection to family life, numerous LGBT people may experience the desire to work non-conventional hours because the supposition proliferates that they don't have families. You must ensure equal opportunities and rights are offered to people, and no bias is made based on their sexuality. Your job as an H.R. or management is to make them feel accepted and welcomed in the organization.

There are many instances of discrimination on the grounds of gender, race, sexual orientation, age, and religion. In professions requiring technical qualifications, women are not considered fit for the role, especially in some countries and continents such as Asia, Africa, and Middle East. Due to the societal view of women as fragile beings and someone saddled with family care responsibilities, their roles and involvement have been limited by the male counterpart. For example, if Jane, an ambitious accountant, dares to apply for a higher position if pregnant, she is refused. The pregnancy is seen as a limiting factor to her official responsibility. There is no way women's personal and professional lives can remain separate.

Other issues such as lower pay as compared to men are widely overlooked. Even with a higher education level, the average income of a woman is 76.5% of that of men. Moreover, the risk of sexual violation is always present. An outspoken and friendly woman is seen as 'easy' and often falls prey to workplace harassment. Women in need of a job and money are often exploited for their pressing needs.

All in all, when any woman is ambitious enough to pursue her dreams, hindrances are already in the queue. On many fronts - financial, social, emotional, or physical, a woman can be a subject of abuse. It is high time we begin to view women with a different lens of equity and not just as objects or inferior beings that are only meant to satisfy male pleasure and make sandwiches.

The inclusion of diversity in our society must focus on freedom from biased judgment and stereotyping. Women should not even be on this list as every culture has significant and powerful women - from monarchs to scientists to entrepreneurs. The capacity and resourcefulness of women have been proven with their roles and exploits in our society. The essence of diversity is accepting women with equity and awakening their values and potentials in the same light as their male counterparts.

Race

In medieval Europe, there was a false accusation of Jews that they had poisoned the wells and eventually spread diseases. This happened again during the Nazi regime, and this time they were accused of Germany's economic crisis. These events led to the Jews' criminal victimization, which is still evident. One of the most widely known chapters in history is the Jewish genocide in Germany under the leadership of Adolf Hitler.

Along with the Jews, Hitler also included other prisoners that he deemed unfit for the new Germany he was about to build. These included artists, gypsies, intellectuals, homosexuals, and the physically and mentally disabled. It is known that they all were killed in the 'Holocaust.'

The Jewish citizens of Germany were persecuted, even if they had converted to Christianity. Soviet Russia witnessed a massacre of thousands of Jewish who were ruthlessly killed. On average, more than 5 million people were victims, out of which one million were children. Hitler's obsession with expanding living space for the superior 'pure' Aryan race led to the killing of millions of innocent lives.

An example of racial discrimination that still prevails today is against people because of their skin color. Regarding their participation in the U.S. workforce, Blacks and Hispanics are significantly underrepresented, particularly amongst employees with a college degree or above.

People of color are stereotyped as hardworking because of their color and history of serving as slaves to white people in colonial times. Hence they are physically exploited and emotionally scarred.

Margaret, a black woman working as a nurse, said, *"As a black woman, I do not get equal opportunities during the times for increments, promotions, or advancement because of the stereotypes. certain people still retain the false belief that black people unqualified and lazy, while the truth is actually the exact opposite. I believe that people are threatened because of my capability, qualification, and competency and that I can be much more productive and efficient compared to them."*

Rafiq, a Muslim working as an administrator in the local government, said that people often commented on his

appearance and continuously asked offensive questions about his traditions and customs. He finds it challenging to work as his workplace reflects hostility.

Shamsher Singh, a taxi driver in New Jersey, says that "after the attacks of 9/11 men of the Sikh community in the United States suffered a great deal because of their matching appearance to Muslims. Many were fired and left with no means of survival in such critical times. More than a professional, people of the Sikh community had a prominent peril to their lives".

Unfortunately, people with darker skin tones are always looked at with suspicion, and the paranoia stops them from getting a successful professional record in foreign lands.

Disability

Some employers cease from hiring people with a physical deformation. If, however they do, they are seen with the utmost sympathy and presumed to be sad or bitter about themselves.

The term 'differently-abled is a more inclusive term in embracing diversity. The belief that even if an individual is not physically equal to others, there are qualities that are basically unique to them, which they should be considered with equal remuneration in any profession they choose and are comfortable to work in.

Furthermore, people with such differences must not be physically or mentally harassed because of their helplessness to perform specific tasks. Employee and retirement benefits for the differently-abled are the main ways of demonstrating their inclusion without any bias.

The problem

Generalizations about people without knowing facts lead to misjudgment. And that leads to bad decisions. For rectifying what is wrong with a person, the first and foremost step is to admit there are false impressions.

You shouldn't put a 'one size fits all' judgment on the individuals of any particular group. Lack of a reliable source of information is the culprit in such cases. If one acquires facts from the means of word of mouth or popular opinions, their judgment regarding any person would be flawed, and it would restrict the employer or colleague from getting to know the person better. On the other side, any aspiring and ambitious person would lose the chance to prove themselves because of these limiting factors. Such shallow practices should not thrive in today's society.

We need to move on from the assumption that 'Different is Defective.' The practice of putting labels on people being 'inferior' if they are different is unacceptable. Negative attitudes towards any individual because of their difference would increase the magnitude of prejudice among individuals. An essential virtue - empathy ceases when one develops a negative attitude towards contrasting attributes of any person.

How empathy helps

Simply put, the quality of empathy means putting oneself in another person's shoes and seeing the world from their perspective. Once we walk on the path of empathy and embrace it in our society, there will be unity and progress in our dealings. The more we focus on similarities instead of differences, the less likely it will be to judge anyone negatively.

More than realization, the practice of empathy makes one develop mutual respect for the other. In India, Dalits being the lower castes, are looked down on. For centuries, they have received no respect from society. In ancient times, they were treated as untouchables and were barred from receiving formal education. With increasing awareness and inclusion of the marginalized, various activists, including those from the upper castes, are working towards better treatment and equal rights. Governments also have given those reservations in schools, colleges, and employment. This way, the prejudice toward this set of minors is decreasing, and people are seen as humans, above other classifications.

What you can do

After getting acquainted with someone different from you, you can make them feel comfortable by trying to feel

how they are feeling. Eating a meal with their family or staying with them until they are done doing their works are unspoken ways of showing affection. Learning about their hobbies and interests might give you common grounds on what to have conversations about. Make sure they don't feel alienated at formal parties.

If one would look at themselves in their position and think how bad it would be to be made feel worthless? How bad would it feel to anyone if they are judged even before they are heard? How bad would one think if they are seen as less human because of their background?

We are all belonging somewhere as social animals. Being excluded from formal circles would make one feel worthless and even depressed. We must ensure that no person belonging to any marginalized community feels left out.

The problem

Egotism can contribute to prejudice. An egotistical individual has an exaggerated perception of self-worth. He sees himself as supreme and judges' individuals as inadequately distinct from him. The Encyclopedia Britannica states: "Most [cultural] groups believe that their way of life, their food, dress, behaviors, beliefs, and values, are superior to those of other groups, to varying degrees of severity." How do we escape this faulty line of thinking?

The last thing needed is sentiments getting in the way in a space where so much hard work is dedicated to advancing a brand or product, where so much commitment, attention, and concentration are put towards a target. There is very literally no space for emotions in the office.

What you can do

Some reality checks would be appreciated in such situations. Tolerance and equality should be entrenched and imbibed as a habit. To acknowledge the excellent qualities of people in place of their deficiencies is an attribute of the strong. Working towards a common goal, identifying and recognizing people with different qualities would be very beneficial as it develops teamwork.

Overcoming prejudice is not so difficult in an organization or firm if one decides to look at the bright side of things, which might help us admire diversity.

The problem

People who view others in a hostile and inferior way may isolate themselves from the possibility of accepting the way their feelings, thinking, and actions might change.

Also, if one is inclined only towards the type of people they have only been with, their preferences would be pretty limited. To avoid that, one must be willing to make conscious and continuous efforts to socialize with and befriend those who are different and new.

How expanding our friends' circle helps

Socializing with colleagues helps to improve the consistency of partnerships in the workplace. Good relationships help the team to communicate better. Coworkers who interact well on non-work topics are more likely to cooperate on work successfully. They will consequently be open and accessible to their coworkers on work-related matters. Employees and the business overall will profit when there is synergy.

Socialization in the workplace improves human relations in businesses. It offers workers the skills and customs required to engage within the corporate culture. Socialization typically affects how workers perceive collaboration, work practices, and knowledge sharing, all of which are essential factors for a company.

We understand why others do things differently when we get to know them personally. And we begin to see them as part of our own community as we move closer to them. We come to love them more, and they become our confidantes to share good and bad experiences.

Consider Nazaré's illustration. She felt discrimination toward immigrants once. "I spent time with them and worked with them," she describes as what inspired her. I encountered people who were the polar opposite of what the rest of the world has taught them. You realize not to judge people from different backgrounds until you befriend them, and

you learn to appreciate and respect them as humans.

According to "Psychology Today" writers Nitin Nohria, Boris Groysberg, and Linda-Eling Lee, "the significance of creating a business culture focused on friendship, mutual dependency, partnership, and sharing." Such emotional drives boost morale and resolve the human need to connect. According to "Psychology Today," workers who do not experience a sense of fellowship, shared dependency, cooperation, or sharing are more vulnerable to feelings of discontent.

A word of caution

Some individuals prefer lifestyles with behaviors that are detrimental to themselves and others. Hence, when widening our circle of friends, we should be selective. Avoiding friendship with irresponsible people who act in a debauched or insulting manner is not prejudicial. Although you should not attempt to injure people who contradict your moral values or try to strip them of their dignity, removing them from your group of friends is wise.

One of the most important ways to make the workplace a happier atmosphere is to make friends at work, especially if you spend 30 hours or more weekly working at a place regularly. It is a fact that we spend lots of time daily with co-workers than with members of our family, and we will finally retire at a later age, which means we're going to spend most of our lives with colleagues at work. That's why friends at work help make our job easier.

It's not only a source of fun to have friends at work but also a source of success and ingenuity needed to get your job done with ease. However, it is also necessary to choose the right friends at work. Without weakness, friendship doesn't go well. And what happens if it fizzles? For the wrong mates, the fallout could be very costly.

Also, to make good friends and acquaintances, you must be the right friend. If you start on the path to be unbiased and cheerful, you must possess certain characteristics.

Be mindful that there are things that you cannot talk about at work. It is not advisable to go into depth at the onset and share all kinds of personal data. Know your boundaries and honor the workplace professionally, sticking with the everyday conversations. Remember, inclusion never replaces exclusivity.

What you can do

Communication is the golden key in including a diverse class. One must possess the ability to start a topic to talk with people belonging to different ethnicity, sexual orientation, or language. You can always start with a short introduction from your side and prompt them to introduce themselves. Extending a hand of friendship might experience a shy pull, but it is always worth it.

Inviting the newly introduced for a meal or wine is a great way to know what is common between you two. If a colleague tries to converse with topics outside of work, it is a clear sign that he or she means to extend a hand for friendship.

Being a good listener is always a prerequisite to being a good friend. Especially from a person with a different background, imagine how wonderful it would be to know a completely different culture. Knowing their stories, knowing how they ended up in the same place as you, and knowing what they like or dislike would help you appear a good friend and, more than that, an individual embracing diversity.

It is also imperative to perceive that the feeling of being prejudiced towards a particular person would not just vanish in the bat of an eye. It takes a day-to-day effort to let go of one's preconceived notions and deep-rooted beliefs. Once you begin to realize that the person you chose to empathize with was not the same person you wrongly imagined, your viewpoints will start transforming into something different, positive, and beautiful. Even if you don't feel wholly convinced of the idea of befriending a different individual, push yourself - this act of being friendly and kind is also for improving yourself.

Kindness as a virtue is vital to make people feel comfortable with you. The more you show your love to others, the less prejudice you will feel in yourself. More love leaves less room in your heart for hatred or contempt. Showing kindness towards others brings people together and grows unity in any organization.

There are several ways to show acceptance and affection to a group of people that you have viewed negatively in your mind.

- You can start with the simple act of holding the door open for anyone. Remember, good manners are seldom forgotten.

- If there is a public transport you share, make a point to save a seat for them or giving up your own. Friendships only sail where there are no rocks called 'selfish opportunists.'

- Little words of appreciating their dressing sense or the food they bring to work might be a good start. Even if you two do not speak the same native language, getting to learn new words from theirs will be impressive.

- Even if you might have decided to befriend this individual, he or she may not be that welcoming because of past experiences. If they choose to be reserved in the first few weeks of getting close, make sure to be patient and not lose your morale.

- In some scenarios, new associates might be experiencing some difficulty while trying to adjust and seek help. Try to keep a loving smile so that the individual feels comfortable coming to you with any issues.

Adjusting with diversity and inclusion may seem complicated, but it is not impossible. If countries and cultures can evolve and imbibe acceptance, so can fellow individuals. Overcoming prejudice against others makes the world a better place. Inclusion often increases a firm's success and interpersonal relationships by creating a sense of belonging.

Chapter 7 - Getting a sense of belonging at work: *Steps to Develop a Welcoming Environment in your organization*

Whether it's in a prominent corporation or small workplace – a sense of inclusion is of prime importance. Let us try to understand from an employee's perspective – how he or she would prefer the working environment to be?

It shouldn't matter what gender, race, or religion one belongs to – the work atmosphere should make everyone feel welcomed. The organization's H.R. department must encourage a friendly workplace where everyone feels belonging. No one should feel left out or out of place while working in the organization.

When employees feel at ease and work in a friendly atmosphere, they work more productively and efficiently, feeling comfortable and happy at the workplace. Now, it is no rocket science we iterate that the organization's success pivots on employees' efforts.

When the workforce doesn't feel welcome, they cannot perform at their optimum capabilities. They would feel uncomfortable, and ultimately it would impact their performance. When the employees are not happy or comfortable at a workplace, it also affects the employee retention ratio.

From HR's perspective, having a better retention ratio is essential. This can properly be explained with the following hypothetical work scenario:

Suppose a company requires at least 10,000 trained workforces to keep its organization fully operational. This staff strength would comprise people from different genders, races, religions. If the company favors a particular gender, race, or religion or practices bias towards a specific workforce section, then the other employees would feel left out or uncomfortable. They might fear never getting better opportunities for their group and decide to agitate or leave the company. The biased situation of the management will constantly make the atmosphere toxic and unstable, as more employees will be going and some continually being recruited. Finding a suitable replacement is never an easy task, and the need to train the new employees to fill in will be a strenuous process. This is an added burden on the shoulders of the H.R. department. Next, the recruit might take some time to get used to the new work environment. Finally, there is always a risk of them leaving the organization after training.

No H.R. would want to go through this entire process repeatedly. Wouldn't it be better if the existing workforce is kept happy so that the need for replacement doesn't arise frequently? Of course! Now just think about what type of organizational environment you should create to keep your employees feel 'belonged' to the workplace.

It is the responsibility of the organization's H.R. department to ensure that there is no bias or favoritism in the workplace. However, no organization is full-proof, and sooner or later, a situation might arise where H.R. has to step

up and resolve issues, one reason why the H.R. personnel should be approachable and easily reachable. This would develop trust and loyalty amongst the workforce.

What exactly does 'sense of belonging means'?

There are multiple aspects to this question. A sense of belonging is the welcomed feeling employees get when they come to work. They should feel at ease that they belong to the organization.

Every organization expects its workforce to add value to the final output or result; this is why it is also imperative for the organization management to make the employees feel that their contribution is vital to its success. This can be done by showing appreciation, rewarding for extra efforts, getting some involved in decisions (based on their caliber), giving them the freedom to express their skills and ideas – irrespective of their religion, race, ethnicity, and gender. This is what a sense of belonging or inclusion is all about. When this is ensured in an organization, there will be stability.

On the contrary, if the employee feels uncomfortable or harassed or feels restricted, productivity will be hindered, and the rate at which they will quit for other firms will be on a high.

Measures to providing your employees a sense of belonging at work?

As an H.R., it should be your responsibility that the recruited staff feels comfortable at work. They would be new to the organization's culture and work practices and need a guiding hand if they face any trouble. The Human Resource department should be their guiding hand.

However, not all employees would come straight to you when they need help or feel discomfort. But this does not let you off the hook (as H.R.). The H.R.'s job is to ensure that the new employee is given the proper orientation and introduced to the team. There are many other things that H.R. can do to instill the 'feeling of belonging' in the workforce. Here are a few steps to begin with:

Give them Space

Every person wants to with a little bit of freedom regardless of the task. You need to ensure that they do not feel restricted. There must be clear guidelines in the organization that provides an unbiased and free work atmosphere.

Consider this situation. Your organization's sales team has five male members, and the recruit is a female. As an H.R., it is your job to ensure that equal opportunities, unbiased performance evaluation, and safety at the workplace are practiced. Moreover, the other team members and superiors must follow the same practice to give enough space to the recruit.

This would allow the new female recruit to perform to the best of her abilities and contribute to the sales figures. Moreover, when the team member feels welcomed, safe, and sees the possibility of growth, they feel more 'belonged to the organization.'

Sometimes, employees feel uncomfortable because of their religious practices. H.R. has to ensure that the freedom to practice religious beliefs must be provided to such employees. To the extent that won't disrupt the organizational structure or goals, the organization can also be lenient to employees in the practice of their religion, and no employees should be discriminated against because of their religious belief.

No form of discrimination or restriction based on gender, religion, race, or any other form must be allowed at the workplace. Everyone prefers to work at places that give them freedom and offer unbiased growth opportunities. Nobody would want to work where their sex, religion, race is frowned upon. As H.R. personnel, these issues must be taken care of from the onset.

Employees should not be required to change their beliefs; this would not help the organization grow. On the contrary, the workforce at such places will always feel unprotected and would not work to their full potential. This would invariably affect the organization's growth, progress, and success.

Another thing that the organization or the H.R. must practice is sharing their employee's happiness and being supportive during difficult times. Celebratory events like getting married or having a baby can be celebrated within the organization; this shows that the company is willing to be a part of their proud moments. Similarly, during sickness or any other unfortunate event like the death of a dear one, the company should support the employee.

These are times that determine the relationship between the company and the employee. The organization's favorable response to such events would ultimately lead to a long-term association.

It is better and productive to create a friendly and pleasant working environment where everyone feels welcomed.

Be Reachable

Creating a good workplace with good practice is no longer enough. Being the H.R. or part of the management team, you need to go the extra mile. It would be unthoughtful to feel that the organizational culture or work environment would be issue-proof.

Of course, problems do crop up. Nobody can eliminate the possibility of having concerns or issues. The only thing that can be done is to ensure that you (as H.R.) are available to solve them when they arise.

There is another angle to consider while we talk about 'being available.' The employees would always have concerns and need someone to clear their doubts. H.R. is the department that is responsible for handling these occurrences. The workers should be able to come to you and explain the problems to solve them.

The critical point to consider is that 'someone should always be available to address their concerns.

Whether it is favoritism, sexual harassment, racial bias, or any other intolerable concern, the workforce should always have someone to talk to. This gives them a feeling of protection and security – 'that someone is always looking out for them'. Believe it or not – employees need to have someone in authority, reachable to discuss their problems; this gives them a feeling of belonging.

What would happen if they don't have anyone to answer their concerns or protect them from any form of harassment at the workplace? There are times when employees find it challenging to connect with someone at the management level to get answers or help. In such cases, they can become violent, disconnected, or leave such a workplace for good!

They must understand – there is always someone to help or guide, just a phone call away when the need arises! This feeling itself gives them confidence and a sense of security. This also enhances the 'feeling of belonging' within the employees.

In this section, the concerns I have discussed might be raised individually or collectively by a team or group. In any case, H.R. should always give them an ear and address their concerns. Being available for the employees is one of the most important things that the management or H.R. should take care of – since **the organization's success would depend on the team's well-being!**

Every employee wants to be applauded for the job 'well-done.' The management must recognize their effort and contribution. There are three types of appreciation:

Verbal: Verbal motivation encourages the workforce as it enhances their importance in front of the team. This increases their morale and makes them more dedicated and motivated. Eventually, this would result in better performance.

The H.R. and top-level management must not shy away from doing this as it can have long-lasting effects. Consider an employee giving the best sales performance in a particular year. If the organization does not attribute its success to the employee's efforts, they would feel worthless and would not be encouraged to put in similar efforts next time. It is crucial to address and appreciate their hard work verbally.

Remember, any form of verbal motivation would make your team more dedicated and lead to higher productivity.

1. **Monetary:**

Monetary rewards are equally important to praise your employees for their dedicated efforts that led to the growth and success of the organization. These financial rewards can be bonuses, free vacation, shopping coupons, a raise in salary, etc.

There is no wrong in compensating your employees from what was derived from their efforts. Instead, it would only make them more dedicated and appreciative of the organization.

2. **Promotions:**

One of the best ways to appreciate your employees for their higher performance and dedication is to promote them to a senior position. Giving them higher authority is one of the best methods to make them feel gratified.

When a team member is appreciated by giving them a better role, they become highly appreciative of the organization, and their commitment to the organization also increases. They feel more 'belonged to the organization' and thus stay loyal and dedicated.

Other teammates would be motivated to perform equally well or enhance dedication to get rewarded similarly. If you consider the comprehensive scenario, it is a win-win for the organization. By rewarding one, you motivate others also.

All the forms of appreciation are equally important. They get a feeling of belonging since their efforts are appreciated, showing that their work is valued in the organization. Getting rewarded is the best form of motivation, and it also enhances the possibility of higher employee retention.

The H.R. or the organization's management must not hold out while rewarding their employees if they perform well. A famous saying by the great author Dale Carnegie states – "Be hearty in approbation and lavish in your praise."

Involve them in decision making

There are times when the management or team leader needs to take tough calls or decisions. At such times involving the well-performing employee to make the decision might not only prove to be beneficial but would also boost their morale.

Involving them in decision-making would make the employees feel important. It also makes them feel more involved with the organization. Taking opinions during group meetings and considering their suggestions is an integral part of making them feel useful in the workplace.

On many occasions, the employees have much more to contribute, but they cannot speak up due to lack of opportunity. At times, these suggestions prove to be much more valuable. However, an important thing to remember is openness in the decision-making process. The more involved you make them feel, the better they feel about themselves.

All this is a process to ensure their 'feeling of belonging' is enhanced. There are many advantages to this effect:

- When the employees have the freedom to voice their opinion and feel that they can contribute, their workplace relationship is improved.
- It increases the sense of teamwork within the organization.
- As a manager or leader, you also tap into their wealth of knowledge, expertise, strengths, and weaknesses. This way, you can utilize the employee's important ideas and strengths and work on their weaknesses with training and workshops.
- If employees feel to be an essential part of an organization, it raises their confidence and makes them more committed and productive.

Team building exercises

One of the essential benefits of team-building exercises is that employees get to know each other better during such activities. It also makes them more comfortable and relaxed, resulting in better involvement and higher productivity. You allow them to analyze their weaknesses and strengths.

The employees would feel more at home when such activities are being carried out at workplaces. As a leader, you

also get the opportunity to analyze your team's competitiveness and strengths. You get to know the effect of competition within the staff and how they react to an incentive to win.

But the question is how to design the team-building exercises? The answer lies in the purpose of such an activity. Besides making them feel they belonged to the organization, team-building exercises help achieve many other goals.

- There is always strength in our differences; as a leader, you can harness the differences/diversity among the employees for the organization's benefit. Their varying strengths, ideas, and skills can be of great advantage.
- You can teach your employees how to work towards a common goal. Team building strategies are a great means to create unity and help them work towards a common goal.

Caution: Team building exercise must increase cooperation and unity amongst the team and not develop rivalry or demoralize any particular group. The design of your practices which includes games and activities, must be such that it makes everyone feel involved and happy. You wouldn't want this exercise to do contrary.

Inspiring them to grow and making it possible

Everyone desires to grow in their professional lives. One of the critical determinants to employee loyalty is the opportunity to grow within the organization. If the employee finds ample scope and opportunities for growth, their commitment to work also increases.

The possibility of growth also motivates the employees to put in more effort resulting in higher productivity. They justify their role by proving their skills. Eventually, the company's growth is influenced by the efforts put in by the workforce.

It is the responsibility of the H.R. department to make everyone aware of the opportunities for growth and progress within the company. They get a perception of belonging to the workplace when their well-deserved efforts are appreciated in the form of growth opportunities.

The organization leaders and the H.R. department have to make sure that ample growth opportunities are provided to its valued employees. It is vital to make the employees achieve their desired growth. This eventually makes them feel they belonged in their workplace – just like a second home.

What does it mean to the organization?

For an organization, it is imperative to create a workplace that makes every employee feel belonged. To harness the employees' potential, it is very important to make them feel comfortable, confident, free, safe and show them the possibility of growth.

Such practices benefit the organization in the long run. A company with a loyal, dedicated, hard-working, and happy workforce can never fail to grow.

The most significant advantage of having a peaceful and positive work environment where employees get a sense of inclusion is that the employer-employee relationship becomes stronger. It is important to note here that this does not happen overnight and takes consistent effort from both sides. Negligence from either side would result in a short-term association that is never desired.

While there is a need to draw a clear line between the employer and employee, it is vital to understand that maintaining mutual respect is the pillar on which the entire relationship would depend.

Another advantage of having a happier workforce is that it lessens disputes. Comprehensively, this is advantageous to the employer and the employee. Better rewards and growth keep the employees happy, whereas higher productivity, efficiency, and profitability keep the company happy.

The loyalty of the employee is the most significant advantage of such workplaces. Since a loyal employee maintains a long-term relationship, it creates stability. Think about the time, training, and resources it would take to recruit if employees leave often.

It is imperative in modern workplaces to develop a welcoming environment within the organizations, to give a sense of 'belonging at work' to their employees.

Chapter 8 - Promoting Communication and Understanding at Work.

Active communication is a necessary part of our personal and professional life. Good communication can lead to success and happiness. No relationship can thrive without good communication, which is also true for our professional life. Whether having small or large businesses, communication has many effects and consequences. Perfect communication among staff members creates a comfortable atmosphere at work. It is crucial to have smooth communication where the employees can discuss their problems and share good moments.

Communication has many fundamentals and features that must be followed. People say that effective communication is an art; it should be learned and practiced efficiently for the greater good. Communication works by a specific process in which both sender and receiver have a significant role. In business, the administrators play a substantial role in communication, as they have to convey ideas, vision, and beliefs to the employees. The information being communicated should be understandable and prompt actions from the employees. Hence, the administrators and the employees need to have excellent personal and organizational skills.

Inculcating Positive Communication in the Workplace

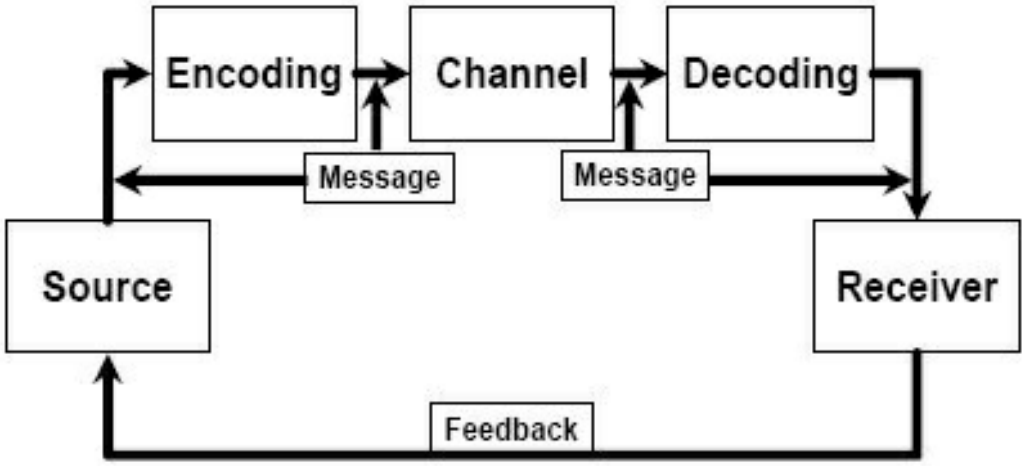
Communication is one of the notable aspects of the work environment. It is considered an essential characteristic of elite work culture. Effective communication is regarded as the center part of the workplace to achieve business objectives.

In simple words, it can be defined as an exchange of thoughts, ideas, emotions, information, and understanding between people. It is necessary to build relationships and understanding of the workplace. We spend almost half of our lives at the workplace, so establishing pure relations and creating understanding is very important. Having healthy communication and understanding at work benefits in various ways we don't notice. Not all exchanges in information are believed to be successful communication. When a memorandum, fax, e-mail are sent, it is thought that communication is done. But that is not the case here. There must be an end-to-end interaction to have proper communication and understanding.

The communication comprises three parts: the sender, the message, and the recipient. The sender may 'encode' the message in some way, and the recipient 'decodes' the message. A recipient may get the message, but there are chances that he may not understand it. Being able to send and receive doesn't ensure that you have good communication. There should be a proper understanding of the message that has been communicated. The interpretation of messages differs from person to person. If the recipient doesn't get the exact meaning of the message sent by the sender, then communication has not taken place.

The Mantra for Positive Communication in the Organization

The Communication Process



The communication process has two important elements: the sender and recipient. Communication cannot take place without them. The above figure shows all the crucial steps included in the communication process.

The sender encodes the information or message and sends it via suitable channels to a recipient or multiple recipient. Here we talk about the workplace. In the workplace, the sender sends a message with various symbols, words, or concepts to others. The sender can be a person, unit, or department of the organization. The message comprises words or gestures to convey a specific idea to the recipient in verbal, non-verbal, or written language. The recipient, to whom the message is sent, has to decode the message into meaningful information. It is necessary to get a close idea of what the sender is conveying.

Effective communication is accomplished only when the recipient understands the information that is conveyed in the message. However, some personal and environmental barriers can hinder the communication process. A barrier is anything that changes the idea of the message. Barriers are obstacles in the communication process. Different perceptions of message, language barriers, emotions, and attitudes are various examples of barriers.

Misunderstandings can form at any stage of the communication process. An effective communicator understands the receiver of the message properly first. Then chooses a suitable channel/means to convey the message. This can help to avoid the misunderstanding in communication. As the receiver decodes the message, the receiver sends feedback to the sender. Feedback is sent to ensure the message is received and well understood; clarification can be requested if otherwise.

Feedback is an important element of the communication process, as it allows you to know whether the two-way conversation between receiver and sender is successful or not. If any problem occurs with any element of the communication process, effective communication is hindered.

The Role of Communication Channels in Deriving Positive Results

The way through which communication takes place is called communication channels. A method used to transmit the message to the recipient or receive the message from the sender is by the communication channel. Various communication channels are available to us today. The communication channels consist of face-to-face conversations, text messages, email, telephone calls, social media such as Twitter and Facebook, T.V. and radio,

written letters, and reports.

Choosing the most appropriate communication channel leads to effective communication. All communication channels have their pros and cons. To convey a piece of complex and technical information, the sender can send via a printed document. It is more reliable than a spoken message. This way, the recipient can absorb the information and understand it at its own pace and revisit it. Hence, selecting the communication channel is critical and must be done wisely. Non-verbal gestures, facial expressions, body position, and even clothing can transmit messages. People can decode information selectively as per their thinking.

The Vital Role of Efficient Communication in The Workplace

The workplace demands effective communication as the organization needs to work with coordination. people with different experiences come together to accomplish the same goals in an organization. If the administrators fail to convey accurate information on corporate ideas, vision, and goals or fail to maintain the needed communication, this can hinder productivity or even a disaster. Employees cannot do a given task effectively work if not appropriately guided. Thus, it is imperative to convey and receive information with proper understanding.

Job Satisfaction

The atmosphere at work determines the job satisfaction of the employee. The organization's work culture is determined by its correspondence between the seniors and subordinates. Organizations that promote easy communication between seniors and associates have fewer employee turnover ratios. With effective communication, employees will work with good understanding and ease. Hence, job satisfaction is achieved through effective communication among all employees.

Fewer Conflicts

An organization needs to have open communication to prevent conflicts. The atmosphere of the workplace must be free and suitable to have conversations. The friendly atmosphere at the workplace encourages the staff to work without arguments and promotes open and mutual discussions. The conflicts can be lessened if communication is open.

Enhanced Productivity

Effective communication greatly influences an organization's success. It can lead to the success or failure of the company. If the leaders succeed in delivering the right information and make the subordinates understand the goals, the road to success becomes easy.

Optimum Utilization of Resources

When there is miscommunication between the company's employees, it creates conflicts. The conflicts can lead to delay in work. The delay in work may result in a waste of resources, time, and money. This has a direct impact on organizational productivity. Hence, good communication is necessary to have optimum use of resources.

Innovation

Every company needs to have a healthy discussion about the company's progress. When given the freedom to share new ideas, the employees can come up with innovative ideas that work. Innovation relies heavily on effective communication, and any organization that encourages good communication is far more likely to be an innovative one.

Strong Management

Managers can only manage their teams if they are strong communicators. Being strong communicators, the managers need to undertake many decisions and tasks. The delegation of functions, conflict management, relationship management, and motivation (all critical responsibilities of any manager) become much easier when you are a strong communicator. Strong communication doesn't mean just the ability to talk to people but to dialogue and motivate them at the same time. A strong communicator creates strong management.

What Impedes Effective Communication at Workplace?

Productive communication at work is not mostly easy and straightforward. Barriers in communication hinder clear

understanding of the main idea of the message, subsequently leading to confusion, misunderstanding, and can even lead to conflict. The communication elements are sender, receiver, message, channels, encoding, decoding, and feedback. If any problems occur in one of the communication elements, there can be a misunderstanding, and the primary idea can get changed. We will see the barriers to effective communication below.

Physical Barriers

Physical barriers prevent an individual from being able to understand non-verbal messages. This barrier is more prevalent in communication methods that rely on technology than face-to-face communication. Other physical barriers also include:

- When old or broken equipment is used for communication, there can be issues in interpreting information.
- Background noise during communication sometimes distorts the information and affects the whole meaning.
- When communicating is done close to break/ lunch/ end of work hours, it can be a barrier as the person is always in a hurry to listen.
- When there are large work areas that are physically separated from colleagues creates a problem sometimes.
- Long geographic ranges between the sender and receiver lead to differences in timings. Communication is usually easier over shorter geographical differences.

Psychological Barriers

The psychological state of the sender or receiver can affect the communication between them. Having a stable mental state is very important while communicating with colleagues in the organization. Sometimes having an unstable state of mind can lead to unnecessary conflicts in the company.

For example: When a person has social anxiety or issues related to low self-esteem, he may be distracted in his thoughts while talking with their superior. He may be worried about what that person might be thinking of him. It is difficult for them to share their honest thoughts. Such a person often forgets the content and context of the message as he was distracted in his thoughts. This functions as a hindrance to productive communication, and many people suffer from it.

When someone is offended, they may speak things they will later regret. In anger, a message can be misinterpreted and creates an unwanted problem.

Organizational Structure Barriers

The Organizational structure must be simple and clear to understand. Each employee must know their superiors and report accordingly. This creates fewer misunderstandings and leads to clear communication.

An organization with a complex hierarchy and multiple management levels always risks losing important information. Let us look at the below image to understand this statement better.

Perceptual Barriers

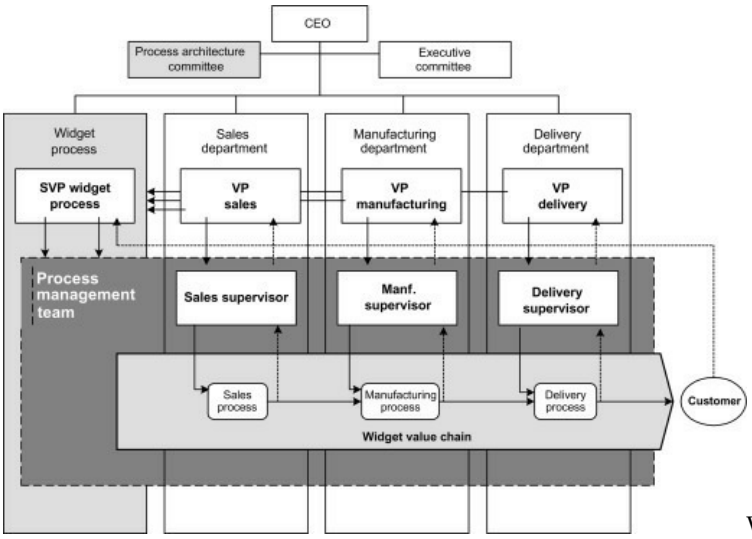
There are many differences in opinion in organizations. This difference of views and opinions reduces objectivity. Sometimes you may be a part of a conversation and assume that the listener will not understand you or the listener is not interested in your discussion. This thought unintentionally harms the message you are conveying and forces you to use dismissive language or be more humorous. If you are the listener who disagrees with the speaker's ideologies and thinking, you automatically decide to ignore the speaker's conversation and look for faults in their conversation despite listening to them carefully.

Attention Barriers

There are times when people are lost in their thoughts, especially when speaking. The listener might not pay much attention to what is being said, and this means they are distracted or uninterested in the topic of the conversation that

is going on. In some cases, employees do not pay attention in the team meetings and miss valuable information, which can slow down work or lead to confusion. Communication is a two-way process – you don't understand the information if you don't give enough attention.

Too Much Information



When much information is provided to someone, he can get confused or lose details of the information. An overwhelming amount of details about the message can change the message's idea and confuse the recipient. This happens when the receiver is new to the information he is given. Much unwanted information can distract the main idea of the message. It would be best to keep in mind not to give too much talk about a message in meetings, where people can easily switch off.

Emotional Barriers

The emotional reactions from both sender or receiver can become a barrier to effective communication. During work, emotions must be kept aside, and the focus should be on the assignment. It is difficult but important. You should analyze yourself and work out the words or topics that trigger your emotions. You can plan and try to manage them.

Sometimes, the employees think that their opinions or ideas don't matter. They also tend to believe that they will be misjudged if they speak about something in general. However, this is not the right thinking. Like you, other people will also have the same fear about speaking out, so when you talk, they will respect you more and feel encouraged to speak the next time.

Emotions must be controlled or shown wisely in the workplace. Some people also feel jealous of their colleagues if promoted; that is not a good attitude. It would be inspiring if you get motivated by your colleague and do hard work to get the promotion. You should not downgrade your colleagues or feel negative about them.

Cultural Barriers

Cultural barriers act as hurdles in communication in various ways. The people working in an organization often come from different cultures and backgrounds.

- The terms of communication vary between cultures, like having personal space. It is important to find common ground in this kind of situation.
- People sometimes form assumptions based on the other person's culture; this is very common among people. They form certain opinions about a person based on his culture.
- Every organization has its own work culture depending on its structure. You have to adapt to the work culture prevailing in your current company to have effective communication.

Semantic and Language Barriers

Language is a crucial aspect when it comes to communication. There are chances of having the following obstacles:

- The language differences and interpretation between the sender and the recipient.
- Some people may have difficulties in understanding unfamiliar accents.
- Not everyone understands the use of jargon, unfamiliar/regional expressions, abbreviations, slang, and technical terminology.

Other Barriers

- Assumptions, jumping to conclusions, and premature evaluations.
- Impaired eyesight, hearing problems, illness, and pain can hinder effective communication in the workplace.
- Shortage of time to convey the information.
- Selective communication.
- Using too many quotes or proverbs can lead to unclear communication and misinterpretation.

Games and Activities for Effective Communication

Sometimes games and exercises must be established to teach the value of effective communication at the workplace.

Games to Improve Workplace Communication Skills

Back to back drawing:

This game is effective for improving the understanding among the team members. The game should be played by an equal number of employees. Pairs are formed, and they are told to sit back-to-back. Now, one will be the speaker, and the other will be the listener. The speaker will describe a thing to the listener, and the listener has to draw the same with the information that he received without looking at the reference image. The task is to be done in five-ten minutes. At the end of the task, they discuss their experiences.

The listener can ask the following questions:

- What to do while conveying the information that is shared without any misunderstandings?
- How did you plan to tell me the instructions for easy understanding?

The speaker can ask the following questions:

- What were the points that stand out to you while listening?
- What was productive about the instructions given to you?

Effective Feedback In "I" Mode

Defensiveness is the leading cause of miscommunication and even conflicts in the workplace. We are never ready to deal with our negativity, especially when intensely thrown at us. This exercise needs to have a worksheet of imaginary scenarios. The employees can do this solo or in pairs. They need to write their own opinions corresponding to the imaginary scenarios. They have to create "I" statements about what they feel. When done in pairs, they can discuss and ask each other why they would feel that way and give feedback without triggering their defensiveness.

Activities to Improve Communication between Employees

1. **Mimes**

This game can have various numbers of members. This game helps the employees to understand each other without even saying anything. There must be a list of topics to act out in this game. A theme must be decided and a list accordingly. The employees must be divided into pairs. One person will act while the other will have to interpret the actions. The person acting to be a mime cannot speak a word. This way, the understanding skills are enhanced.

1. **Let's Face It**

This game doesn't have a specific number of people. You can make a group of as many members as you want. You will require a pen and paper to play this game. It is a swift game and can be played within 15-20 minutes. Start with a group of 4-10 players. One person will need to volunteer to become a facilitator. The facilitator keeps the game on track. Every player has to write down a feeling and pass it to the facilitator. They take another piece that is not theirs and try to act the emotion. Others have to recognize the emotion. We have to analyze here which emotion was the easiest to guess and which was difficult. This starts a discussion about the role of expressions.

The questions that must be asked after the task is over:

- Which expression was the easiest to recognize?
- Which expression was not all understood or took a long time to understand?
- Can facial expressions lead to miscommunication at the workplace?

The Real-Life Examples of the Impact of Miscommunication / Bad Communication

Case Study 1: The Proposal That Went Unaccepted.

The Green Electric Company developed a new current regulator designed to cut the electric power consumption in aluminum plants by 35% by working day and night tirelessly. Although the competition was much, they were aware that their regulator was designed to be cheaper, more reliable, and more efficient than the competitors' products.

The owner, who was eager to capture the market, personally but somewhat in a hurry, put together a 140-page proposal to the three major aluminum manufacturers, recommending them the regulators his company made to be installed at all company plants.

She wrote the first 87 pages of the proposal about the mathematical theory and engineering design behind this new regulator and the next 52 to describe the new assembly line she planned to set up to produce regulators quickly. The test results were buried under the appendix that compared her regulator's performance with present models and a weakly drawn graph that showed how much the dollar savings would be.

Green Electric didn't get any contracts, despite having the best product. The company filed for bankruptcy just after eight months.

Case Study 2: The Mixed-Up Genres.

Mr. James, while working as a co-op student at the KC Manufacturing plant, was simultaneously enrolled in a university writing course. As part of his co-op job experience, Chris followed his supervisor/mentor on a safety inspection of a plant and was asked to take notes and write up the inspection results in a **compliance memo.** In the

same week, James' writing instructor gave the class an assignment to write a narrative essay based on some personal experience. James, who was trying to be efficient, thought that the plant visit experience could become the basis for his essay assignment.

He wrote the essay because he was used to writing essays and was good at it, but he had never even seen a compliance memo and never written one, so he was not confident about that task. So, he submitted the same article to his supervisor and instructor.

He revised the essay a little bit, doing no change to the introduction, and submitted it to his co-op supervisor. He "aced" the essay, getting an A grade, but his supervisor, on the other hand, told him that the report would not be accepted and would have to be written all over again – especially the beginning of the report, which should have indicated whether or not the plant complied with safety regulations. James was astounded! Using "conclusion" at the beginning was new to him. Because he didn't understand the communication system for both scenarios, he miscommunicated information inappropriately.

Chapter 9 - What is Inclusive Leadership and How to Become an Inclusive Leader.

International research data suggests that in dynamically addressing problems, multicultural teams of problem-solvers outshine groups of the smartest ones. Yet studies in neurobiology and psychology show that our brains can cope with similarities more efficiently, while differences are more challenging and often unpleasant. This explains why people gravitate towards people like them and find it easier to communicate with peers from similar backgrounds and similar behaviors.

Recent research on Mckinsey suggests that "Gender-diverse companies are 15 percent more likely to outperform non-gender diverse companies and ethnically diverse companies outperform in 35% cases."

Forbes Insights mentions that 'The globalization of industry has developed a dynamic, diverse, and competitive world. Businesses need to produce new products and services to be sustainable consistently. And through a diverse and inclusive workforce, the creation of new ideas is ensured.

To boost productivity, promote creativity, and direct corporate strategy, a diverse and inclusive workforce is important. An inclusive workforce contributes more innovative ideas, new programs, and fresh goods and encourages thinking out of the box. Today, corporations no longer see diversity and inclusion strategies as distinct from other business activities and understand that recruiting diverse top talent in its workforce can distinguish them from their rivals and help convert new customers.

Organizations may gain a competitive advantage from shifting dynamics in the workforce and the industry through inclusion. An organization with a reputation for diversity and inclusion becomes a magnet that attracts top candidates, which can be used to penetrate the market, whether in developing economies or within a broad range of customers locally. Transformational leadership can also be ignited by a diverse talent mix, which can help companies differentiate themselves from their competitors.

Yet, inclusion is in itself a challenge. Leaders who entirely support the business case for diversity frequently feel unprepared for it, recognizing that homogeneous teams are easier to manage and are more likely to result in 'group thinking.' Korn Ferry also hears this from consumers through various sectors when explaining this approach: "We do not have an idea of what to do and how to do it better."

Companies have recently expanded their procurement of more diverse talents. There is greater diversity today, by gender, nationality, race, and sexual orientation at the entry and supervisory levels, than five or ten years ago. Today, women have almost 50 percent employment parity with men with higher levels of education and development (International Labor Organization 2018), and 22 percent of the labor force is made up of racial/ethnic minorities in the U.S. (Bureau of Labor Statistics 2018). But several companies are struggling to maintain the talent and advance it to leadership and impact roles.

When it comes to inclusivity, people in power have a significant role to play. Diversity among professionals in business is seen as both strength and a weakness. When the latter exceeds the former, a leader's effectiveness is tested. Constant and potent efforts to turn diversity as a source of conflict into a vital pillar of an organization are among the many duties of a good leader or manager.

Although the consequences of non-inclusive leadership are responded to differently between individuals and between groups, there are a few caution warnings to watch out for and frequent disadvantages.

Micro-aggressions: Dr. Derald Sue described microaggression as "the regular slights, indignities, condescending remarks and slurs that in their regular interactions with people of color, women, Queer groups or those who are oppressed encounter." While each microaggression itself is minor, the overall impact can be enormous, causing frustration, lower productivity, and ultimately leaving ones' career**.**

The employees carry the responsibility of being represented. There can be pressure to deliver beyond expectations when they are the only person on a team in a certain group or with a particular requirement. They also face trade-offs that other colleagues do not encounter.

They make less money: The wage gap is a chronic issue, parallel to grappling with segregation, microaggression, and the burden of inclusion. Women, individuals of color, and other oppressed groups receive less cash for similar jobs.

Take Note of Implicit Bias

Harvard scientists suggest that the classification of individuals based on groups of similar characteristics causes an unconscious bias. These characteristics are gender, age, skin color, weight, ethnicity, sexual orientation, accent, etc. Individuals are also grouped according to appearance, financial status, educational qualifications, social standing, and work profile.

While this process helps simplify and process more information about people in less time, it also builds assumptions. People react or behave with any individual out of their own 'category' because of such unconscious beliefs. Such is the practice of stereotypes ingrained in human minds that it becomes difficult letting go of a pre-existing prejudice.

Lack of exposure to diverse groups of people contributes to increasing bias. No matter how much a person wishes to be fair, there is a negative part of them that chooses to judge and rebel.

In corporate culture, conscious efforts to hire and promote deserving individuals of diverse classes have been picked as a trend.

As a leader, one needs to be vigilant towards ill-behavior with different people done by their colleagues, if they are a part of the organization. In a heavily homogenous crowd, the leader must introduce more diverse talent. Keeping a check on their subordinates' social media handles also gives a clearer picture.

While making a point to observe apparent behaviors towards the diverse group, it is crucial to be clear in presenting them a opportunity to prove themselves. Mutual trust between superiors and subordinates takes time to build. But once a leader proves to be successful in making an outsider comfortable, they open up, share their ideas and opinions, and make any project viewed from different angles. It helps build solid interpersonal friendships and relationships.

Proffer a Good Network Support Structure

Networking is one of the prerequisites for communication channels in any organization. It is the humble duty of the leader to facilitate a structured network among the subordinates and appropriate it in the most reliable way feasible.

Individuals belonging to each type of diverse group has the right to come forward to voice his or her take on the

general issue. A face-to-face medium of communication is the key to get things done. When people consult others regarding specific issues, they open doors to interpersonal communication.

An effective support system makes the diverse and discriminated realize that they are not isolated in a relatively homogenous group. When allowed to reflect their opinions, new or different people believe that their opinion matters.

When there is a positive support network, one can receive judgment-free feedback for their opinions. Constructive criticism helps an individual be a better version of themselves and having feedback about their ideas and opinions help a person realize what changes they have to make in themselves.

Challenges are part of life. Having a supportive network of employees and subordinates ensures that many challenges will be addressed appropriately with the right mindset. Learning ways to tackle challenges in life prepares one for life as well.

For promoting the inclusivity of various diverse groups in an organization, a leader should invest efforts in creating a platform for every individual working under him or her to reflect and feel welcomed. One of the telltale signs of a well-supportive network is the absence of personal bias among the subordinates on professional grounds.

In the case of a group with racial, ethnic, sexual, or any other kind of diversity, the leader needs to first listen to them to gain their trust. Mutual trust is the basis of building a good network of support. For starters, the leaders must be well versed in verbal and non-verbal types of communication. Newly employed individuals with different backgrounds might feel intimidated to directly speak up about their problems or disagreements. In situations as such, the leader has to take the initiative of being a reasonable observer.

Develop a Conducive Environment for Open Discourse

In her book 'How to be an Inclusive Leader,' author and humanist Jennifer Brown state that more than fifty percent of the millennial population today will be engaged as a corporate workforce in 2020. And those will only strive in a workplace environment where there is a general air of acceptance and inclusion.

The task of empowering the silenced is the duty of a leader. Thus, to begin building a comfortable environment for their subordinates, a leader is supposed to unite them together and by politely asking for permission to do so. Even though a superior might not need it, asking for permission assures voluntary participation and opens people's minds towards the same. It is accepted that inclusivity should be the norm, but it perishes due to various biases. That is where asking for permission does the deed of an indirect command.

As a leader, letting subordinates feel responsible is very necessary. After all, they are sheep but rather sensible human beings capable of making a conscious decision of the path to tow. By asking for permission to react in a certain way, the leader mentions rules in a softer, subtler manner.

The leader can bring back the main point of any conversation or discussion among the team when it gets off-track. With many people on the table, discussions often get diverted into less relevant subjects. In such scenarios, the leader has to be harsh and ask the subordinates to be back on track. Since shutting people up counts as rude behavior, a leader asks for such permission beforehand.

For any discussion to reach a progressive and germane outcome, every panel member needs to contribute their opinions. Being an introvert might be a personal characteristic, but voicing an individual's angle is fundamental in a corporate environment. Therefore, it becomes the leader's duty to call out on individuals who aren't particularly vocal.

Simultaneously, if certain members of the discussion panel are overtly outspoken and try to dominate or intimidate the new or different members, it becomes necessary to hold them back. No matter the knowledge or experience, no individual should harm any fellow mate's self-esteem. Due to prejudice against certain distinct groups, people often fire offensive comments, and they need to be kept under control. Doing this is the leader's duty while asking permission beforehand as not to cause any further discrepancies.

Certain subjects need more attention than others to bring something good out of them. A leader can instruct his or her team to focus on more critical issues.

Any leader is bound to be seen as threatening or dominating at first, but it is the leader's job to prove the

preconceived notions as incorrect. Therefore, a leader should start using phrases like 'May I ask a question?' or 'May I guide you here?' to seem friendly and approachable.

The Harvard Business Review opined that every individual should feel heard and appreciated. Involving people of all types of groups increases broader conversations and a safe ambiance to voice opinions and concerns.

As a Leader, Practice Transparency and Seek Input

There is nothing as impressive about a leader as to ask for reviews about themselves; this creates a clear perception about the leader, which inspires the subordinates to practice honesty and transparency. This quality also helps diverse groups gain confidence.

Ed Catmull, the co-founder of Pixar movie studio, used to practice an 'open-door policy,' which meant that his subordinates were free to approach him anytime they wanted. Despite being such open, they did not turn to him during the time of a crisis. The reason was him not explicitly asking. If one assumes his subordinates would trust him or her without any encouraging interaction, they would be wrong.

There is a strategy, especially coined for this concept, known as the Round Robin. The strategy requires one to go around the room and ask each person individually when they need to get a response from someone in the community.

The magic of this strategy is that we stop waiting for our brightest, most capable employees to volunteer, and we can stop allowing the discussion to be monopolized by the most optimistic, least talented individuals.

Asking for multiple feedbacks without changing the pattern is not recommended. To work as a team on improvements, the leader ought to have a transparent discussion with every member. Doing so will make all groups of people feel they have a voice worth being heard. Since there is no single code of conduct to solve every problematic situation, combined efforts of superiors and subordinates can bring about the desired change.

Challenge Assumptions and Incorporate Innovative Ideas

There might be a certain group of people in a work environment that does not include different people. A leader has to make sure not to allow such discrimination to stand.

Having a homogenous set of workforce may narrow creativity and innovation. To have a fresh perspective on present issues and novel ideas, individuals from different sections of society ought to be included. Fresh perspective must always be welcomed because society is changing minute by minute, and one never knows when some new concept has overtaken old beliefs.

To include individuals belonging to different sects, the leader or manager can schedule their meeting while inviting new talent along with them. This increases interpersonal bonding between the both. Aside from that, the employee belonging to the discriminated background gains self-respect by being included.

For the record, maintaining equality among officials has been an inspiring trend since the times of King Arthur. He used to hold meetings along with his knights at a round table. This symbolized equal say of every member and that none was above another. Since the round table does not have a head or a tail position, no one can claim more importance than others, and each person's opinions were given the same amount of attention.

Acknowledge that You Might Not Know Everything

It is okay not to understand everything. What will describe a leader is how they cope with this awareness deficit.

Being a competent leader is part of being dedicated to one's own learning and development. Around the same time as new methods in the field are implemented, new thoughts are formed, communication, and sharing are also encouraged. Inclusive leaders understand that no one has all the answers and that strategies to enhance their managerial skills and the talents and expertise of everyone in the team need to be involved.

Having Cultural and Emotional Intelligence

The ability to communicate and function efficiently through various cultures can be viewed as cultural intelligence. These cultures can be based on regional or indigenous cultural lines or even distinct corporate cultures.

Generally, the four areas that cultural intelligence is described are cognition, metacognition, motivational intelligence, and intelligence of actions.

Inclusive leaders understand that not everyone sees challenges and opportunities through the same prism. Nor do all people handle their feelings in the same way. Leading a team involves awareness of how people react to various types of leadership.

When a leader gives time attending to their frustrations, one person on the team may admire it, while another may turn to the leader for a motivational monologue. Trying to develop good emotional agility will enable a leader to inspire and help each team member using different organizational strategies.

Policymakers often regard collectivism and individualism as fundamentally exclusive and conflicting management forms. Collectivism refers to prioritizing the collective efforts over individual members, whereas the converse is individualism. A strong leader would understand that collectivism and individualism should not conflict with each other but can be complementary and contextual in practice.

Getting this cultural consciousness may help avoid and effectively manage potential tensions that can arise from the participation of an individualist executive in a collectivist project and vice versa. Thus, depending on the context, both frameworks will exist simultaneously.

Maintaining a Steady Degree of Inclusion

The practice of including diverse groups in employment is not a one-time investment. Discrepancies still exist globally, and working towards hiring and nurturing more diverse groups of people should be a relatively long-term plan.

Including any individual as part of the team does not mean a great philanthropic deed. A leader must find opportunities to help out talented people in need as much as possible.

Sixty-five percent of 321 prominent global corporate leaders polled by Forbes Insights said they had a strategy in place to hire a diverse workforce, but only 44 percent employ retention programs; this means there is still a void in societal development.

Therefore, just including diverse groups is not the whole and sole objective of inclusive leadership, but retaining makes a great deal of a difference.

Diversity and Inclusion Activities for making Stronger teams

Knowing the employee's background

Create an opportunity to learn more about where your employees come from and what is important to shape their lives. By doing this as a group, employees can learn new things about each other that might not have emerged. Openness, honesty, and vulnerability are great ways to build relationships, strengthen empathy, and improve relationships.

Ask everyone to think of the three most important moments of their life and keep them in separate posts (remote teams can try virtual boards like miro).

Let each employee present these moments to the team and comfortably share their story.

Try to be in someone’s else shoes

Harvard Business evaluation suggests “perspective-taking” to be the best way of walking mentally in another person's shoes. Use the following steps to guide your team through this activity.

Ask your team to share the different types of backgrounds represented on their team (educational qualification, sexual orientation, gender, and caste, etc.).

Pair each team member so that the group has people from different backgrounds.

Have each person write a few lines about the unique challenges they have paired with the background group.

Share and debate with the entire team or make small groups discussion.

These considerations will create a more empathetic team, and, according to a Harvard study, it will help build positive approaches and attitudes towards minorities. The study also shows increased support for and "commitment to reducing harassment of marginalized minorities."

Chapter 10 - Benefits from Investing in Diversity and Inclusion

Most of the companies want to apply the concept of Diversity and Inclusion. This concept has shown excellent results in organizations, so every organization wants to practice Diversity & Inclusion (D&I). You may have heard of this term many times by now. The corporate world loves the concept of Diversity & Inclusion due to the increasing benefits.

Companies that adopt diversity and inclusion in all phases of their business statistically outperform their competitors. – ***Josh Bersin***

Workplace diversity is becoming very successful in the HR world. Organizations are making diversity and inclusion their priority and investing more than ever into the resources that lead to success. They have formed special teams to look into it. It is a very clever decision to consider diversity and inclusion as the organization's primary focus and the right thing to be done for humanity.

Building a Diverse Organization

The dimension used to differentiate groups and people from one another is known as diversity. In short, encouraging and empowering people who are different and respecting them is diversity. They can be different in terms of age, religion, gender, sexual orientation, disability, ethnicity, education, and nationality.

Diversity is a broad concept that allows you to explore your differences positively and nurture them appropriately. Understanding and tolerance increase between people by valuing the differences. The dimensions of diversity in each person must be embraced and celebrated in the company. Every individual in the organization introduces their perspectives, work, life experiences, cultural and religious differences. These differences and the power of diversity can benefit the organization.

Having an Inclusive Workforce

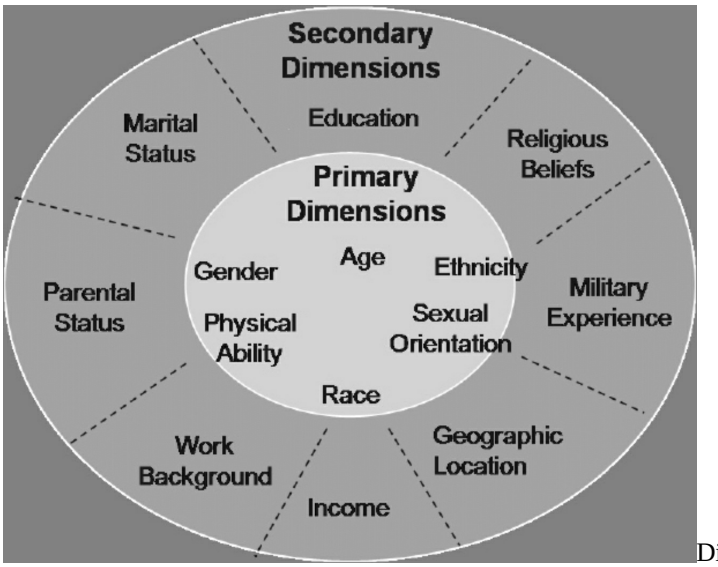
Inclusion in an organization means that all different groups or individuals having different backgrounds are socially accepted and welcomed in the company. The people having different cultural backgrounds are equally treated. The differences could be apparent, such as age, race, origin, religion, gender, marital status, and economic status. The people could also have different educational backgrounds, training, organizational tenure, and there could even be a difference in personalities, such as being introverts and extroverts. Inclusion makes an individual feel valued about who they are as individuals or groups. The culture of inclusion in an organization always has visible effects. They are seen in company meetings, how offices are physically arranged, or access to certain facilities in offices. The process of inclusion makes everyone feel important to the organization's success.

In simple terms, diversity is the mix, and inclusion is getting the mix to work well together.

Why Do We Need Diversity and Inclusion (D&I) In the Workplace?

The beginning of globalization has resulted in a demographic shift, with the rise in mobility in migrant workers traveling to every corner of the globe for growth in their careers. The key driver of economic growth worldwide is the increasing requirement of talented and skilled workforce resulting in diversity. A diverse workforce provides social harmony at work and helps increase the profitability and productivity of the organization. These factors will help the organization gain a successful position in the global market.

Dimensions of Diversity



Diversity has many dimensions depending on age, sex, gender, sexuality, etc. Diversity is very much more than how we look or are thought to be.

To grasp this properly, let us look at some of the dimensions individually:

Ageism

One of the most common types of discrimination observed in a typical orthodox organization is Ageism. It refers to ignoring the inputs and contributions of people who reach a certain senior age. In the United States of America, people above 65 are often referred to as senior citizens. These people find it difficult to get employment at this age and neglected at the workplace (if they manage to find one). The worst part is that they are often subject to abuse or are ignored at workplaces.

Gender Discrimination

Traditional organizations have been observed to follow the male-dominant structure where females are ignored or given lesser opportunities than the opposite sex. Not only this, females are subject to receiving comparatively less compensation for jobs. It has been observed that women have been biased against worldwide when it comes to education, health, political system, or employment.

Religion

Modern world organizations consist of people from various walks of life who follow different religions. Countries like the United States of America have the majority of the population as Christians. However, the organizations cannot just recruit people based on the religion they practice but should instead concentrate more on the caliber and potential of the candidate. If you want to create an Inclusive organization, then religious bias should not have a place in your organization.

Disability

This refers to mental or physical impairment that limits primary life activities. These disabilities might be from birth or a result of an unfortunate incident. However, no discrimination should be allowed in the organization towards any employee. Not only that, team members should be given equal opportunities and inclusion in the organization.

Economic Stature

Economic stature or class is related to the financial status of the individual. An organization that belittles people with lesser financial capacities can never have an inclusive organization. Although such employees do not have equal economic status, this does not mean that they have lesser capabilities or deserve lesser respect or inclusion. Their vulnerability should never be a matter of joke or humiliation, and the organizations should have strict policies for such incidents.

Better Customer Experience

When talking about modern-day organizations, clients from various segments cater to the company's business. It is always advantageous for the organizations if the customers are dealt with by someone who can relate to their group or segment. The contribution of diversity and inclusion in providing a better customer experience is enormous.

The management must always look for suitable people for a particular task based on their group or segment. For example, a company looking to expand its operations in Asian countries must look for an employee who knows the culture, language, traditions, or geography of the particular nation where they decide to spread their wings. This would enhance the importance of the employees and result in better outcomes.

Better Decisions and Problem Solving

It is expected that people belonging to the same group have similar opinions. Having a diverse workforce stops groupthink. It helps to discuss innovative ideas from various groups, leading to better and clear decisions. When the diverse groups are provided with the opportunity to present their views, a different set of opinions and suggestions opens up numerous possibilities.

A diverse employee strength also helps to solve problems quickly and efficiently. The fundamental reason is that these groups do not think alike and hence provide a variety of point-of-view. All of them look at the issue differently, and their perspective leads to multiple options to solve the problem at hand.

Case-Study

A better dynamic is vital to better monetary returns. As indicated by research directed by Bain and Co., choice viability and budgetary outcomes are connected at a 95% certainty level. Those organizations best at settling on choices have monetary returns almost 6% higher than those of different organizations.

IMPORTANCE OF DIVERSITY IN DECISION

So, what is it about diversity that empowers organizations to settle on better choices? While homogeneity may hush individuals into intuition, they are settling on better choices (since everybody concurs with one another), perspectives that challenge each other hone the exhibition of groups.

A Harvard Business Review article named, "Assorted Teams Feel Less Comfortable – and That's Why They Perform Better" underscores this point. While examining an investigation of dynamic where members needed to settle a homicide secret, the writers compose:

On a homogenous group, individuals promptly see one another, and cooperation streams easily, giving the impression of progress. Managing untouchables causes grating, which feels counterproductive.

One other HBR publication, "Why Diverse Teams Are Smarter" addresses some of the reasons why various group delivers better outcomes. These reasons include:

- They spotlight more on realities. This is because they may all the more intently investigate each other's activities. They become less settled in "bunch figure," which may daze them to key snippets of data.
- They cycle realities all the more cautiously. This is because they are thinking about individuals who think uniquely in contrast to what they do.
- They are more imaginative. This is because similarity demoralizes creative reasoning; differing views support better approaches to perspective issues.

What can your organization never really better choices?

Settling on better choices initially requires a pledge to diversity. That requires building groups that are age, sex, ethnically, and topographically different. As indicated by the Cloverpop study, groups that are various in each one of those zones settle on better business choices 87% of the time.

Secondly, groups need comprehensive pioneers who, as per Bourke and Espedido, treat everybody reasonably and deferentially, esteem their assessment, give a feeling of having a place, and cause colleagues to feel mentally sheltered.

Third, colleagues need to tune in and think about the assessments of others. Regarding information and investigation, numerous individuals will say, "the numbers don't lie," and feel there is just a single understanding of the information. Have you thought about the explanations behind the numbers? Would you be able to dive in further to discover the main drivers? Solid information trust and administration can help here. However, it also assists with thinking about different perspectives and goes to a joint agreement on what the numbers are appearing and how you ought to react to what they are demonstrating to you.

Diversity matters. Inclusion does as well. These are basic for building a culture where workers feel esteemed and welcome, making them more beneficial. It also empowers better choices, which helps the money-related execution of organizations.

Is diversity hard? Indeed. Most business pioneers will search out and encircle themselves with individuals who feel and act how they do. It tends to be hard to progress to better finding and enlisting ability, just as building interior groups. In any case, is diversity justified, despite all the trouble? From both a human and a budgetary viewpoint, the appropriate response is undoubted yes.

The Organization’s Reputation

One of the advantages of having a diverse and inclusive work environment is that the company’s image is improved. When the company is known for its diverse culture, the brand image improves, and the opportunities and profitability increases. Having a diverse and inclusive organization is good for the company and the outside world.

People will start recognizing you as an organization with good ethics and work environment. Your organization also gains PR by building a reputation for recruiting people from diverse segments that support its community. Moreover, you attract better candidates if you build your reputation as an organization by giving equal opportunity to all without bias.

Existence

We no longer live in geographically confined locations where the organizations have limits to do business or expand operations. With the advent of the internet, the scope of growth has become limitless. You not only grow, but you penetrate beyond the traditional extent. Having a rigid organizational structure would do more harm than good. Gone are the days when rules were set to follow, and organizations were required to operate in specific ways. The modern scenario demands that you adapt and change the old-fashioned management style.

Although the scope has become tremendous, the fight to survive has also become severe. You know what they say – *"By being rigid, you become temporary; by being flexible, you become permanent!"*

— Mehmet Murat ildan.

Modern-day organizations operate on the pillars of diversity and inclusion. Gone are the days when a particular segment based on gender, caste, color, and ethnicity had the upper hand. With advancements in our education system and enhanced knowledge, people from every segment require recognition, opportunity, and equal rights. It would be unreasonable not to support the trend.

The organization is built on the efforts and hard work of its employees. If you want them to perform to their fullest potential, you need to ensure that they stay happy working. How do you do that? Well, the answer is – by giving them equal opportunity, having an inclusive culture where everyone can put forward their views, not being biased to any particular segment, giving equal respect to everyone, and having an amicable relationship with your team. This begins when you start building your organization by using diverse people and practicing inclusion from the onset.

Various investigations have been performed to show how diversity and inclusion would prove advantageous for organizations in times to come. Why not start taking advantage of it now by practicing it? If you are in for the long run, it is imperative to build your reputation as an inclusive and diverse organization.

Diverse executive workers translate to better financial performance

Desirable change in an organization should start at the top. Advancing ethnically and sex diverse administration groups make noteworthy incentives in an organization. When organizations address ethnic and social diversity at the top level, workers realize that they genuinely comprehend and value the clients and network they serve.

In a 2018 Mckinsey report, "Organization structure in the top-quartile for sexual orientation diversity on their chief groups were 21% bound to have better than expected productivity than organizations in the fourth quartile. For ethnic/social diversity, top-quartile organizations were 33% bound to beat on productivity."

Sodexo, a worldwide neighborliness administration, needed to accomplish sex balance for diversity. After investigation, the organization understood that a more remarkable portrayal of ladies in the board positions related to unrivaled execution on measures, for example, consumer loyalty and worker commitment. From that point forward, the organization has vowed to expand the quantity of senior female chiefs to 40% by 2025.

For organizations that have conquered the test of holding a diverse organization, they're one stride ahead to construct a diverse leader group.

Psychologically Diverse Groups Quicken Dynamic

Psychological diversity is characterized as the inclusion of various critical thinking styles and points of view and how people consider and draw in with new, complex circumstances, as per Harvard Business Review. In contrast to ethnic or sex diversity, intellectual diversity isn't anticipated by variables, for example, sexual orientation, nationality, or age. It's additionally not effectively noticeable from an external perspective. Accordingly, it expects us to work more enthusiastically to perceive these inborn contrasts and surface them. For instance, Harvard Business

Review estimated psychological diversity with a system execution task among various groups in an ongoing examination study. They found that the gatherings of the equivalent ranges of abilities, the distinction in age and sex, fizzled in intellectual diversity. Groups with a similar sexual orientation, age, and instruction "demonstrate[d] a serious extent of intellectual diversity and solve[d] the undertaking at speed."

Intellectually diverse groups get unique views from one another to division level or venture level choices. As indicated by Cloverpop, "exceptionally diverse groups were twice as bound to both settle on better decisions and convey results that met or surpassed desires."

Like any new methodology, intellectual diversity has its difficulties. However, whenever done right, it can bring positive change. Intellectually diverse groups strengthen cooperation, think outside about the container, and challenge each other to not fit into what every other person is thinking or doing or how they'd approach a circumstance or settle on a choice. Unique people concerning a diverse workforce will see things differently and bring new thoughts dependent on their unmistakable encounters and foundations. This isn't to state you should employ or advance individuals who are bad at their specific employment role just for diversity.

There are several strategies to make your work environment more diverse and comprehensive. For further contemplations, determine how you can utilize the latest California sex personality guideline to make your work environment more comprehensive.

Chapter 11 – Inclusive Conversations and Meetings

In every organization, meetings take place regularly, and one of the most common mistakes during meetings is that not everyone is allowed to present their point of view. When we talk about creating an inclusive workplace, let us not forget that it would be reflected in the way you hold meetings. It is important to ensure that no discrimination, bias, or favoritism occurs concerning gender, sexuality, race, or religion.

This chapter would focus on the concept of Inclusive meetings and conversation. It can act as a guiding stick for the HR and managers while conversing with their employees or holding a meeting. You would understand the clear meaning of Inclusive Meetings and what steps to take to ensure that your meetings do not appear biased or single-sided.

Moreover, you would also find the steps to hold meetings properly, what to look out for during meetings, and how to promote inclusivity in your meetings. The information entailed in this chapter explains the importance of inclusive meetings in creating an inclusive organization.

Understanding Inclusive Meetings

Let us try to understand what precisely an inclusive meeting is. The word ‘inclusive’ is derived from the word inclusion. When the team or department holds a meeting in the company, it is crucial that every member feels involved.

Often, peers try to put their instruction and decisions out in these meetings, which is wrong. A meeting is not meant for handing out instructions. The primary purpose of the meeting should be to have an open-ended discussion with all those concerned about a matter.

This is why it is called an inclusive meeting since all members get a chance to contribute their analysis or opinions. An important thing to remember while conducting such meetings is that ‘no one is allowed to be given special treatment and everyone is given equal opportunity and importance.’ “*If they are invited to the meeting, their*

presence should matter and add value to the discussion."

The basic purpose of an all-inclusive meeting is to make everyone feel involved, and equal consideration is given to their voice.

Rules to Inclusive Meeting

Always remember that all meetings have a specific purpose. To achieve that purpose, proper rules must be set for the meeting to inform the attendees about their role and contribution. With the advent of all-inclusive organizational structures, every person involved in the meeting must be given a fair opportunity to communicate their ideas and opinions on the matter at hand.

Note that everyone attending the meeting would eventually ask themselves, was the meeting worth it or not? What will happen if they are not given a chance to speak their thoughts or give suggestions? They would not value attending such meetings or develop hatred towards the leader. Eventually, this will lead to lesser involvement, efforts, and commitment from the member.

Remember that the purpose of an inclusive meeting extends beyond the matter at hand. It would reflect how the organization operates and its culture. When the employees are given a chance to voice their opinions, they feel much more involved and committed to the company. One basic importance is that they are getting a feeling of importance, which is enough to boost their morale.

Decide whether you want to create an inclusive environment for your organization or not? Reflect on the decision in your meetings. Meetings are not just about creating agendas, keeping the minutes, resolving conflict, or time management.

Hiring candidates from various aspects of life, irrespective of their race, religion, sexuality, gender, has a reason. You hired them for their intellect. There is no point in exhibiting your seniority in these meetings since the purpose of the inclusive meeting is to get everyone's contribution and come to a proper conclusion.

If you are not clear on where to begin, then start with focusing on these critical areas or rules:

Maintaining Diversity: It is very important to make sure that your group of attendees represent diversity. Check out the diversity in your organization and choose attendees based on that. This would make the employees feel important as it would give them a chance to represent their group.

- **Agenda**

It is equally important to send out the meeting agenda in advance so that the people attending the meeting could prepare themselves in advance. It would save much time, and the meetings can be more productive. Sending out the meeting agenda in advance is always a good practice.

- **Greeting the Attendees**

It may appear to be less important to greet the people attending the meeting, but it's not. Greeting makes the employees feel more welcomed and important. They would feel more comfortable sharing their opinions clearly and confidently.

- **Rules for Meeting**

Explicitly mention the meeting rules and make sure that it does not have any form of bias.

- **Mediating**

As the host or team leader, it would be your job to ensure that the meeting is adequately mediated. Make sure they all gets a fair chance to speak and that no one is allowed to dominate the other. Also, it would be best if you don't tolerate any interruptions. You would also need to watch who speaks and who does not. he

- **Consistent Engagement**

Your role also involves being constantly engaged in the discussion. You must be actively involved from the

beginning to the end.

- **Follow-up**

It is a good practice to take feedback after the meeting is concluded. It would help you to reflect on what went wrong or right. It will help you take the necessary actions and precautions for your next meeting.

Leading an Inclusive Meeting

As a leader, you must maintain the inclusion and involvement of everyone attending a meeting. However, it is not an easy task but an achievable one. Your job is to ensure that no discrimination occurs during the session and that everyone is given a chance to speak up. As per a study done by Harvard Business Research, only 35% of employees feel comfortable during meetings. That means only 3 out of 10 attending a meeting would contribute properly since the rest are not equally comfortable.

The attendees should respect you enough to follow you but not fear and hide behind the curtains. You would need to make an extra effort to develop trust and respect amongst your teammates to lead the inclusive meeting.

Here are some things to have in mind:

- **Giving Proper Attention and Space**

Basic things like listening attentively, maintaining proper eye contact, body language, avoiding strong reactions during these meetings are important. You must develop and follow such skills during inclusive meetings. This must be done without any bias.

An interesting study published by Brigham Young and Princeton Universities states that males consume 75% of the conversion during the meeting. Another study done by George Washington University supports it by concluding that men interrupt women more than they do to other men (close to 33%). As a meeting leader, you must keep these figures in your mind while you conduct your team meeting.

- **Augmenting Support**

You will often find a particular employee being interrupted. You should play a supportive role to such employees to finish making their comments or giving inputs. This instills a feeling of belonging because of the leader's support. You can also expect better inputs from such employees since they realize they can count on your support.

Major thing to be cautious about is while you are supporting one employee, you do not develop hostility with the other. This has to be done adroitly, so neither feels unsupportive. Your job as a leader is to give your employees space and comfort during meetings.

One of the most ingenious ways of dealing with introverts during meetings is by giving a hint to the employee beforehand. While you address the other team members, you can hint the employee to prepare for his turn to speak next. This displays your understanding and support for such types of employees.

- **Playing the role of a Facilitator**

Before you decide to play your role as a facilitator, understand that your job also entails being heard, and so you need to have a clear and loud voice. You can only be effective if your voice is loud, clear, and authoritative.

Another critical thing to observe while you host an inclusive meeting is to prevent conformity bias. Conformity bias entails people agreeing with you even though they do not want to because they feel pressured by everyone else agreeing with you during the meeting.

Different Ways to Run an Inclusive Meeting

Meetings are an essential part of every organization's day-to-day operations. This is irrespective of whether your

team is working in an office, working remotely, or distributed.

The reality of the modern era is that the traditional approach to meetings is heavily in favor of the outspoken, confident Alphas. But since we are talking about diversity, equity, and inclusion in the workplace, it is imperative to speak of an entirely new layer of meeting hygiene to ensure that your meetings are more accessible, inclusive, and therefore more effective.

As organizations today continue to navigate the maze of daily standups, Slack check-ins, Zoom all-hands, here are different ways you can run more inclusive meetings:

Only invite those who are needed to be in the meeting; however, also ensure that it is a diverse list

The first thing you can do to build meeting hygiene within your organization is by carefully screening people you are inviting.

Ask yourself if it is essential to ask an individual to attend the meeting or make them productively perform on their allotted task. Make it a new norm to un-invite yourself or opt-out if you find that your presence is not worth the time.

Second, ask yourself if you include a diverse range of perspectives and experiences. There are certain workplace cultures where negative meeting behaviors get people excluded from meetings even though they are key decision-makers in a specific topic.

Develop alternate forms of communication during the meeting

As we discussed earlier, confident people are given more opportunities to share their ideas in modern workplaces. However, the objective of an all-inclusive meeting is to ensure that everyone's voice is heard and given equal importance. This is especially true even if the person isn't comfortable speaking up in front of a group or fighting to be heard.

Once you have provided the meeting agenda well in advance to the meeting attendees, it gives them a chance to be more prepared and feels confident expressing their thoughts.

It is extremely vital to develop different forms of communication during the meeting so that everyone feels confident to contribute most comfortably, whether it's with or without video, through text or chat, or all of the above. Below are some options you can provide:

- Speaking up during the meeting independently
- Encouraging text-based contributions added to the chatbox of a video conference
- Enabling contributors to send first and last thoughts through email before and after a meeting takes place

Become an example that you wish to set for the other employees

Take the initiative to become a good listener, redirect the conversation back to someone interrupted, or give credit to someone who has provided an excellent idea. All these things will create positive change within your company culture.

Keep this in mind: A good meeting will always align with your strategy, coordinate efforts, and refresh your team about where it is headed. Whereas a bad meeting does the opposite – it frustrates high performers, distracts from important tasks, and wastes valuable time every year.

Caution against Common Biased Practices

Unconscious bias has been the major culprit against introverts, women, and remote workers, making them struggle to be heard during the meetings. Let's look at some of the tactics to be more inclusive during the meetings.

Let's take a look at a few statistics before proceeding further.

Companies who proclaim to have a robust workforce report grow their market share 45% more often than others. A research done by the Center for Talent Innovation, says, that they are 70% more likely to capture a new market. The question is, why?

The reason being, a group that consists of demographically diverse individuals with diverse experiences, can help in achieving cognitive diversity.

Cognitive diversity – diverse perspectives, problem-solving methods and thought patterns – helps produce better solutions.

According to Julia Taylor Kennedy, Executive Vice President at CTI, "When you have the experience of being the 'other,' even though it is because you purposefully put yourself in those circumstances, you develop compassion for people who are outside the majority."

In case we don't counteract the sub-conscious biases, we have and create an environment where everyone can contribute, we don't get any advantage from that diversity.

This is where inculcating a culture of inclusive meetings is fast emerging as a competitive advantage. To form such a culture, it is imperative to understand that certain biases sabotage the effectiveness of teams. This requires an adjustment in our approach towards meeting facilitation.

Kennedy further says, "Inclusive leaders are conditioned to pave the way for an environment that is conducive to propose fresh ideas which everyone hears without any biases. This builds a sense of belonging amongst the team's various groups."

There are majorly three types of bias that can sabotage the value of your meeting.

- **"People who react first are great thinkers."**

This can have a adverse influence on introverts. For example, let's say you ask a group where they plan to have dinner tonight? You might think that the person who raises a finger first has the best answer, just because s/he raised their fingers first. Culinary specialist who appears to be a little shy is running through his/her mental list of the most wonderful local restaurants. This person can give you a more credible source of information. The only problem with this is that s/he takes time to contemplate before s/he speaks.

- **"Out of sight, out of mind."**

This is one of the most significant biases affecting those who cannot understand proximity during the meeting. People who are joining over the phone or video are the ones who face this prejudice. We, humans, have been hard-wired to pay attention to those who are in physical proximity to us. It is rare to exclude people from joining remotely, however intentionally, there's a tendency to forget their online presence easily.

- **"Men can contribute more than women."**

It has often been found that men interrupt women far more often than their women counterparts. Perhaps this has more to do with the fact that women know more about or men reiterate the women's idea as if it is their own. This is where the terms "interruption," "mansplaining," and "appropriation" come into the picture. The fact of the matter is, although men do not do this intentionally, it is persuasive as proven by research.

We'll probably never be able to eliminate these biases because they exist in our subconscious minds. They're there in our default settings. However, the trick is to use our conscious brains to override them.

Remember: Just like a culture shift, building a culture of inclusion takes patience and commitment. However, as enumerated above, it is not very difficult. No one has to be excluded for someone to be included. There is a reason for each person to attend the meeting.

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Chapter 12 - Real-Life Cases of Prejudice and Inclusion in the Workplace

At workplaces, individuals are prejudiced against owing to various parameters. There has been discrimination based on age, gender, race, religion, sexual orientation, physical conditions, cultural background, or country of origin. Even though the world is moving towards building unity and not letting such differences hinder, deep-rooted prejudice still exists. Here are some real-life case studies of workplace prejudice as well as inclusion.

Microsoft - Workplace Discrimination against Women.

The American multinational company has seen several ups and downs. Since its foundations, the tech giants have worked from the ground level to achieve holistic success. However, 238 women working in the technical department filed a lawsuit in early 2018. The complaint was regarding gender discrimination against women from 2010 through 2016. The women claimants say that the intrinsic ranking system of the firm discriminates against females and inhibits women's professional progression.

Microsoft turned over years of documents to the plaintiffs' attorneys as part of the class validation process and civil investigation. Missouri's counsel, Michael Submit, wrote in the Monday-released filing that "Microsoft's Community is riddled with Sexual Abuse." Specifically, submit added that Microsoft's organizational unit (known as "ERIT") received 108 sexual harassment allegations filed by female US-based technical staff, 119 genders - based discrimination allegations, eight retaliation accusations, and three pre-repression concerns.

Since the 1980s, Microsoft has been prevalent in cases of gender / racial discrimination and sexual harassment. In the 1980s, the organization was also said to be the "most disdainful place for women to work." Microsoft only had just a few hundred employees in its early years, most of them men. Those who edited technical documents were the only women working at Microsoft. In the business, the work culture was by and large disorganized. According to researchers, all the practices, qualities, and characteristics that were not appropriate in traditional society were extremely common in the business.

Microsoft was a geeks' delight, where issues such as communication skills and personal grooming were not relevant, and women's participation was scarcely accepted. It was the basis of newly formed computer nerds, who prided themselves on becoming masters of their fields where women had yet to participate actively and were highly suspicious of their female counterparts' abilities.

A board member said Microsoft Corp (MSFT.O) extensively addresses problems posed in the workplace by women and fired about 20 workers last year over sexual harassment allegations as the organization tries to address arguments that it wrongly handles female staff. In an email to workers, Microsoft Chief People Officer Kathleen Hogan said that Microsoft had 83 abuse reports from a U.S.-based workforce of over 65,000 workers in 2017.

After an inquiry, almost 50 percent were found to be sponsored at least in part, she said, and more than half of those culminated in firing an employee engaging in inappropriate conduct. The exceptional disclosure of such details comes as the major tech firm in the world is fighting a lawsuit claiming that women have been systematically denied pay increases or upgrades. Microsoft disputes that it has ever had such a policy. Microsoft also investigated 84 gender discrimination allegations.

Racial Discrimination

With unemployment rate descending to its lowest level in 50 years, the U.S. jobs market has now seen a historic 109 months of uninterrupted job development. African American employees, nevertheless, still face more obstacles than their white peers to having a job, never mind a decent one. Systematically, they continue to experience higher levels of unemployment, fewer work prospects, reduced wages, poorer benefits, and greater job insecurity. These enduring disparities represent systemic barriers to quality employment, such as blatant discrimination against African American employees and occupational segregation, whereby African American workers frequently end up in lower-paid jobs than white workers. Also, segmented market mechanisms in which Black workers are less likely to be employed in well-paid jobs than white workers.

While African American employees have improved access to opportunities and are having increasing jobs, labor market results continue to worsen for African American workers and their families, including higher unemployment and less decent careers.

Such gaps are not recent, and they have not been removed by the longest labor market expansion on record. In the labor market, African Americans have always been more vulnerable. They face higher unemployment rates daily and work in more inferior positions than whites, which feature lower wages and fewer benefits.

Besides, they appear to work in less secure positions than those held by white employees. "For instance, when the economy curdles, African American workers often see their unemployment rates rise earlier than white workers, and their unemployment numbers often take longer to decrease when the economy recovers than whites do, a concept often referred to as" last hired, first fired."

In addition, struggling black workers are searching longer than white workers to secure a new career.

Historically, the job market experience for African Americans has been lower than that for whites, and today this continues. Several variables have supported and contribute significantly to this. These include associated with chronic persecution of African Americans, such as the demonstrations that devastated the properties of Black business owners on Black Wall Street in Tulsa, Oklahoma in 1921, codified discrimination, legal racial terrorism during the nearly century-long period from Reconstruction to the age of civil rights, systemic exclusion of African Americans from better-paying jobs, and continued occupational terrorism.

The convergence of race and gender inequality has had combined effects on their job market perceptions for Black women, too frequently devaluing their jobs and restricting their confinements.

To begin with, African American families need more wealth to close these persistent labor market gaps. For individuals, money makes it easier to invest in their futures. For instance, wealth can be used to encourage the education of both children and parents, start a business, buy a property in a neighborhood with access to decent jobs, and adapt to different places when there are better opportunities.

More of these advantages provide access to more and better jobs for families. Usually, the benefits of a college degree have lower unemployment rates and better access to well-paying, secure jobs with reasonable benefits. Starting a company allows people more power over their own lives and, therefore, the opportunity to avoid the instability that can involve working with irregular hours for someone else in a low-paying job and purchasing a property nearer to where good-paying jobs are concentrated.

Similarly, wealth enables families to migrate to a new region whenever jobs in one region decrease or entirely vanish. Having little money makes all these advantages challenging to access for African Americans.

The problem brief explores the labor market perspectives of African Americans and white workers in the ongoing expansion of the labor market. The data summary first looks at the differences in unemployment rates, followed by employment opportunity indicators. The debate then turns to job quality indicators, beginning with salaries, followed by benefits, and ending with job security.

African Americans often do worse than whites, regardless of the observed labor market result, with the harshest consequences faced mainly by black women. Increased unemployment, fewer benefits, and less job stability contribute in part to the increasing gap in racial wealth, leaving African Americans in a more vulnerable and uncertain financial situation.

Greater Unemployment Rates in Black Citizen than White

African American employees typically face higher levels of absenteeism than whites. For this, there are many theories. In the job market, Blacks also face outright discrimination. They are often less motivated to participate and finish college, which stems from the fact that African Americans face more significant economic obstacles to college education, winding up with more liabilities than white graduates and paying more for their debts.

The unemployment rate has fallen for a couple of years now, improving the outlook for the labor market for many groups along the way. In September 2019, the U.S. unemployment rate for all 16 years old and older dropped to 3.5 percent from its high of 10 percent in October 2019, hitting its rock bottom in 50 years.

The African American unemployment rate plummeted to a record low of 5.5% in the strengthening job market, and

the rate for whites hit a 50-year low of 3.2 percent at the same time. More notably, for the period between November 2018 and October 2019, the unemployment rate for prime-age employees, those aged 25 to 54, dropped to an average of 5.2 percent for black workers and 2.8 percent for whites.

That would have been the lowest unemployment rate on track for black prime-age workers since 1973 and the lowest for white prime-age workers since 2000.

LGBT in the Workplace

In the United States, about 4.5% of the population identifies as lesbian, gay, bisexual, or transgender. Out of those, approximately 11 million - and 88% are unemployed. According to an infographic put forward by The National LGBT Workers' Center, only 20 states and D.C. have laws that criminalize discrimination based on sexual orientation. LGBT workers experience high rates of discrimination while searching for a job.

There is currently no federal legislation that expressly protects workers from discrimination because of their sexual orientation, gender identity, or gender expression derives from many LGBT workplace problems. Such rights have typically come from the reading of the legislation to protect LGBT employees by state laws and federal court cases. This patchwork of court judgments and state law leaves many susceptible.

Legislation for LGBT workplace discrimination differs between states. Just 23 states (in addition to the District of Columbia) in both the state and federal workforce prohibit discrimination based on sexual orientation or gender identity. The LGBT community remains in a state that does not forbid job discrimination, regardless of sexual orientation and gender identity. This imbalance in safeguarding the rights of LGBT employees is a cause for concern.

Research shows that open gay job candidates are as much as 40 percent less likely to obtain job interviews in some sectors. Transgender people have a three-fold higher unemployment rate than the state median.

According to Keith Cunningham-Parameter's Florida Law Review, many in the gay and lesbian community prioritized organizational equality over marriage modernization before the Supreme Court decision.

Although LGBT discrimination in the workplace certainly hurts LGBT people's social and economic conditions, it is the implicit social structures in the workplaces that are stirring up trouble on their welfare and feeling of connection.

A variety of surveys have found that Americans are much more optimistic towards legal protections than they are towards casual benefits, such as public displays of affection, suggesting that there is still inadequate recognition of queer and trans-sexual.

In a Human Rights Campaign Foundation article, this framework was well-observed. A large-scale survey of LGBT and non-LGBT staff found that 81 percent of non-LGBT participants answered that their LGBT colleagues "do not have to conceal their identity." Despite the obvious recognition of these views, 70 percent of the same respondents indicated that it is "unprofessional" talking about sexual orientation at employment.

The cultural conditioning on all employees to disclose their identity through day-to-day casual interactions with colleagues is what this assertion does not account for, however. For example, the same poll found that 84 percent of those surveyed had conversations about social life weekly or daily, with 65 percent saying the same about relationship interactions and 36 percent about sex and intimacy.

It was an everyday struggle for LGBT employee Erika Karp to preserve the privacy of her lesbian identity.

The combination of the need to hide their identity, the lack of opportunities for promotion, and sometimes pervasive negative feelings about their identity help create a profound sense of alienation among LGBT workers.

Undoubtedly, the detrimental effect of non-inclusive workplace environments appears to be a drawback to workers. Pretty much across the board, according to Human Rights Watch, employee participation among LGBT workers is 30 percent lower than their hetero colleagues, while one in five LGBT personnel say that they have already considered leaving their career.

Nicole Raeburn, author and professor at the University of San Francisco, said, "Now that we live in more multicultural times, where people realize that they can pick and choose jobs, there is a high possibility of a costly brain drain among LGBT top talent. Instead of working in a close setting, they would obviously go somewhere

else."

According to Human Rights Watch, if there is a positive aspect for HR and compliance practitioners seeking to develop a more welcoming atmosphere that eliminates harassment in the workforce against sexual orientation, it is the improved workplace commitment, efficiency, and satisfaction of LGBT workers in authentic settings. One in four LGBT workers surveyed indicated that they have remained in work specifically because of its welcoming climate.

Anti-discrimination initiatives and employee resource groups (ERGs) are also the first steps businesses make to help create a more welcoming atmosphere when discussing LGBT workplace problems. However, Human Rights Watch cautions that these attempts do not consistently deliver their intended meaning.

Around half of LGBT employees surveyed claim that the non-discrimination regulatory framework relies on the overall perceptions of their boss around LGBT people, and while 67 percent said they felt "very welcome" by their ERG, 31 percent said they felt just "somewhat accepted."

Age-Based Workplace Discrimination

CASE-1

Katherine, a 47-year-old model of fashion and media, suggests she was discriminated against based on age. Beauties, a modeling agency, advertised in the newspaper's fashion section as follows:

"For the upcoming fall collection of junior fashions, professional models from 21-28. Applicants must carry a portfolio and references to our office in Beverly Hills. Only such individuals must apply in the specified age group."

When the company found out her age, Katherine auditioned and was refused. 'Beauties' presented the bona fide occupational qualification defense during the investigation and claimed that the junior collection requires applicants who have a youthful look. 'Beauties' further claims that, historically, young girls are approached by junior fashions, typically between 18-25.

Nevertheless, though Katherine is 47, she seems to be 27. In fact, they found out the date of birth on her driver's license; Beauties was in the process of completing the documents needed to recruit Katherine. 'Beauties' does not show that individuals 40 or older have a disqualifying characteristic that can be established unless the applicant's age is verified. Beauties have thus not shown that age is a bona fide professional credential, and it is essential to reform its derogatory advertising.

The EEOC agrees that if an advertisement explicitly discriminates based on age, the employer may assert that age is a bonafide professional eligibility. However, to decide that age is a bona fide occupational requirement for a specific position, the employer must demonstrate that all persons excluded from the position are genuinely ineligible. If a qualified person can do the job, this will defeat the argument that age is a bona fide occupational qualification if the truth is valid.

CASE-2

The Do-It-Yourself Store, a significant home maintenance chain, releases the following ads about a labor shortage that exists throughout the country's southeast region:

"Wanted: all ages of people. Day and evening shifts open. Full-time and part-time jobs. Accepted all inquiries. An excellent secondary source of retirees' income."

While the ad discusses "retirees," in this case, it is not an unlawful age-based discriminatory advertising practice. For the opportunity of work, individuals of all ages are accepted. For this subgrouping of the covered age group, the reference to retirees in the ad does not imply a preference. Instead, it tells them of a chance and encourages them to participate. The language used in this ad is different from the language used in Case Study 3, which shows that only retired people eligible for a pension are considered working.

Maintenance of Age Diversity in Work Environment

ADEA (Age Discrimination in Employment Act) in the United States is a state law that shields people 40-years and above from employment discrimination on the grounds of age.

A PricewaterhouseCoopers study indicated that 64% of surveyed CEOs had implemented programs that encourage inclusion and diversity. Just 8 percent, though, included age in their diversity strategy as a consideration. This suggests that many firms will be ill-equipped to handle an age-diverse environment adequately.

The older staff brings decades of work expertise, tried and real ideas, and problem-solving approaches. Those can be of enormous benefit to a corporation. Multi-generational environments, however, often come with specific obstacles, which can lead to unfulfilled workers and reduced business performance if mishandled. Getting it right depends on intelligent management and an open-minded theory of leadership.

Building age-diverse workplace teams enable staff to learn from each other. Older workers can provide young workers with expertise learned by experience, and younger employees can show them how to use modern technologies and methods.

The ability to question and inspire each other benefits all parties. That is why organizations should look wherever possible for opportunities for inter-generational teams to partner on ventures.

Reports by the Department of Labor Statistics, says that the unemployment rate for those over age 55 stands at just 3.6%, compared to 5% for the overall population. While older employees have found a position in the modern workforce, many people are victims of age-based discrimination when it applies to recruitment and hiring.

Inclusion of Diversity: Caterpillar Inc.

Caterpillar is the world's largest building and mining equipment maker, employing more than 120,000 workers across various goods and services. They have more than 10,000 staff in the UK, located at 20 facilities nationwide.

The development of a genuinely diverse and inclusive working environment that represents the essence of their global organization and the communities in which their facilities are available is one of Caterpillar's main strategic objectives. The company's desire to build and maintain a diverse and inclusive working climate is focused on the premise that if it can attract and retain the best talent, regardless of gender, ethnicity, religious belief, etc., the organization would be much more successful. For the United Kingdom, this is primarily focused on fostering equality for women and has a range of measures to help achieve it.

The Organization recognizes the value of maintaining a work-life balance among its workers, having a formal flexible working strategy in the UK intended to overcome the issues experienced by employees with childcare or elderly care needs. Improved maternity benefits, subsidized childcare vouchers, part-time jobs, remote work, and job sharing are examples of how Caterpillar workers can ensure that they can fulfill their work responsibilities in ways that help them meet their family's requirements.

Inclusion of Diversity - Jaguar Land Rover

Numerous arrangements have been established by Jaguar Land Rover to positively impact the number of female engineering graduates who consider a career in engineering after graduation.

Just 1,234 female students (13% of the population) graduated from 'relevant' engineering subjects in the UK in 2013. Then 3/10 of an already tiny percentage opt not to go into engineering careers, which means that many leave the field before they have even begun.

Jaguar Land Rover concentrate on workplace diversity and the progress of design and engineering in the United Kingdom and want to provide an informed decision to these women who are doubtful about a career in engineering support; hence, they have established the Women in Engineering Sponsorship Scheme-a innovative program to support the preparation of these female engineers alongside their degree. The scheme provides female students studying engineering with 3, 6, and 15-month assignments.

Good students receive benefits, such as an annual vacation allowance and a competitive wage. Moreover, when they switch to their studies next year, students on the funding scheme also benefit from a pell grant payment of £ 1,500. The system has been working with excellent results since 2011.

The aim each year is to hire a new class of 10 students, but we have taken on more than the initial target year on

year due to the quality of applicants. This demand shows the need for such a structure. The UK has less than 10% of the European Union's female engineers, and JLR is doing its best to improve this.

Each recruitment student is paired through their placement and when they return to university with a mentor in the company from day one. When a student enters a position, this mentor is crucial as this can seem a confounding environment.

Over 20% of the graduate engineering hires are now female through these initiatives, a rise of about 13 percent; the 'WiE' network is also moving from good to great, with 19 networking sessions being hosted and more than 700 students have been linked professionally. Where the inclusion of diversity is concerned, JLR is going in the correct direction. However, like with any project, they are preparing to revisit the standard paradigm while happy with the progress so far, looking at whether improvements must be made to the 'WiE' profiling operation or the funded project to remain appealing and convincing to the target group.

The Department of Health

Currently, the Department of Health (DH) has 11 recognized personnel networks covering much of the protected features described in the 2010 Equality Act. Disability, race, LGBT (Lesbian, Gay, Bisexual, and Transgender), religion, women, pregnancy, and flexible schedules are protected by the DH networks. DH also has a range of staff classes, such as domestic violence, health and well-being, and dyslexia, that offer targeted support to employees.

The organization did not require staff networks but instead allowed DH to establish them when the need emerged and promoted, sponsored, and given a small amount of compensation to further their scope and activities.

To guarantee that internal policies and procedures do not discriminate and are open to all our workers, their feedback is crucial. General staff's opinions about how various policies and practices impact them can also be hard to gauge. Staff Networks offer a platform for workers in a 'secure' atmosphere to share their opinions. Concerns posed by members are returned to the appropriate community, and reflection is given to correct the issue.

Many examples show both bad conditions and positive advancement towards the goal of inclusion of diversity in workplaces. The path seems complicated, but with conjoined efforts, a great deal of equality can be achieved. Prejudice on the basis of religion, gender, ethnicity, gender, ethnicity, age, race, cultural backgrounds, sexual orientation, physical conditions or country of origin should completely diminish. Individuals should not be stripped of the possibilities of their opportunities based on these. There should be compassion in colleagues and employers to stop seeing the diverse with indifference and include them as much as possible, depending upon their capability and talent.

PART 3

Chapter 13 - What Is Inequality?

We can view inequality from different perspectives. It ranges from individuals being denied opportunities to a more structural understanding of inequality of social conditions. Inequality has become a significant discussion – especially in politics – mainly because of the transition that the US and UK led in the 1980s to a neoliberal economic regime.

In retrospect to the Keynesianism practiced by the western Europeans and northern Americans in the early postwar decade, classical presumptions have it that markets – if left to themselves – arrive at optimal economic equilibria. Therefore, the state should withdraw from social steering.

To digress a little, it's evident that the neoliberal era has seen the soaring of top income at the expense of those in the lower reaches of the income hierarchy. Also, the age itself has been questioned by 2008's financial crash since no neoclassical economist could anticipate it.

Coming back to our primary focus, inequality and its effect have been evident in many other occurrences. What then does this term mean?

According to the Oxford Dictionary, inequality is simply the difference in size, circumstances or degree. This difference means an imbalance in the distribution of opportunities and a lack of unevenness. In other words, it refers to the phenomenon of unequal and unjust distribution of resources and opportunities among members of a given society. Inequality is both inefficient and unfair.

Countries with high inequality of opportunity have a strong negative correlation between income inequality and growth. However, inequality has spread through and entered into schools, workplaces as well as multicultural companies.

Educational inequality can be described as unequal access to education and unequal outcomes for students' results. The disparities present in academic access among students in the United States result from several factors: government policies, school choice, family wealth, origin, achievement, health status, among others. One of the main driving forces of educational inequality is an implicit bias towards the race or ethnicity of a student (this has been discussed in the previous book of the series - Unconscious Bias).

We've studied how children are not always conscious of such inequalities. But unfortunately, they unknowingly become a part of it. They may not purposefully succumb to the practice of implicit bias and tolerance of inequality, but it sometimes arises when not given proper attention. The common types of inequalities found in schools and workplaces include;

1. Gender inequality
2. Racial inequality
3. Economic inequality
4. Academic inequality

Gender inequality does not happen in schools alone, but it is also a significant problem in every societal stratum, especially in workplaces and other social settings. Sometimes, restrictions are imposed on students of a particular gender in schools, such as limiting their role or access to some positions, for example, the issue of 'Head Girl' and 'Head Boy' in some multicultural countries, especially in the United Kingdom and the United States has raised lots of concerns. Recently, in June 2021, at St Paul's Girls' School in the UK, the word 'Head Girl' is set to be changed to 'Head of School' because it is perceived to be "too binary".

Studies by UNICEF have proven that even though most countries have achieved gender parity in primary enrolment, many countries still discriminate against girls in their education system.

Racial inequality occurs mainly based on the particular caste, religion, or area a student, worker or citizen belongs to. The majority will show a tendency to rule them or to avoid them from mainstream activities. Sometimes, even skin complexion can be the basis of such bias. This disparity may severely affect the confidence and caliber of students.

This form of discrimination was most felt in the US, specifically in the 1960s, the United Kingdom, and other multicultural countries. During this time, most African-Americans, Latinos, and Native American students were educated majorly in segregated schools. These schools had their funding at rates a lot lower than schools for the whites and were excluded entirely from many higher institutions. Although this practice has been put to an end with schools now being open for everyone, there are still traces of inequality in schools, which we will treat in the latter part of this book.

Economic inequality is also another terrible form of inequality that appears among school children. I just mentioned how schools were segregated and funded differently. Though in a different form, this practice still exists to this day.

In a school, students belonging to different financial backgrounds study in separate classes. This gap is evident in the students' clothes, various accessories and stationery they use in the class, and the cash they bring to class for their needs. Discrimination brought about by inequality based on financial status can seriously affect students, making them feel inferior.

Educational inequality can be as a result of academic performance. All students don't have the same ability to learn or to grasp lessons. Their grades also vary, and the teachers sometimes show an extra affection or implicit bias towards those who score well.

Over time, inequality has spread up in diverse forms on a global scale. This doesn't exclude workplaces. Like we have seen in the previous book, there have been several instances of implicit bias based on gender, eight, accent, sexuality, height, or race in the workplace. As most countries have been focused on fighting agelong inequalities and prejudice in the world, several forms of disparities and bias have sprung up lately; though the effect of some may be mild, others have a grave damaging consequence.

Research shows that the distribution or allocation pattern of groups across occupations favors specific individuals or groups more. For example, the gap in the distribution of men compared to women in certain professions is alarming. Secondly, these focus on the link between occupation and income – such as comparing the income of whites with blacks in the same field.

Inequality in workplaces has historically always been a problem but could diminish over time. Ethnicity has an enormous influence on the quality of jobs and the amount of money an individual will make in the workplace. In workplaces, gender is also a factor; women are not able to move up into higher-paid positions as quickly as men. Workplace inequality can affect an individual's socio-economic status, and it is also correlated with their access to things such as finding a job, purchasing a house, etc. This issue can be resolved by building diversity and inclusion, conducting training on promoting an inclusive workplace, fair and equitable procedures for addressing sexual harassment/discrimination, considering unconscious bias training, and being flexible.

Multicultural organizations, also, haven't escaped the tentacles of inequality. A multicultural organization has a workforce that includes people from diverse backgrounds across all departments and offers them equal opportunity for input and advancement within the company. Some of these companies had to deal with a poor growth rate because of lack of cohesion and self-imposed value by some people in the rank. People meant to help such companies progress are not allowed to work efficiently just because of reasons previously stated.

In the 1960s, the passing of the equal employment opportunity (EEO) laws at th federal level was to enforce equal employment opportunities against women and minority men in the workplace. The US experienced a tremendous decline in occupational inequality in the 1960s and 1970s. Although, in the 1980s and 1990s, it began to rise.

Another form of inequality that is often overlooked is 'Age inequality.' We have culturally and socially defined expectations of the meaning of age, our understanding of it, and our responses to it (Calasanti and Slevin 2001), distinguish acceptable behavior for different social groups. There's a legal age for voting, consuming alcohol, and the ability to hold certain elected offices.

Age inequality comes in different ways, one direct way you might experienced it can be when a person makes a bias against you just because of your age. For example, an employer may refuse to allow his employees to do a training

course because he thinks you are ‘too old’ but allows younger colleagues to do the training.

It may also occur indirectly. Age inequality also appears in a situation where a person is harassed or victimized because they’re too young to defend themselves or too old. They’re made to feel humiliated and emotionally down in the process.

Inequality has been persistent in our society, despite the efforts of individuals and governments to combat this societal menace. The biggest challenge we face in this battle sterns from the differential perception of the world, which is inherent in every individual and groups. However, as individuals, we can curb inequality as it starts from how we treat people wherever we find ourselves. Therefore, the show of equality and equity begins with YOU and ME.

Chapter 14 - Multicultural Nations and Inequality.

A multicultural nation consists of diverse people with various cultures, ethnicities, and races living and coexisting economically, politically, socially, and legally. Politically, multiculturalism means people advocating for equal respect of all cultures, rights, and policies that maintain cultural diversity and shun racism. Both the USA and UK are described as melting pots because right from the 1400’s varieties of different cultures mingled and coexisted.

Before talking about inequity and inequality in the United States and the United Kingdom, I will briefly dwell on the state of inequality in other multicultural countries globally, with a bit of focus on Africa.

Chad

According to research by Erkan Gören of the University of Oldenberg in Germany, he analyzed the cultural diversity in over one hundred and eighty countries (180). He published a paper to show data that will help us understand the diversity in different world countries. Among the top in the list of the most diverse nations, we have Chad in north-central Africa with just about 8.6 million population divided into about two hundred (200) ethnic groups speaking 100 languages.

The history and current state of chad fully depict what disunity in cultural diversity can cause in a country. Just after Chad's independence in 1960, the country went into a civil war that lasted for about 24 years. The continuous turbulence caused by power struggles has been responsible for almost 55 000 deaths of its citizens. The disproportionate distribution of wealth is a considerable concern and is also one of the root causes of the crisis.

South Africa

Still in Africa, let's quickly look at the situation in South Africa. It is said to be the most unequal country in the world, according to the World Bank report in 2019. Economic inequality is a huge problem in the country and the root cause of extreme poverty.

The World Bank report on the state of inequality in South Africa shows that 70 percent of the Country's resources are controlled by just 20 percent of the population. Also, from the report – Black Women are at the bottom of the income-earning. The Black women in South Africa earn 24 percent less than their counterpart White women. The huge gap in income inequality results from the economy being controlled by few companies established in the apartheid and colonial eras.

Nigeria

Nigeria is the most populous black country, still carrying with pride the tag ‘Africa’s largest economy.' But, does the tag name reflect the reality in the country? Reports shows that about half of the country's population still wallows in abject poverty, while only a small percent (less than 8 percent) of the people enjoy the country's wealth. Inequality, among other factors, has led to so many agitations and violence in the past. Recently, the 'EndSARS' protest is a big issue in which the government was accused of using force to suppress the people's voice.

The present state of economic inequality is at the topmost level, and it's the daily reality of the population. Its population keeps increasing, and the economy keeps deteriorating. There is so much regional inequality in the country; while over 80 percent of Sokoto and Maiduguri states population are impoverished, some states have less than 30 percent.

Gender, regional and economic inequalities are interwoven. The cultural and religious beliefs of the northern part of Nigeria do not support the education and empowerment of the girl child. Also, the attitude and beliefs of this same part of the country do not support western education. These factors cause a high number of illiteracies, poverty, and underdevelopment in the country.

The Developed Nations

Right from its inception, the USA has been a multicultural society made up of 13 colonies merged. Its original inhabitants being the Aztecs, Incas, and Mayas, who had different ways of life. The Spanish explorer, Christopher Columbus's exploration in 1492 led to the settlement of other nationalities in America such as Spaniards, Portuguese, Britain, France, Germany, and other Europeans. With the advent of the slave trade came other races like Africans, Asians, and Indians. The rise of industrialization brought about abolishing the slave trade, so the formerly enslaved settled down and became integrated into the society.

Unfortunately, they faced and still face discrimination at different levels, though it is considerably less in the contemporary world. America's 19th-century expansionist policy led to the incorporation of Mexico and Puerto Rico. Mass individual and group migrants settled, causing demographic changes in the population.

England, Wales, Scotland, and Northern Ireland are four countries that make up the United Kingdom, these countries come with different traditions, customs, values, beliefs, art, music, cultures, and languages. When the Romans, Vikings, Normans, and other nations invaded the UK, they carried along with their cultures and language, leading to English dictionaries having French, Spanish, Italian, and German origins. Trade links with other nations also led to interaction and migration. The Royal family also possesses multicultural elements as there have been queens and kings of different descent, e.g., Catherine of Aragon, who was Spanish; William I, who hails from Rome; William III of Dutch origin; Meghan Markle, an African American.

During the colonial era, there was a saying that the sun never went down on the British Empire due to how vast it was. Inhabitants of British territories migrated to the UK to work mainly in the major cities like Leeds, Manchester, and London. Due to this, diversity was unevenly distributed as smaller towns were less multicultural. Britain formed associations with her ex-colonies, e.g., Commonwealth Nations, which led to further migration. Liverpool, which was linked to transatlantic trade, has a central old black community and a Chinese community due to trade ties with Shanghai.

Multiculturalism increased in the 1900s with Irish fleeing the potato famine, Jews fleeing Tsarist Russia, and other races fleeing Germany in Adolf Hitler's reign, which began in January 1933, and the Empire Windrush, in which 500 immigrants came from the West Indies.

Evident in nations like the USA and UK, and other multicultural countries is globalization in politics, which involves intensifying political interaction across borders at the federal, state, or regional levels. This can be seen in America having a president of African descent- Barack Obama. Cultural globalization as those in diaspora spread their food, music, language, art, religion, e.g., the spread of Islam with Iranians and Pakistani's arrival. People of different ethnicities also intermarry and produce new races, e.g., creoles and mulattoes. And also, economic globalization as economies become interlinked and share information, capital, goods, and services. In the USA, economic globalization could be traced to 1945 when in a bid to reconstruct the world economy, the IMF and International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (now World Bank) were created to build collapsed economies of the world.

In a community with multiple cultures in its demography and many ethnic minorities, migrants play critical roles in different societal aspects such as science, art, sports, education, etc. A survey done in the USA in 2000 showed that its population has become much less European, and there is notable religious diffusion. Contemporary Britain has shifted from a predominantly white, British, and Christian people to numerous creeds, races, and cultures.

These demographic changes have intercepted political, social, economic, and legal policies as governments accommodate and promote diversity.

How Inequality is Practiced in Multicultural Nations.

Inequality is more rampant in multicultural countries. Multiculturalism is a term that defines all the different cultural or racial groups in society, state, or country as having equal rights, privileges, and opportunities, and no one is belittled or regarded as an unimportant race.

However, it has instead been the basis of inequality in such countries. Certain racial groups or cultural groups are considered superior to others. They are giving specific rights, opportunities, and privileges over other cultural groups or races.

Multiculturalism causes division within a country. This division may be formed when a particular group, for instance, refuses to accept another culture's everyday language and insists on their language being generally accepted or refuses to be included in specific cultural activities of another group, demanding their recognition.

Such closely related practices lead to community isolationism, discrimination in markets, and separate people into distinct groups. The misconception of multiculturalism will be destructive to any country because it obviously stands as an obstacle in developing or sustaining common internal goals and national bonds.

The United States is an excellent example of a multicultural country. It is made up of individuals of different beliefs, heredity, race, culture, and color. It would be rather unfair to assume one culture as the supreme or most significant culture in countries like the United States. Yet, there will always be a race proving superiority.

Racial and cultural inequality in the United States identifies the observed social inequality and injustice that affect different races and cultures in the United States. This is definitely a result of historic oppression, inequality of inheritance, racism, and prejudice, especially against minor or lesser groups.

Forms of Inequality in Multicultural Nations.

Inequality can be manifested in different ways in multicultural nations like the United States and the United Kingdom. These are a few ways to observe inequality or unfair treatment among individuals in multicultural countries.

1. **Housing Segregation**

In the United States, Housing segregation is the process of denying African Americans and other minority groups or races equal access to housing privileges or systems through methods such as giving them wrong information and denial of reality and good financing services. The Housing policy in the United States has supported housing segregation trends right from the early years.

The Housing system in the United States provides strict laws that prevent lesser cultural groups from accessing much more comfortable houses and the privileges that come with it.

Key legislation includes the National Housing Act of 1934, the GI Bill, and the Fair Housing Act. Certain factors such as socio-economic status, spatial assimilation, and immigration contribute to the seemingly everlasting housing segregation. The consequence of housing segregation includes unequal living standards, relocation, and then poverty. It is also a reason for the increased crime rate among these minority groups. They seek to earn more and find ways, illegal ways, to beat the system and bend it to please and favor them.

2. **Education**

It may be uncommon to find some 'all-white schools' in countries like America in this current world. However, it wasn't always so. At a time, schools existed that wouldn't allow individuals of other races to admit to their institutions. There were only accepting children of their race or cultural group. This practice has been put to an end. However, there are still traces of inequality in education to date.

In August 2020, the US Justice Department argued, stating that the prestigious Yale University discriminated against Asian candidates based on their race, a charge which the university denied.

Take African Americans, for example; the government has established some schools in African American dominating areas for black children to school. Such schools mostly lack the facilities and equipment required to

learn in a conducive environment. Certain educational privileges are not given to members of these minor races.

The educational system is made to favor members of the dominant group in the country. Scholarship opportunities, competitions, student grants, only rare and upright people in charge of the system give these opportunities based on merit. Commonly, the race or heredity of the individuals prevents them from qualifying for such opportunities.

Also, in the United States, financial sponsoring for public education is largely dependent on local property taxes. Local property tax revenues might vary between different neighborhoods and school environments. This difference in property tax revenues amongst neighborhoods and school districts leads to inequality in education. This inequality is exhibited in the form of available school financial resources that provide educational opportunities, facilities, equipment, and programs to students.

For every admitted student, an average non-white school district receives $2,226 less than what a white school district receives.

3. Gender

In terms of gender inequality, there is a laid-back notion that surmises that women or the female gender aren't supposed to participate or fill positions that play specific roles or hold certain responsibilities in society.

Instead, they're limited by the gross misconception that men are to be superior to women. However, studies reveal that women are responsible for about 60% of work done globally yet earn just 10% of income and 1% of the property. In Africa, 70% of women are excluded financially. The continent has a US$42billion financing gap between men and women.

Worldwide, women still have limited access to education than men. ¼ of young women between 15-24 will not finish basic school, while ⅔ of women worldwide are illiterate. When girls aren't given the same level of education as boys, their output to society is also greatly affected and reduced—limiting their ability to participate in representative political offices and top decision-making platforms.

Although the situation is a lot different in developed countries, the US and UK, there are still traces of women being biased against. In the UK, for example, around 38% of teachers in state secondary schools are male. This result may seem fair (or unfair against men, that's not where we are going) until you realize the gender divide based on the subjects taught by men. Male teachers are more likely to specialize in STEM (science, technology, engineering, and mathematics). Whereas women are more likely to teach languages and humanities subjects.

Women over the globe are more educated now than at any point in history. Yet, they are not still as educated as men. About 60 years ago, almost 50 percent of women had no formal schooling, and 3.3 years was their average level of educational attainment. But by 2010, their average achievement had increased to 7.7 years, with just only 20 percent of adult women having no formal education.

In fact, both boys and girls have access to more education today than anytime in history. The mean years of education among adult men was 4.1 years in 1960, and it was more than double this figure as at 2010, with 8.6 years as the average years of education. Also, the number of men without formal education declined from 37 percent to 10 percent over the same period.

Though it has seen a remarkable improvement, it's still got much improving to do.

4. Poverty

The poverty difference between the Caucasian race in the United States and other races such as African Americans, Asian Americans is vast. Due to the inequality in giving job opportunities or basic amenities, the minor races face a constant state of lack and want, poverty. There is also housing segregation that leaves lesser races with low-quality housing to breed poverty. Poor education, which does not give members of the minor group a future to look forward to, leaves them with many financial struggles. Such efforts push these individuals into crimes to sustain themselves and their families. Though these factors cannot justify crimes, however, it needs to be addressed.

On the other hand, basic amenities of the highest quality are provided for members of the dominating race. Loans and grants are easily accessible. This bias pushes them way above the poverty mark. In countries like the United States with little poverty rate, it is the members of the minority group that primarily make up this percentage.

5. **Police brutality**

We might all have heard statement like “I thought he had a gun” coming from a white police officer about a black person, or “A black man could be walking on the street with his hand inside his pocket and get arrested because they thought he had a gun.” As unreal as this statement sounds, it is true. Due to the wrongly accepted fame African American males have for belonging to violent gangs, every African American male has become a suspect for street crimes.

The number of innocents lives of African Americans, including females that have been lost due to wrong police judgment and police brutality, is increasing daily. Members of the higher races do not have any trouble with the Police, mainly of the same race. Despite the law being said to treat everyone equally, two criminals of different races would still be judged differently in some countries.

Such treatment does not convey equality in any way, like the George Floyd incident. Here, an African American man, George Floyd, was choked to death by an American police officer even after surrendering. There have been very few to no cases of such incidents happening to a member of the dominant race in the same country. Such treatment is unfair and unequal. It is racial inequality.

6. **Health treatment**

In nations like the United States and the United Kingdom, certain races do not get urgent and quality medical attention. African American women and a few other races are more prone to die during childbirth than bona fide American women. This occurrence is due to a lack of or insufficient medical attention. There have been cases of African American women having their children in their homes because of unaffordable/inaccessible medical care or facilities.

There is a significant gap in the life expectancy between races, like the African and Native Americans having the lowest expectancies. The average interval between African and White Americans is four years. However, there is significant variation between states and even more minor levels; for example, in Wisconsin, the life expectancy gap is six years. In Washington DC, the gap is over ten years.

7. **Rescue Operations**

During natural disasters, Caucasian races evacuate and are evacuated earlier than minor races. This advantage could be due to their preparations for such disasters, but in severe cases where they required external assistance but were denied. So many natural disasters in areas dominated by minor groups would not have turned out worse if the government had intervened. According to Hawkins et al. 2009, Latinos and African American minority groups have a greater risk of disaster exposure and are severely affected than other cultural groups in the US.

Some factors like ignorance, insensitivity, racial isolation and bias, housing segregation or poor housing conditions, information transmission, and relief assistance largely contribute to the difference in disaster preparation.

RESPONSES TO INEQUALITY

With the varying ideology of what inequality is, various responses have arisen to it, and variable propositions have been made on how to tackle it. Seeing how far the world has come, it’s safe to say that people no longer sit back and watch vices become norms.

Everyone has their method of reacting or responding to societal vices, especially when they feel they’ve fallen victim to bias. Some take legal actions, while others choose a protest, with a few resulting in several acts of violence. Well, we shall be reviewing how inequality affects society and how people respond to it.

Many nations, especially those with socio-cultural diversity, suffer from gross levels of unequal standing regarding political power, decision-making processes, or influence on both governments on the federal and state levels. Inequality cuts across even the socio-economic status of a society, separating the elites from the masses.

Democracy, a system that is supposed to be a political platform where policy decisions that are supposed to align with citizens’ preference, in reality, are “de jure but not de facto regimes of equality.” Political nepotism caused by the concentration of power and wealth among politicians explains the scramble for controlling structures and institutions in society. It has dramatically impacted society in diverse ways.

The continuous rotting of the system affects the citizens in negative ways, such as the growing rate of unemployment in society, lack of development, increase in crime rate, and corruption on its highest level. There's no longer any form of Justice in such a society, and it becomes a situation where the rich getting richer while the poor getting poorer.

Another form of inequality that still ravages our present-day society is Racial Inequality. Many people still interact with others based on their racial dispositions even in this 21st Century, considering factors such as physical features, ethnicity, or cultural affiliation.

One of the most significant responses to inequality in recent times and history was the massive protests as a response to the killing of George Floyd. The Minnesota police officer responsible for this wicked act kneeled on the neck of this unarmed 46-year-old black man for nearly nine minutes, resulting in his death. This event sparked conversations about inequality on a global scale. This event shook the world by bringing about controversies on whether the black community, who were once victims of racial discrimination, weren't totally out of the hook yet.

According to research, relative to whites, blacks earn twenty-four percent less, live five fewer years. Hispanics make twenty-five percent less than whites and are three times more likely to be imprisoned. Also, about 45% of the US poor are non-Hispanic Whites, with African Americans having the highest poverty rate among minority groups. This result is a clear indication that racism is still imprinted into the system and that it is still clearly visible in today's world.

One's sexual orientation can also serve as a basis of inequality in society. There's no definitive study on the number of individuals who identify themselves as gay, bisexual or lesbian. No one gets "outed" for being straight in our society, but being gay is considered taboo or an abomination due to religious or societal orientation, especially in most African cultures.

Human Rights Watch notes that two countries in Africa, among those that outlawed homosexuality - Benin and the Central African Republic, do not criminalize it but have specific laws which apply differently to heterosexual and gay individuals. Countries like Nigeria have stringent laws against homosexuality, bisexuality, or lesbianism and out rightly abolishes them.

Gay and lesbian partners are refused the same legal and social support given to straight couples. Their families are denied standard legal protections that non-gay families take for granted, such as adoption, custody, guardianship, social security, and even inheritance (Lambda Legal 2003).

Even in the US, these individuals have faced several acts of discrimination, especially in the 1960s. This event brought about the Stonewall riot. In June 1969, historic riots occurred at New York City's Stonewall Inn. It was not uncommon for Police to raids gay bars at the time. However, on that particular night, members of the city's LGBT community decided to take a bold, historic step and fight back. Their actions would spark an uprising that launched a new era of resistance and revolution. It marked a raucous turning point in the fight for LGBT rights.

To date, LGBT Pride Month occurs in the United States to commemorate the Stonewall riots. As a result, lots of pride events are held during this month to recognize the impact LGBT people have had globally. This celebration helps provide role models, build community, and represent a civil rights statement about the contributions of the LGBTQ+ community.

The bias on LGBTQ+ people has also sparked several other famous responses worldwide, as they strive to be accepted by society.

As expected, most workers do not get income equality at a given point in time. Income inequality is quite an inevitable phenomenon that still thrives. The ideologies justifying it as a natural outcome of varying differences in skills, talent, efforts, etc., are still accepted in society.

However, most times, Income distribution is affected indirectly by patterns of taxation and ownership. Economic inequality is affected by policies that provide public goods, such as health care and education, leaving a more significant proportion of individuals' incomes to be spent on other goods.

Income inequality is evident when there exists an unequal distribution of incomes across various groups of individuals in the economy. A good example is when only the top ten earners represent about 50% of a country's income. Technically, the less equal the distribution, the higher income inequality is.

Income inequality can be a result of a difference in sex or risk. Due to the crowds in technological advancements, joblessness or unemployment is on the increase. Machines and improved artificial intelligence technology are developed to substitute human resources for a more efficient result. This improvement may reduce the job opportunities available that require human efforts and increase unemployment.

Also, individuals with different levels of education earn other wages primarily because the job requirements are proportional to the individual's skill. This system is prevalent in many countries and cities today and contributes to income inequality.

Income inequality usually results in higher rates of health and social problems. Many individuals are more likely to rely on crimes when they're affected by income inequality. This result is because, in general, income inequality decreases satisfaction and happiness and even a lower level of economic growth.

Chapter 15 - Global Egalitarianism.

It's a well-known fact that equity is difficult to achieve. This difficulty exists because the system is designed to favor the majority. Living in a world where everyone wants to be placed above others is quite challenging. This challenge is especially notable when you hold no sort of power or affluence. Therefore, there is a need for "Global Egalitarianism."

The term "Global" means relating to or encompassing the whole of our world. On the other hand, egalitarianism is the creed that all people are equal and deserve equal rights and opportunities.

For a country or society to be free of inequality and inequity, then the people in such a country should be Egalitarians. These are people with a social ideology advocating the removal of inequalities among people. This is concerning social, political, and economic affairs. An example of a notable Egalitarian is Martin Luther King Jr, who fought for civil rights.

Egalitarianism is defined as a philosophical perspective that emphasizes equity and equal treatment across religion, economic status, gender, and political beliefs. A focus of Egalitarianism may be on income inequality and distribution, which influence various political systems and economic. Egalitarianism also examine how an individual is treated under the law. Karl Marx used egalitarianism as the starting point in creating his Marxist philosophy, and John Locke considered egalitarianism when he proposed that individuals had natural rights.

When this topic is mentioned, one common misconception people have is that - equity and equality mean the same thing. However, there are significant contrasts between the two. You must understand them, especially when dealing with education. Therefore, we'll delve into the differences between equality and equity to understand how fairness, success, and society are affected by these notions.

Equality

Equality is seen simply as the state or quality of being equal. Equal here means the state of similarity in quality, status, or nature. When using this definition for social structures – like education, workplaces, and multicultural countries – equality insinuates that the state of society has the same level and support in all its segments.

In the US, equality in education was proposed and established in the 1954 Supreme Court Case of Board of Education vs. Brown, where the Court ruled that "separate is inherently unequal." This ruling was in respect to the segregation of schools between African American and white students. It led to the integration of schools and the Civil Rights Act of 1964.

Equity

Equity, on the other hand, refers to anything dealing equally with all concerned. In education settings, equity insinuates the fact that different people have varying needs of support and assistance. Therefore, systems exist for

the help of individuals based on their specific needs.

The primary aim of equity is for achieving fairness in treatment and outcomes. It's the state where equality has been completed. A typical example is the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA), set up to ensure equal access to public places for people with disabilities. This act means that public restrooms must have ramps to enable access to people in wheelchairs.

Understanding the Difference Between Fairness and Success.

Without understanding and considering the different scenarios a person enters a situation, it's difficult to achieve equality. This difficulty is present because every individual is different. Therefore, varying needs must be considered when setting up children for success in fairness.

Equity is seen as the idea of leveling the playing field for fairness to be successful. Equality ensures everyone is treated the same without considering the natural differences – in races, sexes, social classes, etc. – between the people involved.

If we're to consider this, understanding the main topic becomes a whole lot easier. Everyone has differently ways of learning. While some students prefer auditory learning, others perform better at visual learning and must-see things before understanding.

Therefore, a teacher using one method will be favorable to those who prefer that style. While this is a form of equality as everyone gets the same treatment, it's not equitable because some students may have performed better due to the difference in learning style.

Importance of Global Egalitarianism.

Global egalitarianism is of great importance to everyone in a society and country at large. This importance is because, when there is equality and equity, the following happens;

1. From the social and economic outlook, egalitarianism promotes economic upliftment amongst various classes of society.
2. The Egalitarian ideology is based on ensuring equality of income and equality of opportunities among different sections of society.
3. It brings about fairness in multiple issues arising.
4. This point also leads to giving a sense of belonging. People tend to feel very comfortable wherever they find themselves.
5. There is an equal allocation of assets.

Looking at the various importance of Global Egalitarianism, it is clear that a society where there is equality and equity would always experience progress and development. However, a society that is unfair and unjust would always be backward. Therefore, there is a need to highlight some of these effects.

Effects of Global Inequality.

1. Poor health and poverty: it reduce social cohesion, a dynamic that leads to more stress, fear, and insecurity for everyone.
2. Inefficient allocation of assets.
3. Social tensions.
4. Frustration.
5. Conflicts.
6. Increase in crime rates.
7. Bad working conditions.
8. Migration.

When there is no equality in a country, everyone lives in fear of others who are superior to them. This fear has led to many frustrations as well as tensions. There is no room for workers to contribute equally and share recognition of success in an organization with no equality or equity. This disadvantage is because the people ranked higher feel too proud to mingle.

Global egalitarianism has slowed down a lot of organizations and countries at large because there is no unity. Let's

also look at the conflicts such has caused. When there is inequality, people tend to pour out their frustrations, leading to violence.

The issue of poverty cannot be overemphasized. When there is no economic upliftment to various classes of people, the tagged “low class” won’t benefit. A country without equality and equity would always experience an increase in crime rates. This occurrence is because the people who are being looked down upon tend to look for other ways to survive.

The effect of crime rates in a country reduces drastically when egalitarianism is treated equally and fairly. Migration is another effect that has affected most countries that do not practice equality and equity. Citizens tend to leave such countries to other countries where they can have peace of mind.

Once there is no equality, there is no zeal to work hard in the minds of people. They feel it is useless and of no use to put effort into work that will not be appreciated.

Causes of Global Inequality

There are so many reasons why we face this global inequality all over the world. These reasons include;

1. Religion.
2. Political goals.
3. The exploitation of developing countries.
4. Lack of education.

Religion has played a vital role in this. Countries now support countries with the same faith. This act doesn’t portray global egalitarianism as it shows inequality.

Although often proclaimed by politics, global inequality favors some countries and gives them an edge over developing countries. This advantage could be in technological progress, which gives those countries a competitive advantage to and sustain power. Developing countries often get exploited by rich countries in several ways since they depend on the demand of rich countries. This exploitation makes them heavily reliant and dependent.

Knowledge is key. But what happens when people are not well educated on their rights as citizens of a country. The lack of education is ignorance of one’s rights. These have led to global inequality all over the world.

Solutions to Global Inequality

Inequality is a serious issue worldwide, and we can still do a lot to reduce it. The possible solutions to consider are;

1. Better access to education.
2. Financial subsidies.
3. Worldwide support.
4. Creation of incentives for firms to locate poor areas.
5. Establishment of sustainable minimum wage.
6. Improvement of workers’ rights.

As said earlier, a lack of education could cause a lot. Also, access to education could solve a lot. When education is made easy, people know what, how, and when to handle such issues.

Developing countries rely on financial subsidies from rich governments. This reliance is to progress and fight the adverse causes related to poverty and inequality. Therefore, it is crucial and necessary to set up and enlarge global funding programs for developing countries.

All countries should cooperate and work together. The cooperation between them is to share their newest research findings on all kinds of topics. This cooperation would help developing countries to profit from those findings.

Governments and municipalities should increase the financial incentive for firms. This increase is to make it more attractive for firms to open branches in poorly developed areas. To solve the problem of global inequality and promote egalitarianism, the government should improve the minimum wages. This increase helps to enhance the standard of living in a country.

The rights of people mean everything to them. Therefore, the government should improve the rights of workers. In many developing countries, working conditions are pretty bad. This condition causes workers to get exploited by companies. To lower the inequality in working conditions across countries, local authorities should set stricter rules. This decision is for firms to treat their employees better.

According to the report by the world economic forum, Iceland is the most egalitarian country globally, considering all measurable parameters. These parameters are; gender equality, economic, social, and educational.

According to Nelson Mandela, “As long as injustice, poverty, and gross inequality persist in our world, none of us can truly rest.” This is to say, global inequality would, one way or another, affect every one of us. If not directly, but indirectly.

There is a need for everyone to stop this and make the world a fair place to live, and that’s what global egalitarianism is all about.

Chapter 16 - State of Equality in The United States.

You may have noticed so far that in this book, emphasis has been placed on inequality and the responses towards it, especially the adverse effects.

Only recently have we begun to elucidate equality, with the next chapter dwelling on differentiating between equality and equity. This chapter will make a noteworthy attempt to summarize the current state of equality in the United States and Canada.

But before we begin, let’s try a different method of making a recap on what we’ve been attempting to establish. As you may know, the United States of America declared independence from Great Britain in 1776. Since then, they’ve had their issues to face. Amongst them is inequality.

As more and more immigrants trooped in as the country kept developing, the issue of racial inequality — one of the forms of inequality — arose. As of now, about 23.7% of the people living in the US are of different races. Using racial injustice towards Black Americans as an example, I will try to bring out a point regarding inequality before and during America’s first periods of independence.

In the US, the slave trade was first identified in the 17th Century, 1619, in particular. It wasn’t until the 1800s that successful efforts were made to abolish this, and it did not come without sacrifices; about 60 years after enacting the federal law that created the trans-Atlantic slave trade, the bloody civil war-ravaged America at unprecedented levels. Studies recorded an estimated number of 504 deaths per day. But did the war stop racial inequality? If it did, the late Martin Luther King, Jr., would not have risen against it alongside other freedom fighters.

Let’s take ourselves out of this example a bit. We’re beginning to focus only on racial inequality in this summary. What about gender inequality in our society? Since we’re narrowing this summary down to the United States, we’ll be taking America as our case study.

Although as of 2018, America was ranked at number 51 out of 149 countries in terms of gender equality, there is

still a noticeable gap in the number of women working and the total workforce population. This condition is quite alarming. And though efforts have been made to stop this and create positive change in society since the early 1900s, progress has declined for the past few years.

A study shows that in 2020 the number of women working reached the lowest levels ever experienced since 1988. Even though records have shown that an average working woman made about 81% of what a working man earned in 2010, we can surely do better than that as it took 31 years to make 19 percent progress.

So, can we genuinely say that right now, there is equality in the United States?

The current state of equality in the United States.

During the pandemic, many issues surfaced. Among them is the issue of racial injustice that we once thought had been solved to a large extent. You have probably heard of the black lives matter movement that was birthed in the wake of the several unfortunate incidents that happened to Black Americans. In particular, it was the killings of black people that sparked the revolt of the people and the mass movement against injustice. George Floyd and Breonna Taylor became the infamous martyrs of the campaign. This event was just last year. As of this particular time, can we say there is racial equality in the US?

What People Think About Racial Equality in the US and Statistics that Support It.

News reports and interviews show that though some progress has been made over the years, racial injustice still blooms implicitly in the minds of many and explicitly in the financial records of the country. Research data published on Perspectives on Psychological Science show that the average Black American family earns 10 dollars of every 100 dollars earned by a White family.

Upon a series of questioning, many people have revealed that they feel that racial discrimination and the pertinent lack of access to quality education and jobs are the primary reasons Black Americans will face issues in equalizing with the whites in America. Some statistics have revealed that the median net worth of Black American households in 2016, $17,150, was almost ten times less than those of white families, at $171,000.

A recent study made by the pewsresearch.org team found out that about 56% percent of Americans feel that being a Black American reduces the chances of getting ahead in life quickly. When asked for the reason for this assumption, most people interviewed responded by citing that the inability to access proper education, racial discrimination, and the difficulty black people experience in trying to get high-paying jobs to contribute to their answers. A few others said troubled families, the absence of good role models, and inadequate drive to be hardworking are why they have these issues with getting ahead.

Also, most people admit that blacks are treated less well by the Police than whites. This treatment is primarily because of how black people get flagged down on roads by Police more often than whites for reasons that would have otherwise been unnoticed in the case of other people. And also, how black offenders get shot down during complicated arrests more often than white criminals.

Nonetheless, most people believe that black people are treated just as somewhat as White Americans when it comes to court rulings. Studies show that Black Americans agree and claim to have more difficulty obtaining credits when it comes to accessing loans. But most white Americans don’t share the same views. They feel that Black Americans are given the same opportunity to obtain loans just as much as possible, and any difficulty they experience in getting this is a mutual liability.

However, this disagreement is refuted by some blacks who say that they are refused loans because credit companies feel that it’ll be harder for them to pay off their loans since black people have been stereotyped as unable to access good jobs. Forbes records have it that the unemployment rate for black people in May 2020 was 16.8% — a 4.4% more value than the unemployment rate for white workers.

When it comes to voting rights, over 70% of Americans and Canadians in general interviewed feel that white people are given the same privileges in voting as Black Americans in the US and Canada.

They feel that the same goes for healthcare access, but does it? A working paper from SSRN shows a preprogrammed bias favoring white people in medical scheduling software. The researchers found out that black

people are mostly scheduled to have their appointments at overbooked periods or just after such times. This result means that the software algorithm is already preprogrammed to respond to the stereotype that black people miss their appointments and should be given less priority.

In conclusion, for how people feel about racial injustice, it's critical to consider the fact that most black people will want to say that they've been maltreated. To have a balanced view, one should also listen to the opinions of white people. Combining both ideas and paying attention to the trends in different patterns will give you a clearer view of the subject at hand.

People's Perception About Gender Inequality in The United States.

Misogyny isn't a new concept in the world. Coming in different forms, subtle misogyny is not easily spotted by the people who wield it in making their evaluations of women. The victims, however, are ever told keen on identifying them and most times speak up when they're interviewed on the issue, with the hopes of creating awareness on the topic to whoever comes across the results.

In a review from the Pew Research Center, it is clear that most women feel that little is done to change how women are treated concerning work. About 57% of women that participated in the interview believe that the government has not done enough to equalize the rights of men and women in the US. 33% of the women feel relatively okay and equal, while the remaining 10% refused to answer.

On an introductory note, out of every 10 Americans, 8 says it is essential for the country to equalize men's privileges with women. This result shows quite an impressive figure, given that researchers did not do this as the study with only women being questioned but with men too.

About half of the public believes that there is still work to be done in equalizing men's rights with women in both Canada and the US. Political views also influence the data gotten from this study. For example, about 69% of independent Democrats and people leaning towards the group believe that in the United States, not enough effort has been made into creating gender equality in workplaces and schools.

About 54% of people leaning towards the Republican party and Republican independents say that the country has done quite enough, with 18% saying that the government has gone too far in promoting gender equality.

About 36% of Americans feel that men have it easier in the US today than women. However, 56% of people claim otherwise. Many cite workplace inequality as one area where women are mistreated, with 43% explicitly mentioning this as to why they feel that the country needs to do more to be considered a gender-equal society.

Though women are more likely to say that they do not have equal rights as men, the response of a 67-year-old woman to the question - "In what ways do women have it easier in our nation these days?" will surprise you.

She says, "compared to white, heterosexual men, that have no workplace policies or laws to protect them from gender discrimination, racial bias, women, particularly non-white women, fare better in the education institutions, workplace, and socially."

There are some controversies regarding women's rights and how it's affecting workplaces and the sports scene. A study by Forbes shows that firms with more women on their boards than others face financial consequences. The research team led by Isabelle Solal and Kasia Snellman came up with exciting results. They said that they made evaluations with 14 years' worth of panel data, proving that firms with gender-diverse boards face market penalties. They realized from the data they reviewed that as companies increased, female directors' number on their boards declined, and they experienced a decline in market value.

They estimated that with each additional female member to the board, a 2.3% market loss is encountered. Why is this so? A possible reason is that the market does not perceive more women on the board as a positive change. More people feel that the addition of women to a board of directors is based on decisions aimed at diversifying the boards' gender rather than qualification and experience.

Those people think that adding more women to the team reduces the team's value and weakens the decision-making power of the board. However, the research shows that the inclusion of more women in any board of directors did not decrease the team's performance. This result brings us to the inevitable conclusion that the stereotypes associated with women influence the market's devaluation of the board.

Also, from Forbes is a study published in the Journal of the American Medical Association. The study shows that female medical professionals are followed less on Twitter when compared with males of the same profession.

The research shows that the average female medical researcher has about 570 followers while the intermediate male medical researchers have twice that number. The study shows that posts and tweets made by female researchers have fewer likes and retweets than those from make professionals.

However, there are noticeable bright sides to this review as it shows that there's potential for this issue to be solved in the nearest future as the gaps between the average number of followers of male and female junior researchers are lesser than those of their superiors. With these results, the research team concluded that though social media seems to reduce these stereotypes by creating awareness on these issues, it is unknowingly doing very little to change people's attitude towards the stereotypes, if not even reinforcing them.

The Current State of Equality in The United States.

With the facts considered above, is there true equality in America?

Before I answer this question, let's see some positive statistics and compare them with what we've been able to evaluate so far to give an unbiased answer to this question. In 2008, America had, for the first time, a democratically elected black President in the person of Barack Obama with Michelle Obama as the first Black American First Lady of the United States. This occurrence was a significant milestone not only in the history of America but also in World history.

The global community was pleased, and this meant a lot to the black community in America. It was a regime that ushered a new decade and lasted to see almost the end of it. It inspired many young black Americans to have hope that they could join hands with their fellow Americans of different colors to move the country forward.

With this, can we still say there's inequality in the United States?

Let's fast forward to right now, where we have Kamala Harris as the Vice President of the United States, a considerable achievement today. And it is not only good news for the people who fight for the equality of the multicolored people of America also means a lot for women's rights activists. Being the first female Vice-President of the US, and as she's stated many times, she is an ardent advocate of women's rights movement. She's making conscious steps to eradicate racial and gender inequality in the country and abroad. She's slowly becoming a trailblazer in her field.

Before these, Colin Powell became the first African-American secretary of state in the nation. In sports, Venus and Serena Williams broke into the Tennis world and made a huge impact, and many other black Americans set records in the country. But do all these mean equalities in the US? Records show that the economic gap between White and Black-American families in the US has remained the same since 1968. So, the answer right now to the frequently repeated question is that the current state of equality in the nation is better than before but still in dire need of improvement.

If there will be equality in the United States, the nation's socio-economic structure has to change. This change should begin with every single citizen of the country. People should accept that there isn't as much equality in the country as there should be. Judgments should be based on facts and not stereotypes, and people in society who are more likely to be maltreated should not only be given opportunities but be allowed to perform in their best capacities without prejudice. From the grassroots come the most significant changes. Such is the pattern for making actual change and progressive egalitarianism in the United States.

Chapter 17 - Egalitarianism in The United Kingdom.

The United Kingdom is a place where many people think peace thrives and there's multicultural harmony. If you feel this way, you're not entirely wrong. For the better part of the last few decades, nations of the United Kingdom or

Great Britain as it is popularly called have tried their best to get rid of the shadows of their past. Let's quickly consider some of the racial disparities that Britain has battled with for some time now.

Britain has made huge transitions from being instrumental in the great slave trade to being initiators of world peace treaties. Indigenes of Britain were once victims of brutal slavery before and during the reign of the Roman Empire, especially during the dawn of the First Millennium AD. But things changed for the better when the 12th century came.

Soon after the fall of the Roman Empire's conquest over Britain, the British soon sought to develop their lands and explore the world. And so, their search for new lands begun. It was not long before they stumbled upon the ever-promising African soil. When their ambassadors arrived, the quest for power and control made them forge alliances with the heads of the civilizations they met. Once this was successfully established in any region they went to; it was easy for them to come to terms with trade.

In some African communities, slaves were sold in exchange for beer and wine. This result was the plan that facilitated the trans-Atlantic slave trade, which ushered people of color into continents that they had never been before to live less privileged lives.

After several hundreds of years, the British had a change of heart and decided to end the slave trade. The birth of the abolitionist movement in the 18th century eventually yielded a positive result in the Slave Trade Act of 1807. The outcome of this act was the abolishment of the slave trade in the British Empire. However, it wasn't as effective as the Slavery Abolition Act of 1833, making a more fruitful attempt to abolish the slave trade.

Attempting to compensate for the hideous acts they did in the past, the British invented a new means of being influential. This thought led to them coming up with the idea of colonizing uncivilized territories. With this, they were able to make countries that would eventually become independent and join the Commonwealth.

Although the United Kingdom has tried its best to erase the past haunting memories, there remains a vivid reminder of what transpired in the previous times. This reminder is the black people distributed all over the United Kingdom.

We cannot thoroughly analyze the state of racial equality in the United Kingdom without bringing out some details of the past, so this concise history course is essential in understanding the analyses that follow.

With this brief lesson, we are ushered into the subject matter at hand. Is there genuinely racial equality in the UK?

Out of the 68.2 million people living in the United Kingdom, three percent are black. The black British have thrived over the years and have adapted to that area's weather conditions, contrasting the two seasons experienced in the African nations. But how well have they adapted to how they have been treated since the years when they were illegally brought into the country.

Racial inequality in the United Kingdom is not a new thing. In the wake of the Black Lives Matter movement that started last year, recent research has been done into finding out how bad racism is in Great Britain. The results of this research were quite stunning, given that most people felt that racism was at a shallow level in the UK.

Statistics That Show the Current Level of Racial Equality in The United Kingdom

An article published on one UK's infamous Independent website gave some reliable statistics obtained from interrogations and records kept. Studies show that people of color in Britain are stopped by the police more than White Britons. These studies show that black people were more likely to be blocked by police officers and searched six times more than white people would. But over eight years, this value has increased by almost 100%. There's ten times more chance that a black person will be stopped by police and searched than a white person. This has led to more arrests of black people in the past few years.

Shockingly, data gotten from Police powers and procedures, England and Wales's statistics show that every police force in England and Wales had arrested black people at a rate of over 20 per 1000 people. This result is horrible compared to White Britons who got arrested at a rate of less than 20 per 1000 people in every single police station.

Homeownership doesn't work out for black people on average because research shows that these families privately own about 63% of the households living in the United Kingdom. However, within this figure, we find out that 68% of the population of White Britons own their own houses, which isn't a bad thing. But the percentage of Black Britons originating from Africa who owns houses is just 20%, which is relatively small compared to their white

counterparts.

When it comes to education, the story isn't much different. Poor records are also documented for black Britons when it comes to school performance. Information sourced from the Department for Education shows that white children are more likely to have acquired the basic literacy standard for their age 10% faster than black children would have reached this stage in primary schools in Britain.

Unfortunately, this result will get worse as the children grow older. Records show that when they reach A-levels, White students are three times more likely to have better results than colored students.

In their workplaces, things don't seem to get any much better. Records have it that black people experience twice the unemployment rates of white Britons between 2004-2008. Information sourced from the UK's Annual Population Survey shows that even when Black Britons get jobs, they receive less pay than white people on an average.

At a point in time, 2013-2018, to be exact, the average hourly pay of a black Briton was between £9.91 to £10.80. Meanwhile, White Britons enjoyed an average income of about £10.58 to £11.87.

We know that equality for the colored society in the United Kingdom isn't really in its best form with these values. But our definition of equality doesn't only limit us to racial equality. There also exists gender equality. So, how well is Britain faring in terms of treating genders equally?

Society tends to believe that women are less likely to perform better than men even when they constantly prove this wrong. It's eaten so deeply into the social value of women that unless immediate action is taken, society may seriously undermine the role of women. Over the years, women's rights activists have risen to show displeasure with this trend and have tried, to very impressive extents, to empower the lives of women around the world.

Women are often not given the same privileges as men because of certain religious and cultural restrictions. But we live in a world where our views regarding certain aspects of life that do not seem to be of many benefits are beginning to change. Why then are these restrictions often overlooked?

When one asks these questions, it does not take long to discover that personal sentiments hinder men and women from getting similar opportunities. When it comes to career and work, women are often pushed towards catering for children and the elderly, while men shy away from these jobs because they feel that they are too womanly. And if a woman manages to get into a corporate office, a glass ceiling limits her advance in the organization. This restriction is indeed a sad reality for women in the United Kingdom and all over the world.

The good thing is that the global community is working hard towards eradicating these stereotypes that stop women from being productive in society. Britain is doing an excellent job at this as they were ranked 15th in the global gender gap index. Although this doesn't seem like a significant position, it means a lot. The United Kingdom is just below other trailblazing European countries ranking high on the list like Germany.

As of 2019, Britain was one of the very few nations to have a female prime minister. Theresa May did an outstanding job as prime minister before being replaced by Boris Johnson when her tenure expired.

Records have shown that the number of female Members of Parliament in the House of Commons has increased. In 2017, they took about a population of 32% of the members after being elected. When compared with 1979's three percent, this is an applaudable increment. As of now, the proportion of female Members of Parliament is 34 percent.

Britain record a number of 7 total female Chief Executive Officers of FTSE 100 companies. This result is a considerable achievement as very few countries can boast many female CEOs of companies heading the Stock Exchange.

Out of the total workforce in England and Wales Police Forces, 21.7% are female inspectors. But do these figures apply to every single female there? What about those that do not get on the news and seem to be hidden under a mountain of records? What about that nurse in the elderly care home who applied for a position in the local hospital but lost it to another male nurse. What of that talented young lady who got refused and now works at the coffee shop across the street instead of being the financial advisor of the company she applied to? Do I have to remind you of that lady stuck in HR because she can't advance further in the corporate ladder? Do I need to mention that she spends her days watching those who started off the job with her keep getting promoted while she reaches the border of her predefined career?

With these in mind, do you now understand that though these milestones achieved in Britain are impressive, they are not evenly spread? That not all the jam of equality covers the crust of women in the UK.

When you consider this, we can now proceed.

Statistics That Show the Current Level of Gender Equality in The United Kingdom.

The current gender pay gap for all employees in Britain is about 15.5%. Though this is a measure of dispersion, it says a lot regarding female workers' wages. A study shows that in 2019, women were being paid an average of 83 pence for every pound male worker made. You can imagine how this difference causes pain in the minds of several female workers in the United Kingdom. A study shows that while female workers earn about £27,981 per year, men earn about £33,923 annually. This fact is somewhat discouraging for women when they know that they can perform in the same capacity.

And while we're talking about gender inequality, let us not shift our focus from equally essential aspects of life. Education is also affected by the gender disparities existing in our society. Although it is a known fact that women perform better academically in the UK, with stereotypes still in existence, they are prevented from achieving their full potential in society.

Tests taken in 2015 revealed that the girls are already ahead academically when kids are between the ages of 7-11. The test shows that about 83% of the girls reached a level 4 score or higher. Meanwhile, only 77% of boys were able to do this. When they eventually reach high school, girls tend to get higher grades as it is recorded that ten percent more girls were able to have more than five credits or higher grades in the GCSEs than male students. And further probing reveals that more females apply for college in the UK than males.

But is this the only aspect of education that's being bothered by this inequality? It also affects school staff. In Britain, the average percentage of male staff in primary schools is just 15%. And like I mentioned earlier, measures of dispersion like this often leave out certain information, one of which, in this case, is that many primary schools do not have male teachers at all. When combining the absence of male role models to look up to with gender-specific learning difficulties of some children, education can become quite traumatic.

It gets a little better in Secondary schools as statistics have it that about 38% of staff in state secondary schools are men. But the fact is that these teachers are mostly assigned to Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics, STEM, courses, and Physical Education. With this in place, women have often been pushed aside to courses on humanities and languages.

This occurrence can be devastating for female students interested in science because they most often go on without a female role model working in their school to admire. Also, research shows that female students are more responsive to female physical instructors and gym teachers because they feel they are more aware of their physiology than male teachers. The absence of a female PE teacher may lead to an unwholesome experience for girls.

Another part of being affected by gender disparities is position. Research has shown that fewer women get to work in the higher-paying non-academic offices than men in schools. This result is why it's more likely for men to be appointed into high-ranking positions of authority in schools than for women. Because this has been happening over time, women have even accepted and become comfortable with lower-paying teaching roles. There isn't much competition for men when getting such positions because most school staff are female.

With the 79% of women who agree that there is a noticeable gap in gender pay in the United Kingdom, we understand that many women understand their position in society and are uncomfortable with it. They are willing to take active and proactive steps to move from the stagnant roles they've been given and join hands with the male workforce to make progressive societal changes.

The problem is not their fault, and they are willing to take steps that will bring forth change no matter the cost. The issue now is whether every member of the global society is ready to join them to make this change.

With all this said, is there indeed equality in the United Kingdom? To a remarkable extent, I'd say progress is being made to equalize the genders and their privileges. But we can achieve higher levels of progress. The scene looks pretty hopeful for women in the United Kingdom. We can hope for the best while creating a society where women are treated just as somewhat as men.

How about racial equality? Progress there does seem bleak, but when compared to previous times, it is quite an

impressive change. However, we must put in more work to eradicate white Britons' implicit judgments on people of color. In the next chapter, steps are required to make these changes and ensure true equality for all people of all colors and genders, not only within the United Kingdom but also globally.

Chapter 18 - Strategies for Change.

A rampant phenomenon in large Nations where people from all walks of life, races, backgrounds, cultures, and civilizations meet and coexist, not all learn to tolerate and accept the differences present. There are constantly biting cases of racial discrimination, class discrimination, gender inequality, religious Intolerance, and even unfavorable social policies that are construed to favor those on the upper rung of the societal ladder while relegating the minority to the shadows.

These various forms of intimidation, oppression, and discrimination is experienced socially, politically, economically, and even religiously, thus amounting to inequality all around; this inequality is practiced not only in hierarchical Institutions but also in schools, hospitals, grocery stores, and everywhere one can imagine. The practice of inequality is detrimental even to the nation itself. This occurrence leads to the deprivation of skilled personnel as a practice of favoritism. It widens the gap between the rich and the poor, and it denies competent folks opportunities that they could utilize to the benefit of the nation and beyond. These are only a few cons to be seen in a society where equality, equity, or egalitarianism is lacking.

Though inequality is a worldwide phenomenon, it is highly experienced in more developed nations with different individuals. It is experienced on an individual level, group level, and even amongst nations. Inequality in developed countries spans from race to gender, class, business, workplace, learning, and stretches. When moving to the group level, inequality is experienced in the LGBTQ community as social and governmental laws do not favor them, and they aren't accepted in society. Inequality on an Individual basis due to preference. In the area of gender, it tries to subjugate women to patriarchal domination, etc. On the national level, inequality is prevalent in the capitalist system of governance, exploitative by nature, and supports class difference. In the capitalist system, we see social variations from the bourgeoisie to the proletariats and peasants. The peasants and proletariats are constantly being exploited and drained by the bourgeois. Concerning capitalism is the dependency theory developed by Raul Plebisch, which talks about the core nations of the western world who wield power and influence exploiting the periphery nations of their labor and resources, and this, in turn, leads to the periphery nations depending on the core for basic needs and provisions and even protection. This dependency is exploitation and a high level of inequality as it constantly broadens rather than closes the gap between developed and developing nations, between first world and third world countries.

Due to these, there is an extreme need to advocate for promoting equity and equality in day-to-day living, in the relationship between groups, nations, and the world. The rise of equality is a practical project that would require the development of new ideas to help reshape and restructure the environment, economic, governmental, and social institutions.

Information gotten from the United Nations Development Project 2002 informs us of the high rate of inequality of life expectancy between the rich and the developing nations. Life expectancy in Sub-Saharan Africa is forty-nine, while in America, it is seventy-six. If a thousand children are born in Sub-Saharan Africa and the same amount in Europe, 174 die in Sub-Saharan Africa while 14 die in Europe. This result shows that the privileged ones live longer. If all could have equal opportunity and health care or means to afford standard health care, it would balance the life expectancy.

In multicultural nations, where the white majority see themselves as superior and control modes of production and businesses, they often leave the menial jobs to people of other racial or ethnic descent who they consider subordinate due to lack of color line. The unskilled jobs handed to races like Indians and Africans are primarily dangerous. Due to The physical dangers encountered while working, they are more likely to die. These other races are also more inclined to experience homicide. Irrespective of color or religion or gender or class, disability, we are all humans with flesh and blood running through our veins and, as such, are entitled to universal suffrage and fundamental rights as declared by the Universal Declaration of Human Rights.

Income inequality is also one of the many forms felt. Income can be majorly classified into wealth and resources.

We could view income inequality based on gender, disability, and race. In gender, women are hardly recognized as being qualified to handle domineering positions in offices and workplaces. Most women either work part-time or are paid low wages. Males are seen as more fitting to rule, even in the political context. When women are employed, they often face harassment from their bosses at work. Women, even in some developed countries, earn lower in comparison to men. Disabled people are also less prone to get job opportunities, and when they do, they mostly don't receive standard pay.

In America, the African American migrant receives on average less than two-thirds the income of a non-Hispanic white (Herwood 2002). The Economic Cooperation and Development organization uses the Gini coefficient to measure inequality. It makes use of 0 for perfect equality and 1 for perfect inequality. Studies discovered the US as the highest of all the G7 nations experiencing income inequality with a coefficient of 0.434, while the UK has a coefficient of 0.392. There is a severe black-white income gap. The median household incomes between African Americans and whites have grown from $23,800 in 1970 to roughly $33,000 in 2018. The majority of UK households have incomes below the mean average of £34,200 as of 2018. The median income has been on a rise of 2.2% in the last few years. Most of this is accounted for by the increase in the average income of the wealthiest fifth. The poorest fifth has seen income decline by 1.6%. The richest fifth has an income of more than 12 times Tue amount earned by the poorest.

In The face of all this inequality, living standards are relatively high, and there are constant needs needing provision. There is rent to be paid and shelter to be gotten. Income inequality is notable because income is what represents and distinguishes social class. If this inequality can be breached, there will be an elimination of social class and equal social status. People's resources also include non-financial conditions for their access to goods and services. These resources include their right to public services. It also constitutes their freedom. People with physical impairments need higher incomes than those without these impairments and changes in the physical environment that promote their inclusion in the activities. If resources are equal, prospects for the good life will be similar also.

Inequality of respect and recognition- Racism strengthens the belief that subordinate races shouldn't be accorded respect and deserve to be maltreated with disdain. A sense of distinction thus arises and carries with it sentiments of special entitlement to the appraised class. These beliefs could be carried out to the extreme, leading to mass genocide, e.g., when Adolf Hitler killed millions of Jews with his Arian faith and antisemitic practice. Concerning gender, this belief of patriarchal dominance is expressed in various forms; examples are the disallowance of female participants in governance, the praise of assertive behavior in men while it disparaged in women, and male pronouns to refer to persons generally. This occurrence gives rise to the struggle of feminist groups for women's suffrage and gender equality, e.g., FIDA. Disrespect is also related to sexuality and disability. To overcome this, respect and tolerance of differences are required. Diversities should be appreciated and celebrated. Critical interculturalism should be practiced to attain a mutually supportive and essential dialogue between observers of different cultures to promote understanding and acceptance. The principle of universal citizenship should also be adhered to by everyone.

Power inequality is most apparent in authoritarian states that deny their citizens of even the most basic rights. This denial isn't related to only tyranny or dictatorship as there is arbitrary power use even in democratic capitalist governance, mainly about political offenses and penal systems. This could include the under-representation of ethnic minorities in the national legislature. In societies full of minority groups, ethnicities, races, Individuals, and religions, the minorities are always underrepresented or deprived of a voice to speak. For example, African Americans make up 13% of the United States' population but only 7% of the congress (Amer 2003; Ethnic Majority 2003). In a primarily capitalist economy, there is a continual creation and reproduction of inequalities in people's lifestyles. To do this, it utilizes inequalities of power and status. it places tremendous strains on relations of love, care, and solidarity. The cultural system reinforces inequalities based on gender, class, disability, ethnicity, race' and sexual orientation. To counter inequality in this form, we must protect fundamental civil and personal rights against the powerful. This step is vital as it is a central and longstanding idea within liberalism.

These rights include:

1. The prohibition of slavery, torture, and cruel, inhuman, or degrading punishment.
2. Freedom of association.
3. Freedom of movement.
4. Right to own property.
5. Equality before the law.

6. Right to the due process of law.
7. Conscience and religion.
8. Protection against arbitrary arrest.
9. Freedom of thought.
10. Freedom of opinion and expression.

These civil and personal rights are standard features of modern liberal regimes. Documents which you can find them are; the American Bill of Rights (1789), the International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights (1976), the European Convention on Human Rights (1950) and the Universal Declaration of Human Rights (1948).

The content of these materials has varying interpretations. However, when taken overall, they are one way of setting limits on the degree of inequality of power any society should tolerate. In the bid to prevent or reduce arbitrary use of power, countries should engage in a more potent, more participatory form of politics. By this, ordinary citizens, and particularly groups who have been excluded from power altogether, can have more control over decision-making. They should have more strengthened local government, closer accountability for elected representatives, procedures to ensure the participation of marginalized groups, and broader access to information and technical expertise.

Antonio Gramsci's 1891- 1937 Gramscian strand of Marxism concept of hegemony embraces two things: the domination of some groups over others depending on ideological factors and the relation of dependency. A Marxist approach to migration shows the importance of historical materialism as individuals from the periphery/ developing nations migrate to the core/ developed countries to supply labor that is cheaply rewarded, and this increases the gap of inequality and highlights the need for equality. Marxism sees people united in their oppression and struggles and fighting to gain emancipation from the shackles of fixtures that trap them, such as borders that unfairly determine relations of dependency and inequality between developed and developing States. Border fixtures result in migrants being treated as second-class citizens creating a problem of social inequality. Marxist ideas could also serve as an Instrument of Change and inspiration to end the great social divide, gender, race, and resource-based exploitation. Friedrich Engels and Karl Marx in the 19th century wrote that the primary source of instability in the international system is capitalist globalization.

Marxist view of International relations sees sovereign state systems and capitalist mode of production as products of social conditions and relations. Historical materialism served as his guideline to understanding humans. It asserts that humans, including their relationship with one another and the environment, are determined by material conditions to survive. Marxism asserts that material requirements can be changed by events and actions of humans, thus enhancing transformation and change.

Inequality In the case of work and learning shows the disparities between different classes of workers as work varies from skilled to unskilled labor and spans over various factors like repetitiveness, neatness, duration, control over one's hours, and learning opportunities. Within the paid workforce, ethnic minorities and marginalized groups are disproportionately represented among the peripheral and menial workers in society. They suffer long working hours with arduous tasks, low wages, and numerous part-time jobs. In educational attainment, only about 13% of African Americans have had four years of college education compared to 24% of white Americans (Hacker 1992, Pg. 234). Surveys in several countries show that nearly everywhere, women work longer hours than men and that they generally perform between two-thirds and four-fifths of a society's unpaid work (UNDP 2002, Table 26). Statistics have shown that 'an average worker in Mexico City, Istanbul or Hong Kong works about six hundred hours more in a year than his/her counterpart in Copenhagen, Berlin or Amsterdam' (Sutcliffe 2001, graph 7).

Reports by ILO 2002 states that the average paid working hours range from below 1400 in Norway and Netherlands to over 2400 in South Korea. Work inequalities are strongly related to gender. Time use surveys in various countries show that women work longer hours than men and generally perform between two-thirds and four-fifths of a society's unpaid work (UNDP 2002, Table 26). Working-class or proletariats are subject to the power of their employers, who deprive them of opportunities for satisfying and fulfilling work conditions, thereby consigning them to lower living standards. This event, in turn, hampers the opportunity for their children to learn or acquiring education.

In contrast, people in dominant social classes enjoy the high income, status, and economic power. They have a wide range of opportunities for engaging in and rewarding work and learning and are thus equipped to provide similar opportunities for their children.

It should be noted and observed that everyone has a right to work under minimally decent conditions. The Universal Declaration of Human Rights published that everyone has the right to work, favorable and fair conditions of work and security against unemployment, and free choice of employment. We should equally share the burdens and benefits of work, and working conditions are to be equal. Those who take on more significant work burdens should receive more significant benefits or be divided equally. The division of society into those that assign tasks and execute them is unjust and needs to be radically reconceive (Young,1990 ch.7). Learning processes and work are closely related because work always involves learned abilities. Due to this, appropriate education and training is a necessary condition for a decent job, so education should be encouraged and supported. Schools should be built in rural areas and made accessible to all.

One of the most potent political advances of our times has been developing an international movement supporting human rights. Human rights are primarily every egalitarian's idea, resting as it does on the Universal Declaration's commitment to equal dignity. The human rights agenda an excellent way of setting universal minimum standards for the ways people can be treated, particularly by governments. More human rights activist groups and agencies should advocate furiously for better societal restructuring as an Instrument of change.

The inequalities of our world are deep, pattered, and clear to everyone. In the bid to change them, it is not enough to view them as workers or women or disabled people. We need to develop a method of addressing them that incorporates all of these perspectives without ignoring their differences. Hence the need for an interdisciplinary field that combines both normative and empirical inquiry and aims at the transformation.

With the quantity of inequality evident in societies all around, the need for practice and promotion of equity and equality cannot be over-emphasized to develop and sustain an egalitarian society. Therefore, the bridge separating the rich and poor is balanced, resources, opportunities, power, respect, income, recognition, etc., are evenly shared, and citizens have equal status. The distribution of aid and options shouldn't be biased or based on gender, class, race, disability, or ethnicity.

In the educational field, disability studies should emerge as space where disabled people can speak for themselves and analyze how disabled people are excluded and oppressed, not only studied in a medical or sociological context. Queer studies should emerge from the lesbian, gay and bisexual movement. These studies are necessary to learn ways to create and Implement a valid and lasting societal transformation.

Equality is the egalitarian belief that all humans have equal worth and importance and are therefore worthy of the same rights and respect. No human should be seen as more minor or more. Governments should severely punish acts of inhumanity, degradation, violence, subjugation, and oppression to deter such actions. Equality is meant to provide a fair basis for managing inequalities by strengthening the minimum to which everyone is entitled and regulating competition for advantage. On the other hand, equity sees the essential minimum for individuals affected by circumstances and advocates for entitlement according to individual requirements. Equity and equality both promote fairness in the public status of citizens, individuals and groups. Equality is a tool for making coherent connections between values and creating several coherent principles for the betterment of society. These principles can be used to criticize existing social institutions and systems and to suggest ways to improve or replace them.

Conclusion

Despite the saying, “there is unity in diversity,” cultural diversity is one of the bedrocks of inequality in multicultural countries. Despite how wrong this seems, it is quite natural for human beings to favor people who look like them, are of the same race, practice the same culture, and have similar beliefs. Inequality in multicultural nations will fadeout when everyone learns to accept and coexist equally with all the different people that inhabit the country. When they know that everyone around them is as human as they are and are entitled to equal rights. Only then will inequality in multicultural countries be stopped.

With the world becoming more polarized and consumer product companies increasing their services to a global market, it is certain that embracing our difference becomes not just the right thing to do but the very backbone of any hope of innovation.

Many individuals are already making efforts to keep going forward; however, unconscious bias will always strive to pull companies, and humanity in general, backward. It poses a tough roadblock, and fighting it is critical for any progress.

The full spectrum of ways that individuals can identify is diversity. When we say workplace diversity, we mean the notion that the cultures we represent are the way they are perceived in our businesses. There are many facets of diversity, including ethnicity, race, and gender, country of origin, age, religious affiliation, and sexual orientation. But diversity is not always something that can be quantified or seen. People of various educational backgrounds, character traits, cultural references, perspectives, or physical capabilities are often interested and invested in the appreciation and propagation of diversity inclusion.

It is pretty much implied that if there are mutual grounds or a common platform provided to a diverse population, the reach of ideas would be widespread, which will result in a more significant and quicker positive outcome.

Inclusion is when every single individual is valued, understood, appreciated, encouraged, and experiences a real sense of togetherness in society. It goes beyond tolerance to genuinely celebrate and uplift every individual in the space.

A company with credibility for diversity and inclusion becomes a magnet that attracts top applicants, which in turn will allow greater use of the capacity of markets, whether in emerging economies or at home, within a broader range of consumers. The inclusion of various diverse groups in good positions is not limited to employee satisfaction. Happy employees will help generate favorable outcomes for the company as well. According to a report by Salesforce Research, - employees who believe that their voice is heard at work are almost five times more likely to feel motivated to give their best to the job.

Employees who report fair opportunities are provided by their employers are almost four times more probable say they are pleased to work for their employer. And those who claim they can be their true self at work without being ashamed of their identity are almost three times more likely to say that they are willing to work for their business.

The report based on 'The Impact of Equality and Values-Driven Business' also suggests that organizations actively practicing inclusion of diversity gain higher potential for client retention. Along with that, the employees are motivated and thus give a hand in producing better profits.

Hence, the distorted belief of disregarding the difference should cease. Doing so will provide clarity to several notions. The hypocrites of the society often misconstrue the thin line between similarity and equality. Two persons belonging to different sections of society are allowed to be different and are not bound to be similar, all while receiving equal opportunities and rewards.

By now, it is crystal clear that how we address unconscious bias internally can consequently result in a huge step forward for the global community. The importance of diversity and overcoming implicit bias should be embedded into every process, decision, engagement, and interaction you make so we can all keep moving forward.

We have successfully completed our exposition at this juncture, but the results depend entirely on you. How well are you willing to relive this knowledge and apply it to your personal life? How firm is your will to overcome this treacherous beast that has caused global-scale catastrophes? How much do you want to contribute to worldwide

innovation? It's all on you. I now pass the torch to you. Onward to victory!